

Regulatory Genomics

Yongjin Park

Slides credit
(borrowed a lot from):

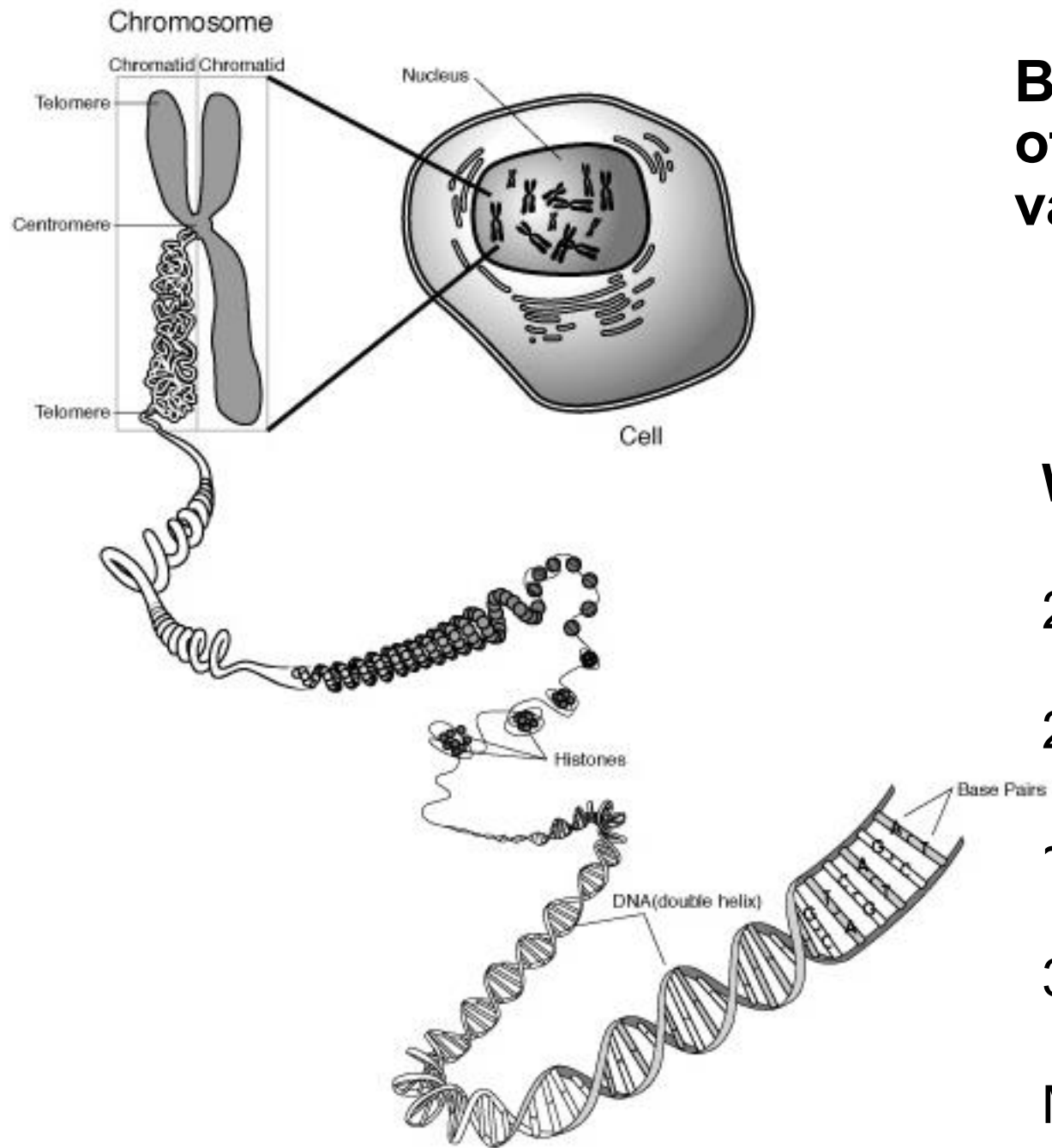
Carles Boix
Abhishek Sarkar
Manolis Kellis



Roadmap of STAT/BIOF/GSAT540 2026

data generation followed by methodology

- ③ Formulating biological questions
- ④ RNA-seq data
- ⑤ Experimental design
- ⑥ Single-cell genomics
- ⑦ Matrix factorization
- ⑩ GWAS
- ⑪ **Regulatory genomics** (Today)
- ⑫ Regression (for reg. genomics)
- ⑬ Biological networks
- ⑭ Clustering



Building blocks of genetic variation

Within each cell:

2 copies of the genome

23 chromosomes

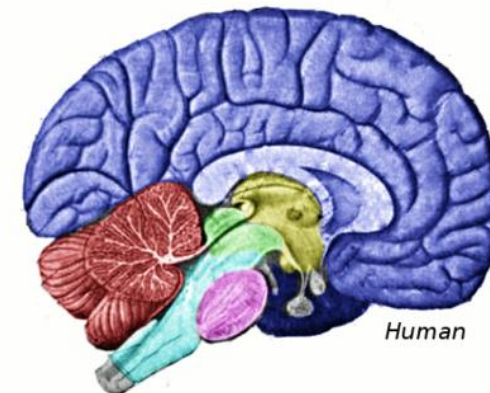
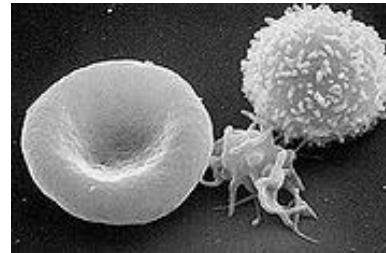
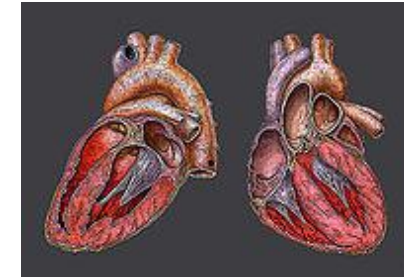
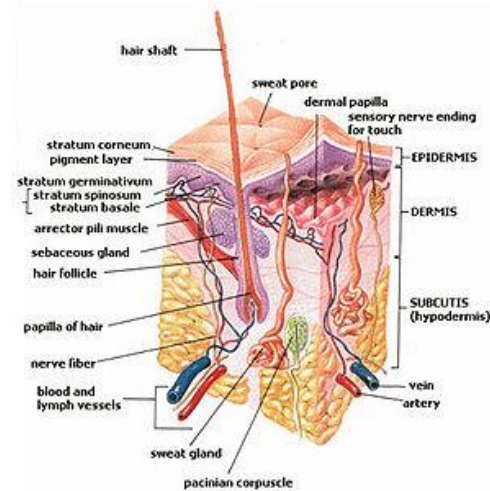
~20,000 genes

3.2B letters of DNA

Millions of polymorphic
sites

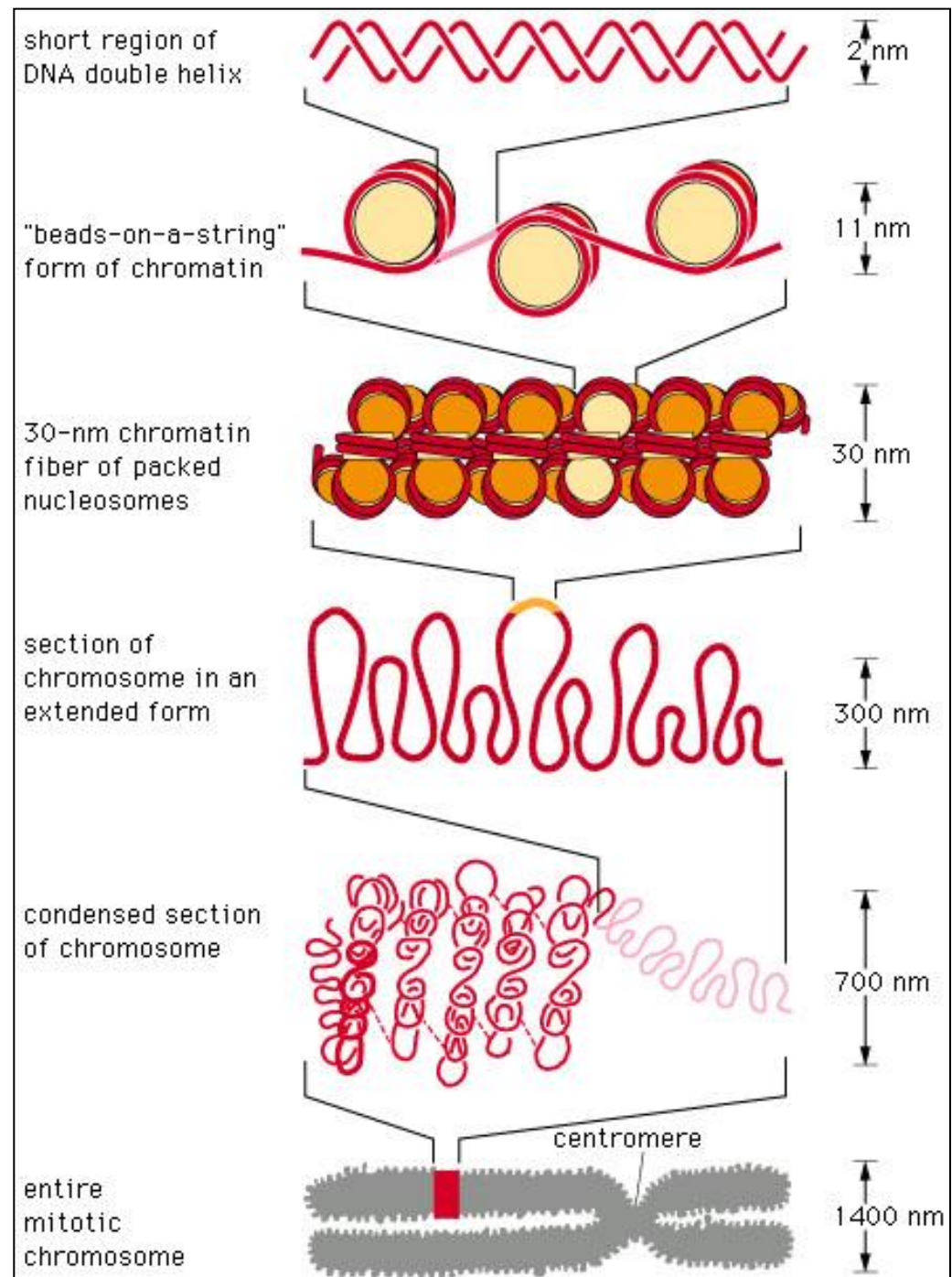
One Genome – Many Cell Types

ACCAGTTACGACGGT
CAGGGTACTGATACC
CCAAACCGTTGACCG
CATTTACAGACGGGG
TTTGGGTTTTTGCCCC
ACACAGGTACGTTAG
CTACTGGTTTAGCAA
TTTACCGTTACAACG
TTTACAGGGTTACGG
TTGGGATTTGAAAAA
AAGTTTGAGTTGGTT
TTTTCACGGTAGAAC
GTACCGTTACCAGTA

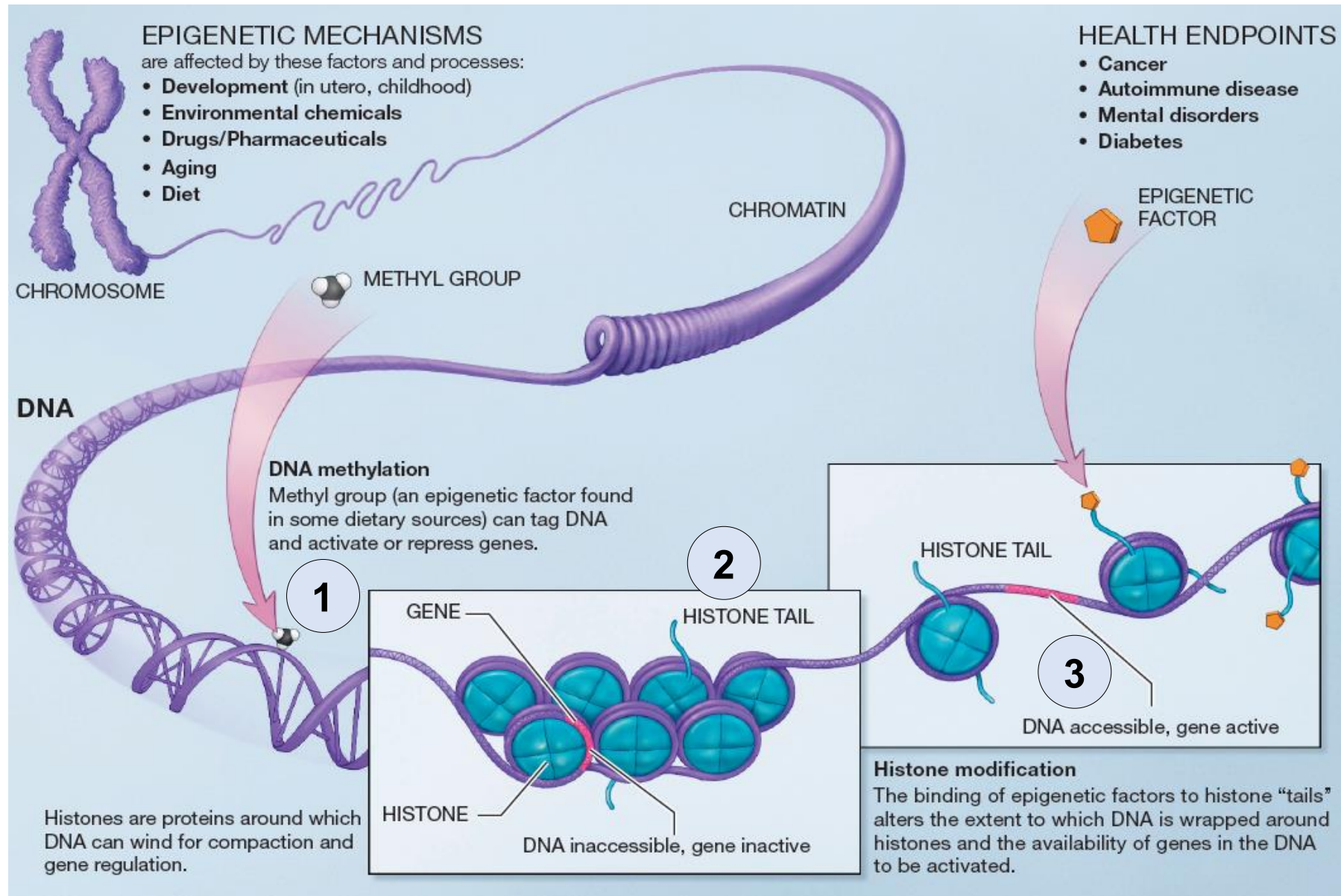


DNA packaging

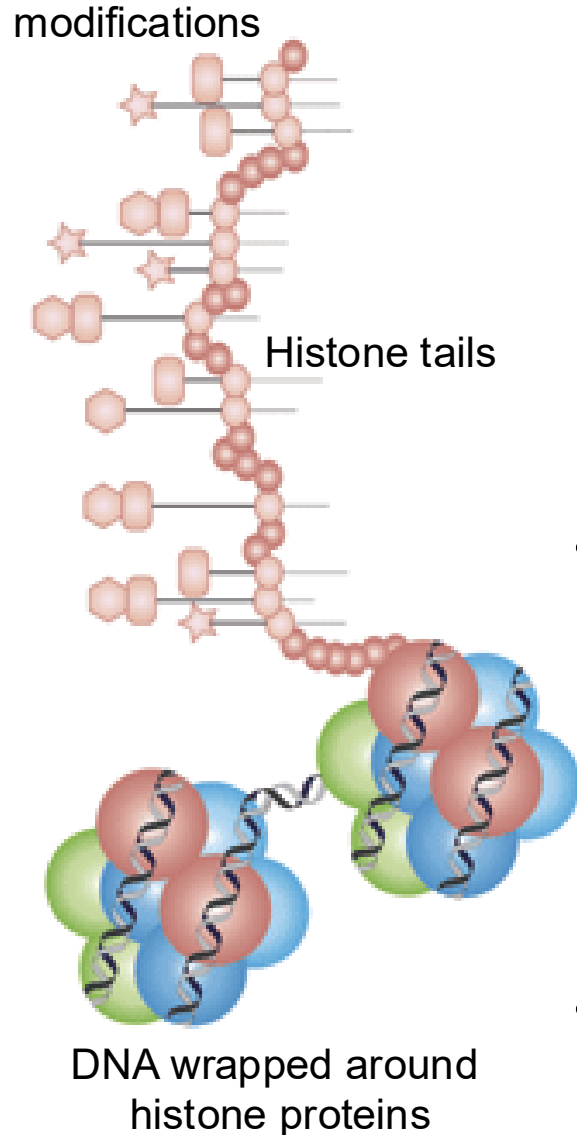
- Why packaging
 - DNA is very long
 - Cell is very small
- Compression
 - Chromosome is 50,000 times shorter than extended DNA
- Using the DNA
 - Before a piece of DNA is used for anything, this compact structure must open locally
- Now emerging:
 - Role of accessibility
 - State in chromatin itself
 - Role of 3D interactions



Three types of epigenetic modifications

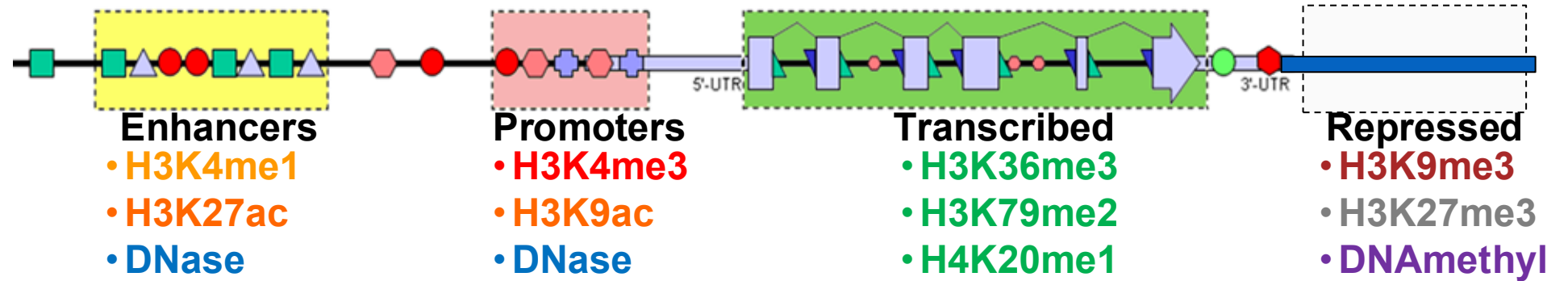


100s of histone tail modifications

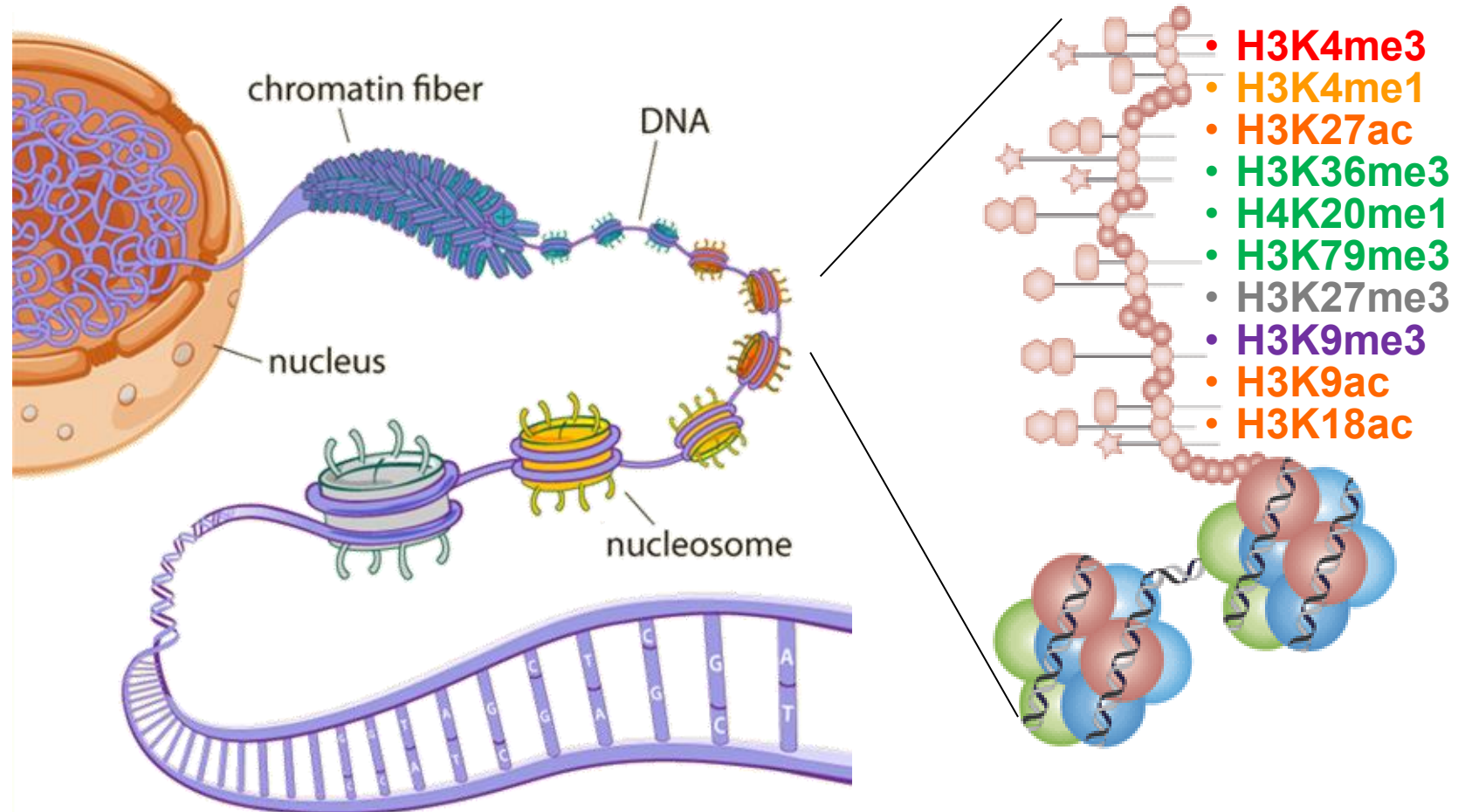


- 100+ different histone modifications
 - Histone protein → H3/H4/H2A/H2B
 - AA residue → Lysine4(K4)/K36...
 - Chemical modification → Met/Pho/Ubi
 - Number → Me-Me-Me(me3)
 - Shorthand: H3K4me3, H2BK5ac
- In addition:
 - DNA modifications
 - Methyl-C in CpG / Methyl-Adenosine
 - Nucleosome positioning
 - DNA accessibility
- The constant struggle of gene regulation
 - TF/histone/nucleo/GFs/Chrom compete

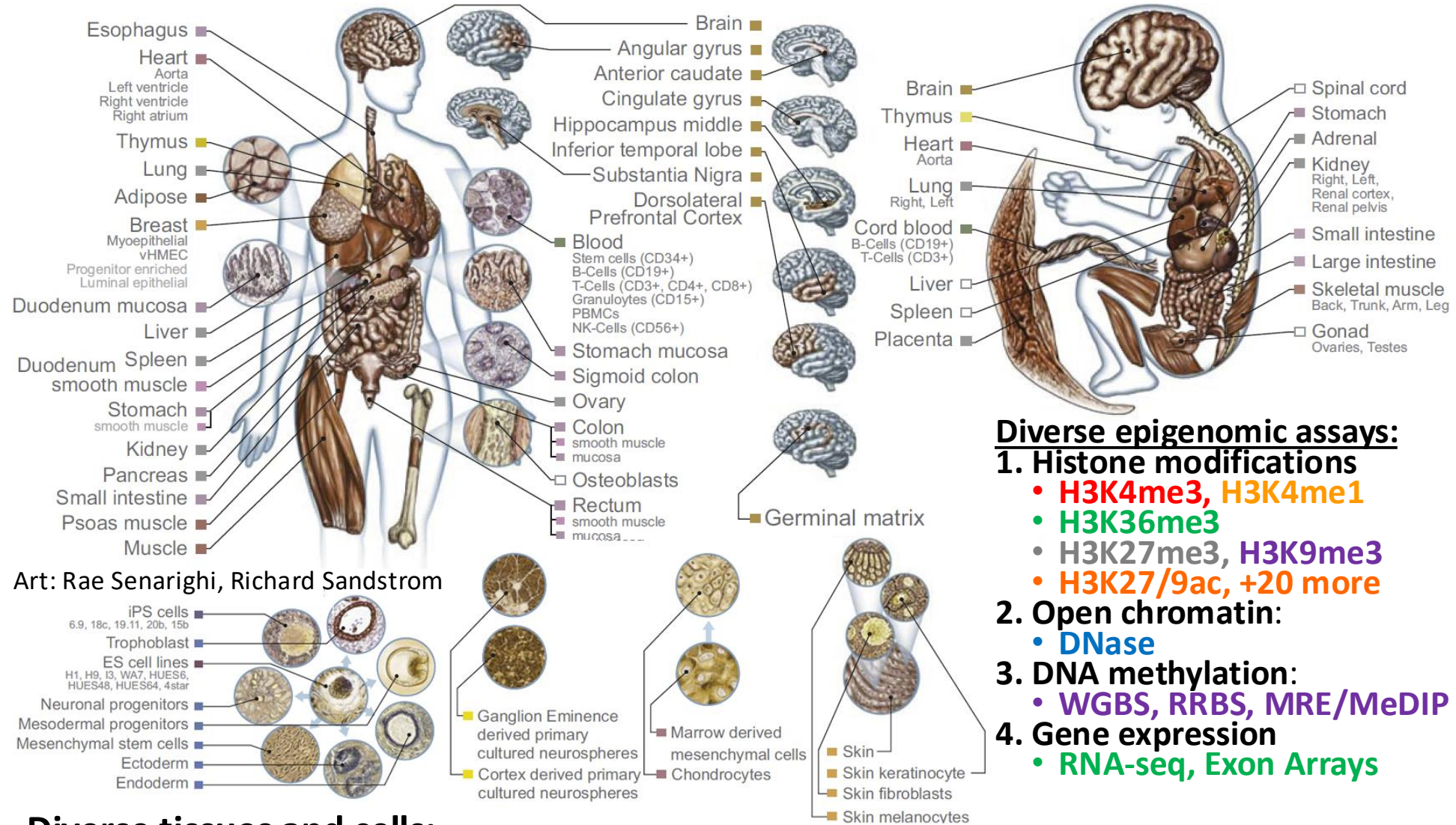
Combinations of marks encode epigenomic state



- 100s of known modifications, many new still emerging
- Systematic mapping using ChIP-, Bisulfite-, DNase-Seq



Epigenomics Roadmap across 100+ tissues/cell types



Diverse epigenomic assays:

1. Histone modifications

- H3K4me3, H3K4me1
- H3K36me3
- H3K27me3, H3K9me3
- H3K27/9ac, +20 more

2. Open chromatin:

- DNase

3. DNA methylation:

- WGBS, RRBS, MRE/MeDIP

4. Gene expression

- RNA-seq, Exon Arrays

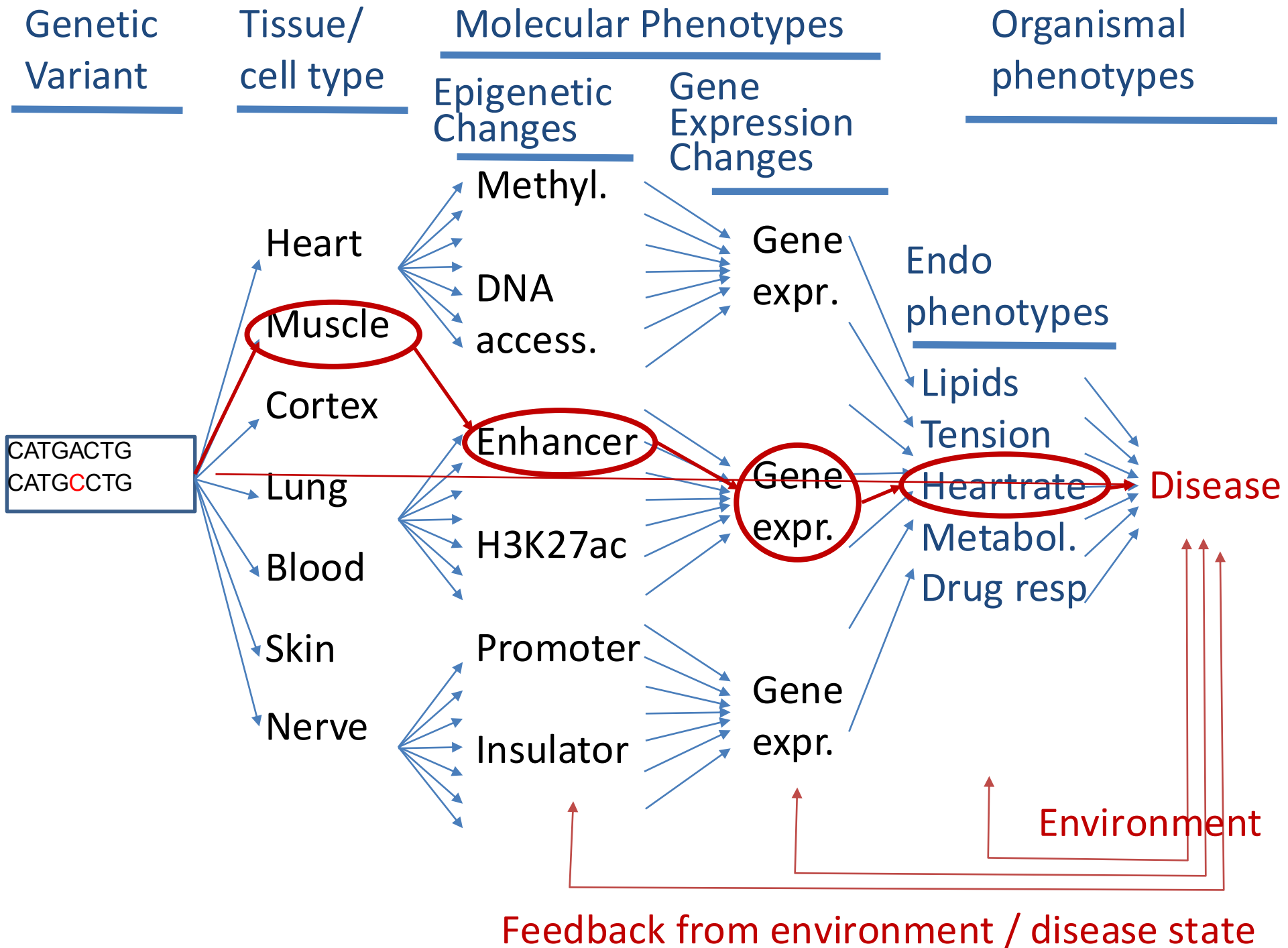
Diverse tissues and cells:

1. Adult tissues and cells (brain, muscle, heart, digestive, skin, adipose, lung, blood...)
2. Fetal tissues (brain, skeletal muscle, heart, digestive, lung, cord blood...)
3. ES cells, iPS, differentiated cells (meso/endo/ectoderm, neural, mesench, trophobl)

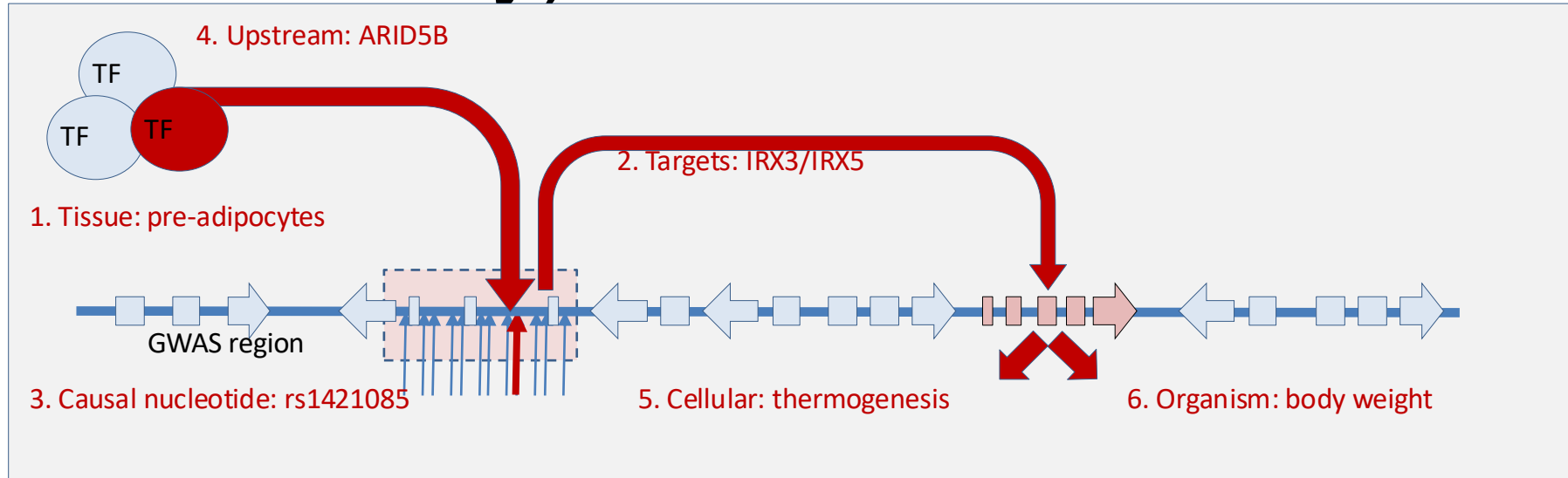
Ongoing epigenomic mapping projects



- Mapping multiple modifications
 - In multiple cell types
 - In multiple individuals
 - In multiple species
 - In multiple conditions
 - With multiple antibodies
 - Across the whole genome
- First waves published
 - Lots more in pipeline
 - Time for analysis!



Dissection of disease mechanism (e.g. FTO/obesity)



1. Establish relevant **tissue/cell type**: **pre-adipocytes**
2. Establish downstream **target** gene(s): **IRX3 and IRX5**
3. Establishing **causal** nucleotide variant: **rs1421085**
4. Establish upstream **regulator** causality: **ARID5B**
5. Establish **cellular** phenotypic consequences: **thermogenesis**
6. Establish **organismal** phenotypic consequences: **body weight**

Today's lecture

- 1 Technologies for measuring regulatory activities
- 2 DNA Methylation (credit: Keegan Korthauer)
- 3 Multiomic Data Integration with Regulatory Genomics

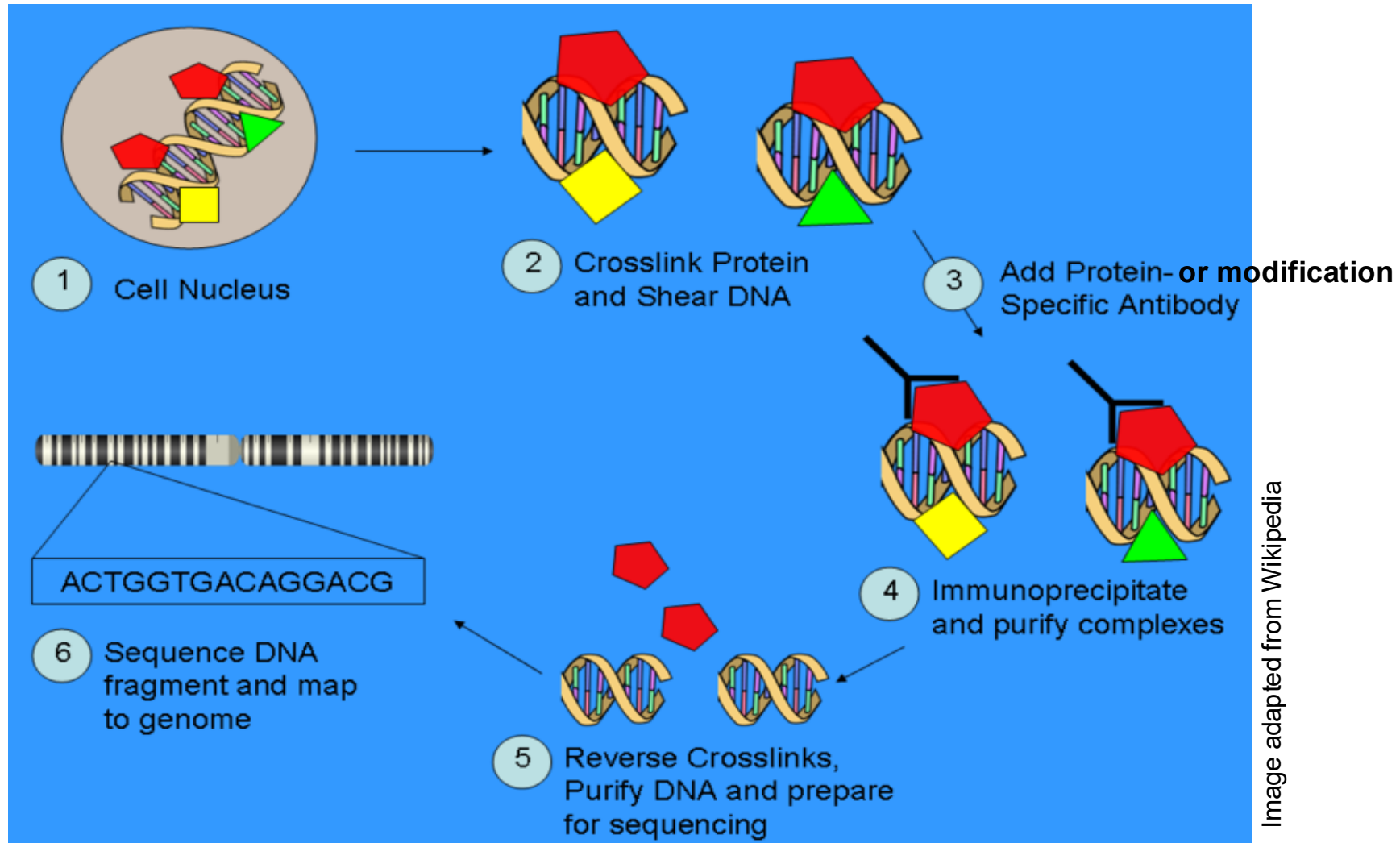
Chromatin Immunoprecipitation + Sequencing

Goal: Identify where proteins (e.g., TFs) bind to DNA genome-wide

Experimental Protocols:

- 1 Cross-link proteins to DNA
- 2 Fragment chromatin
- 3 Immunoprecipitate with antibody
- 4 Sequence DNA fragments
- 5 Map reads to genome
- 6 **Call peaks**

ChIP-chip and ChIP-Seq technology overview



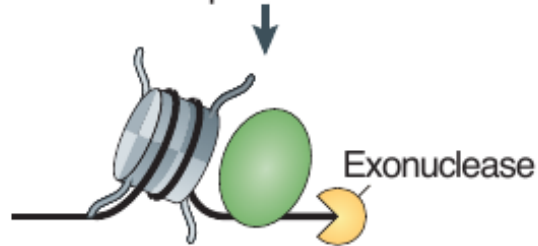
Modification-specific antibodies → Chromatin Immuno-Precipitation
followed by: ChIP-chip: array hybridization
ChIP-Seq: Massively Parallel Next-gen Sequencing

How ChIP-seq works

a DNA-binding protein ChIP-seq

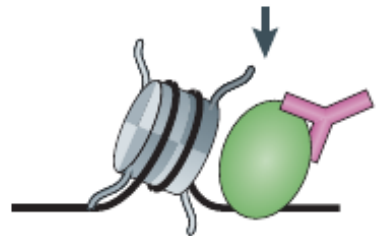


Crosslink proteins and DNA



Sample fragmentation

- Sonication
- Endonuclease (ChIP-exo)



Immunoprecipitate and
then purify DNA

- Binding
- Sequencing

Furey (2012)

How ChIP-seq works

a DNA-binding protein ChIP-seq

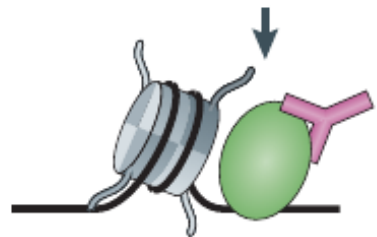


Crosslink proteins and DNA



Sample fragmentation

- Sonication
- Endonuclease (ChIP-exo)



Immunoprecipitate and then purify DNA

b Histone modification ChIP-seq

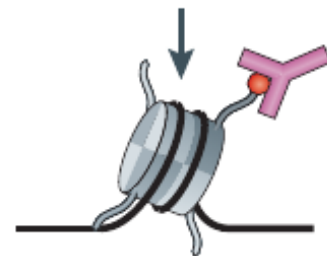


Crosslink proteins and DNA



Sample fragmentation

- MNase digestion



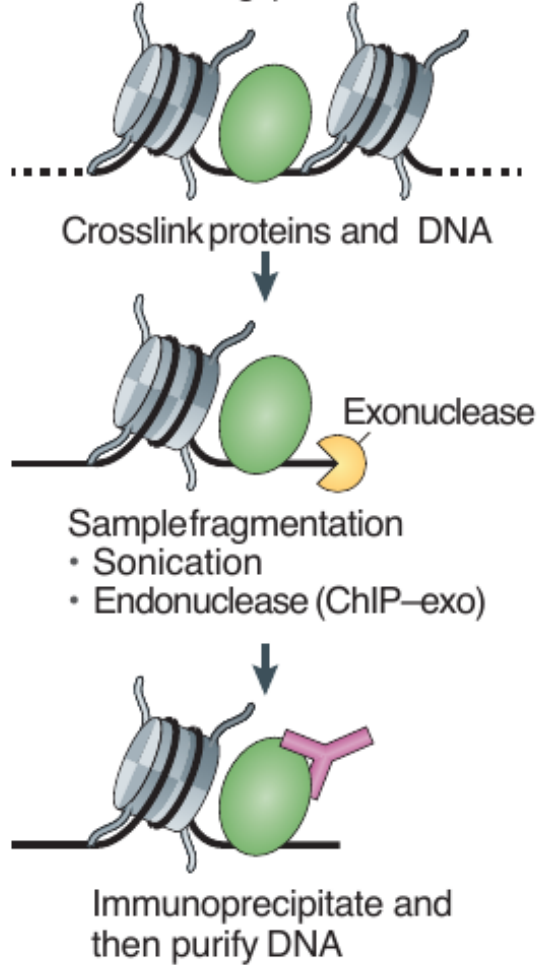
Immunoprecipitate and then purify DNA

- Binding
- Sequencing

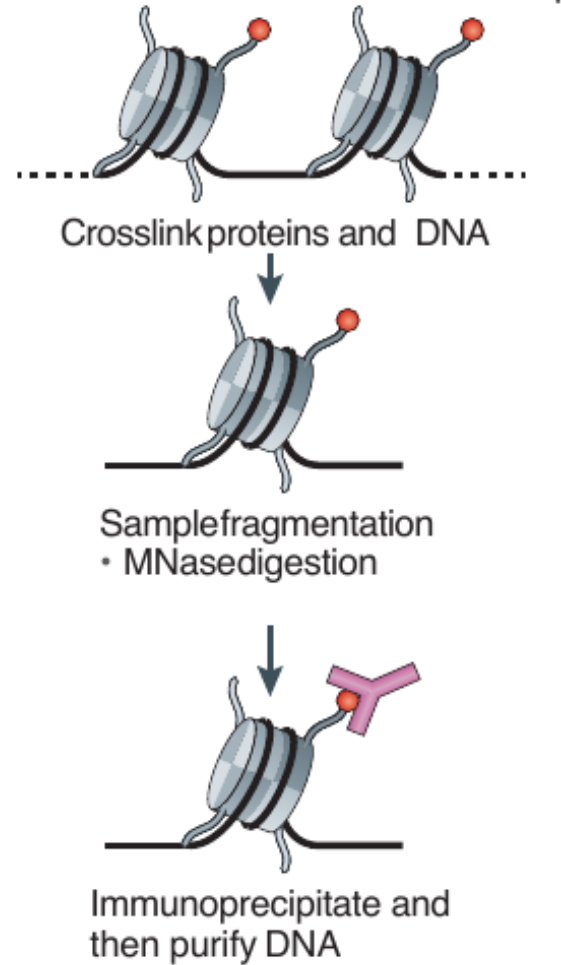
Furey (2012)

How ChIP-seq works

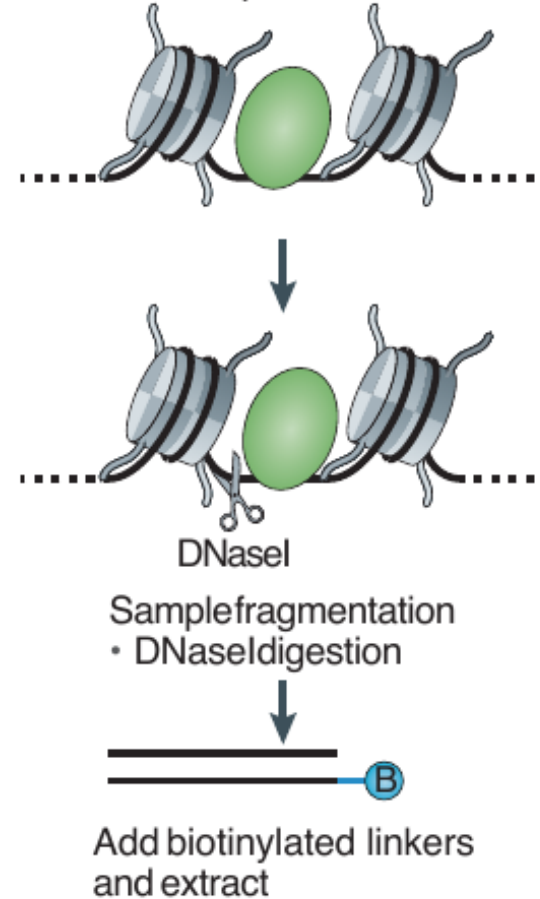
a DNA-binding protein ChIP-seq



b Histone modification ChIP-seq



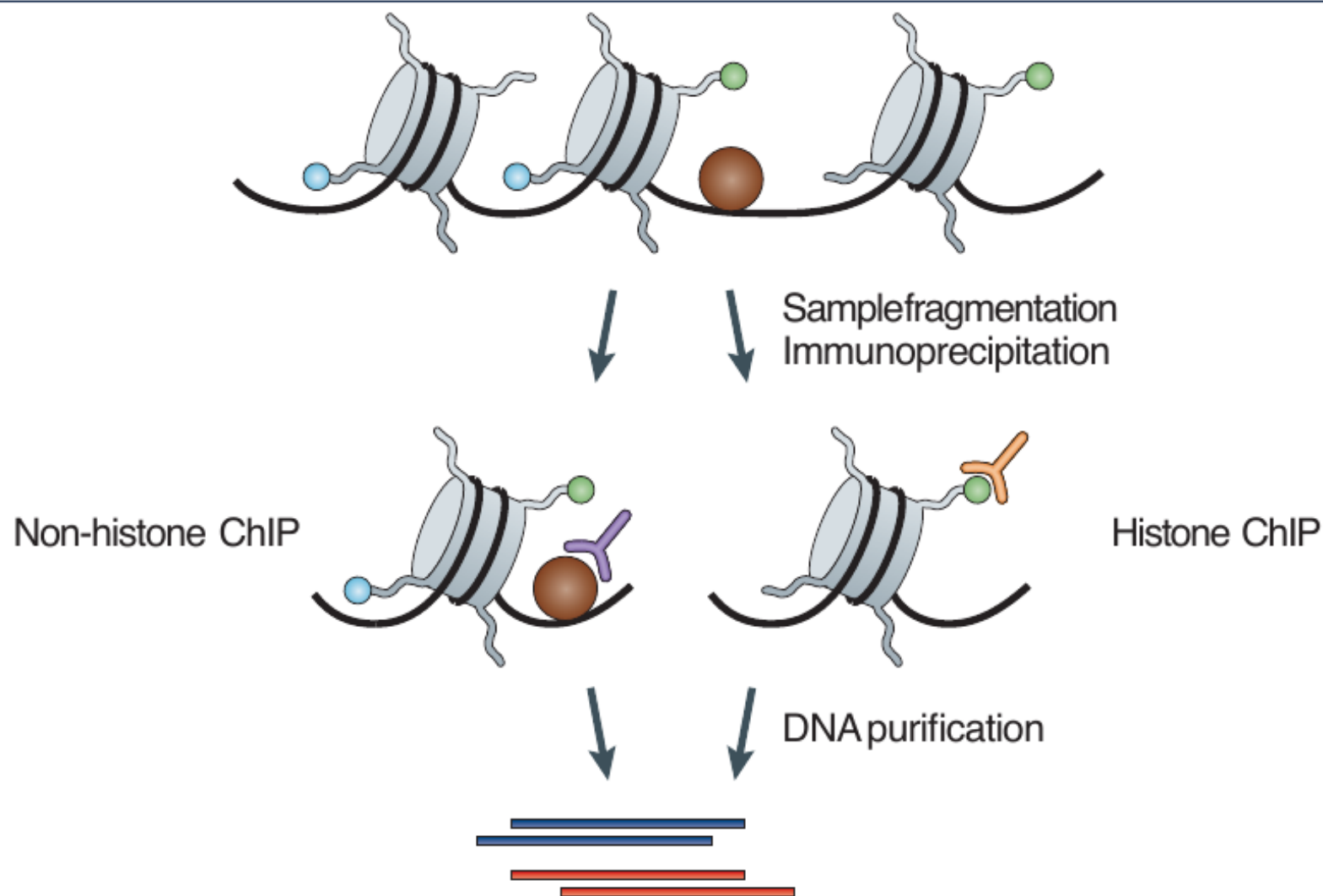
c DNase-seq



- Binding
- Sequencing

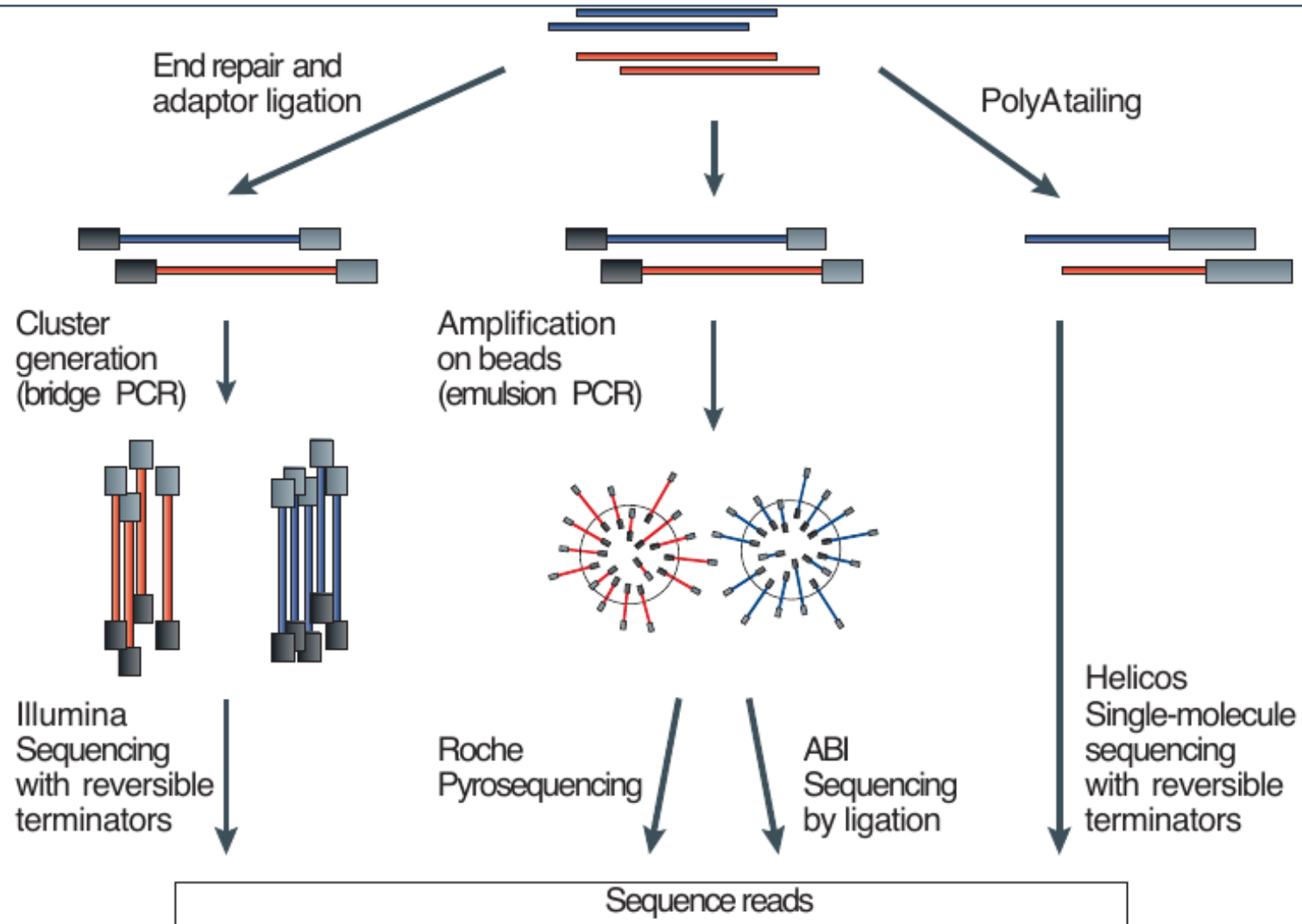
Furey (2012)

How ChIP-seq works



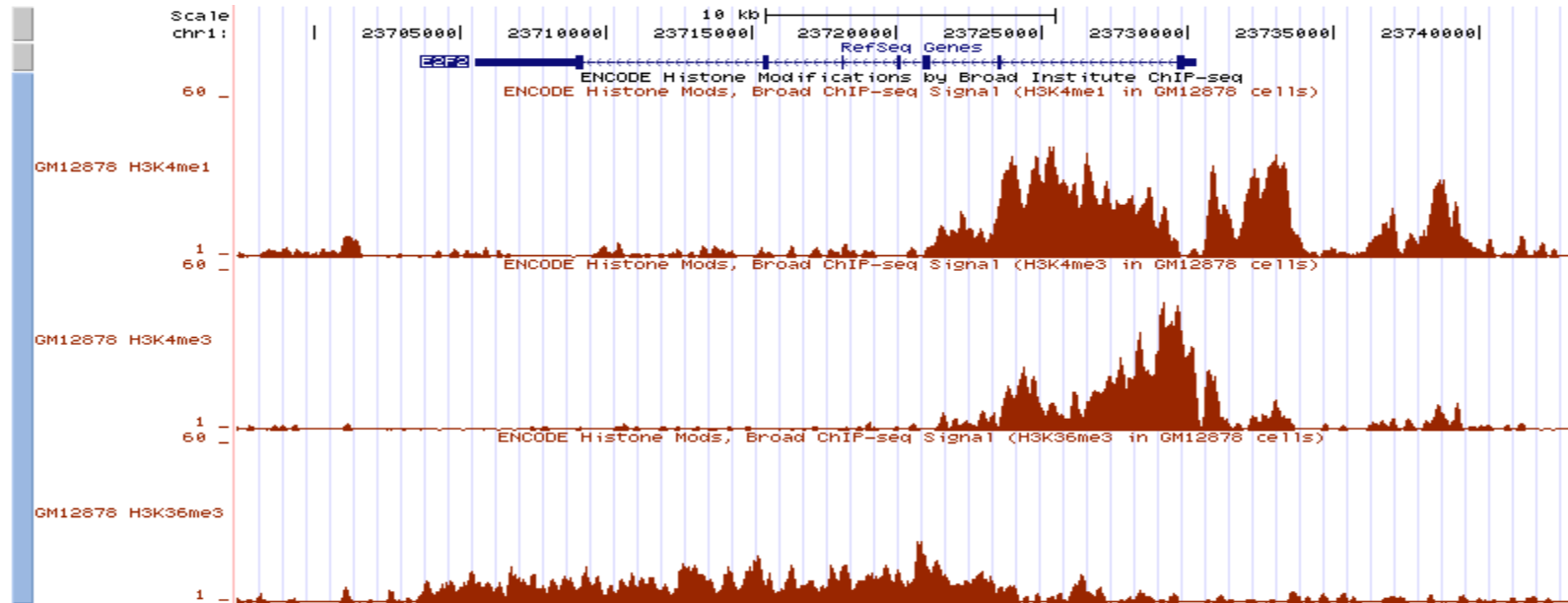
(Park 2009)

How ChIP-seq works



(Park 2009)

ChIP-Seq Histone Modifications: What the raw data looks like



- Each sequence tag is 30 base pairs long
- Tags are mapped to unique positions in the ~3 billion base reference genome
- Number of reads depends on sequencing depth. Typically on the order of 10 million mapped reads.

Quality control metrics

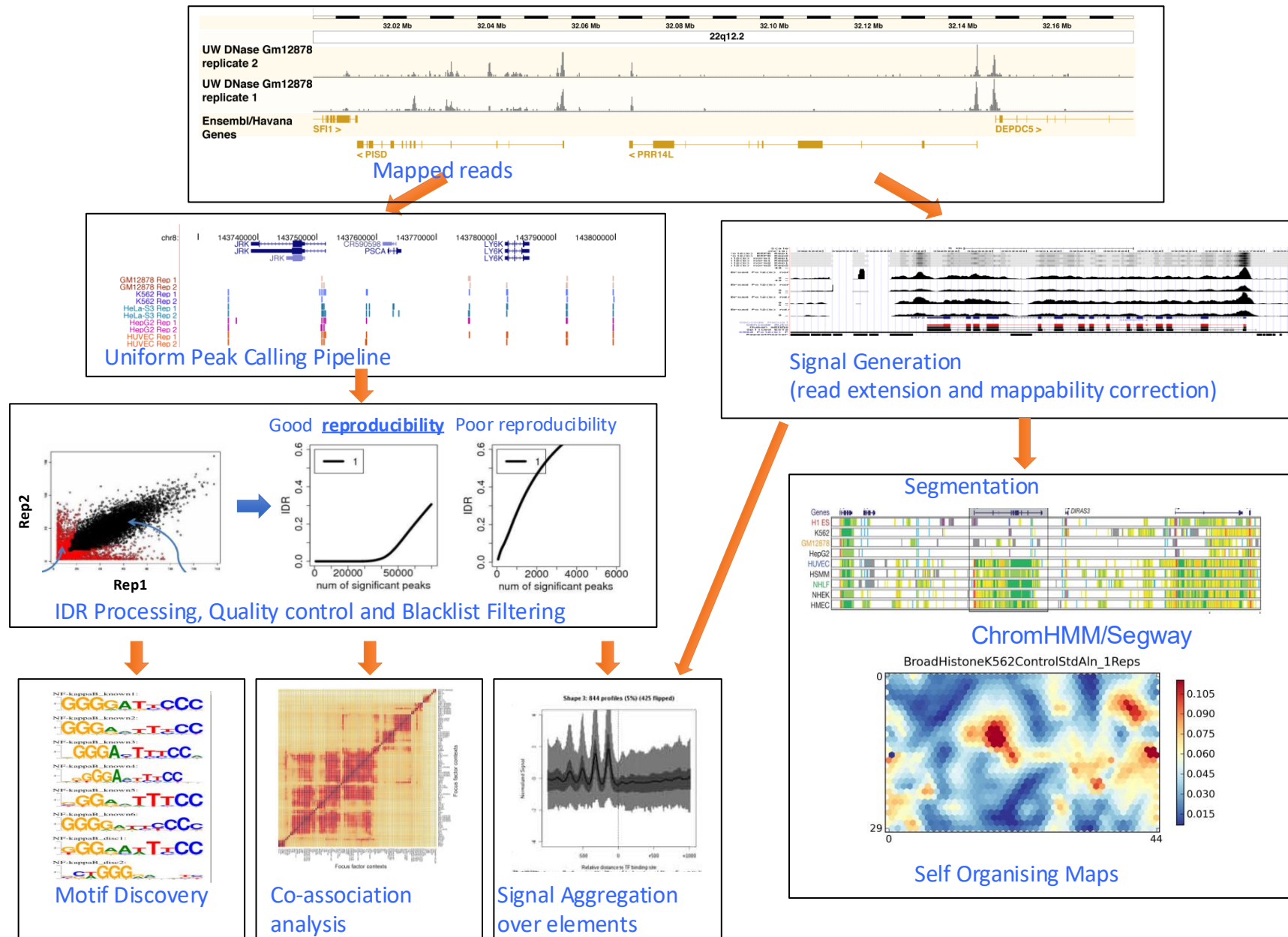
ChIP vs. Input DNA

Read quality

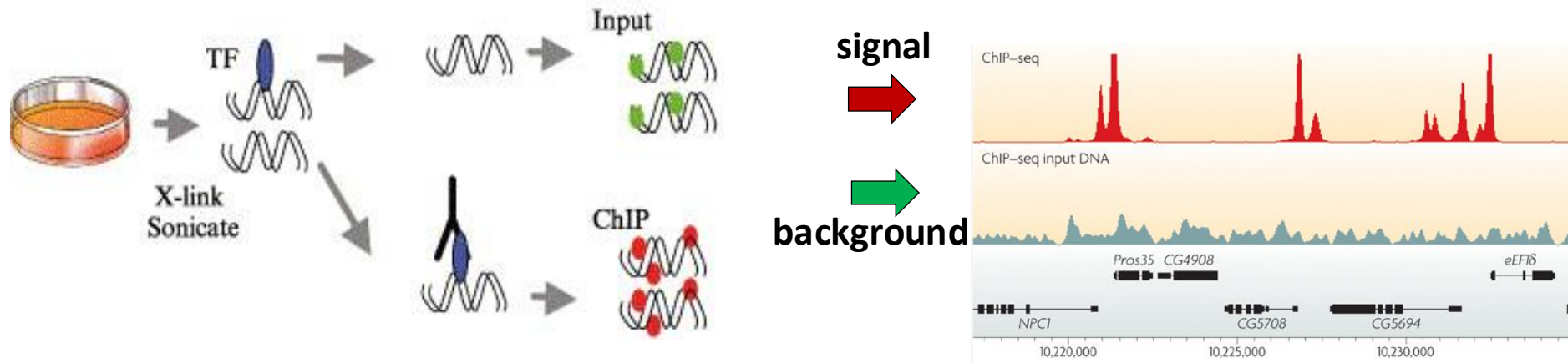
Mappability

Library complexity

ENCODE uniform processing pipeline



QC1: Use of input DNA as control dataset

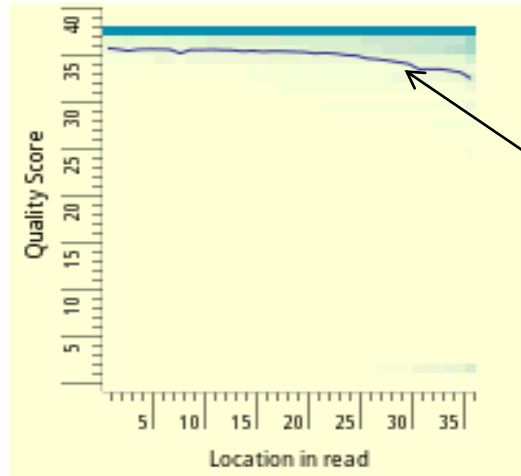


- **Challenge:**
 - Even without antibody: Reads are not uniformly scattered
- **Sources of bias in input dataset scatter:**
 - Non-uniform fragmentation of the genome
 - Open chromatin fragmented more easily than closed regions
 - Repetitive sequences over-collapsed in the assembled genome.
- **How to control for these biases:**
 - Remove portion of DNA sample before ChIP step
 - Carry out control experiment without an antibody (input DNA)
 - Fragment input DNA, sequence reads, map, use as background

QC2: Read-level sequencing quality score $Q > 10$

Read quality histograms

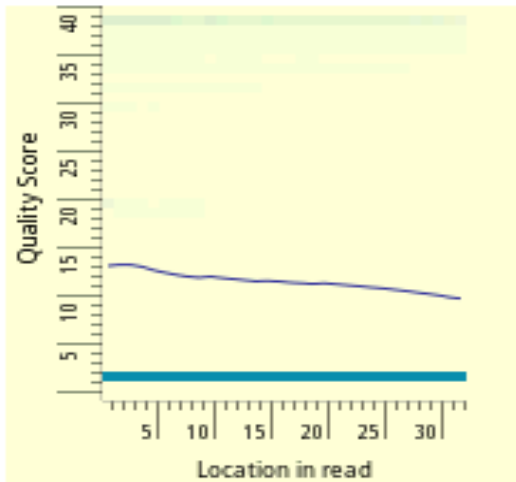
High quality reads



average base score
per position

- Each column is a color-coded histogram
- Encodes fraction of all mapped reads that have base score Q (y-axis) at each position (x-axis)
- Darker blue = higher density

Low quality reads

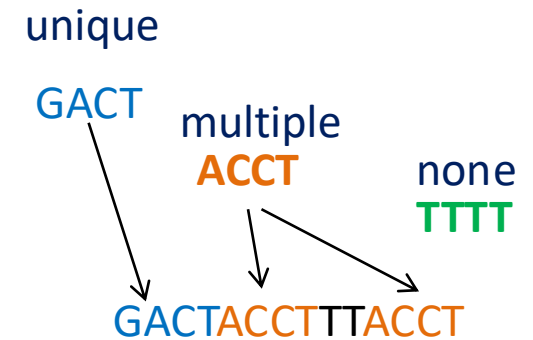


- Read quality tends to drop towards the ends of reads
- Low average per base score implies greater probability of mismappings.
- Typically, reject reads whose average score $Q < 10$

QC3: Fraction of short reads mapped >50%

Reads can map to:

- exactly one location (uniquely mapping)
- multiple locations (repetitive or multi-mapping)
- no locations (unmappable)



Dealing with multiply-mapping reads:

- Conservative approach: do not assign to any location
- Probabilistic approach: assign fractionally to all locations
- Pair-end approach: use paired end read to resolve ambiguities in repeat reads

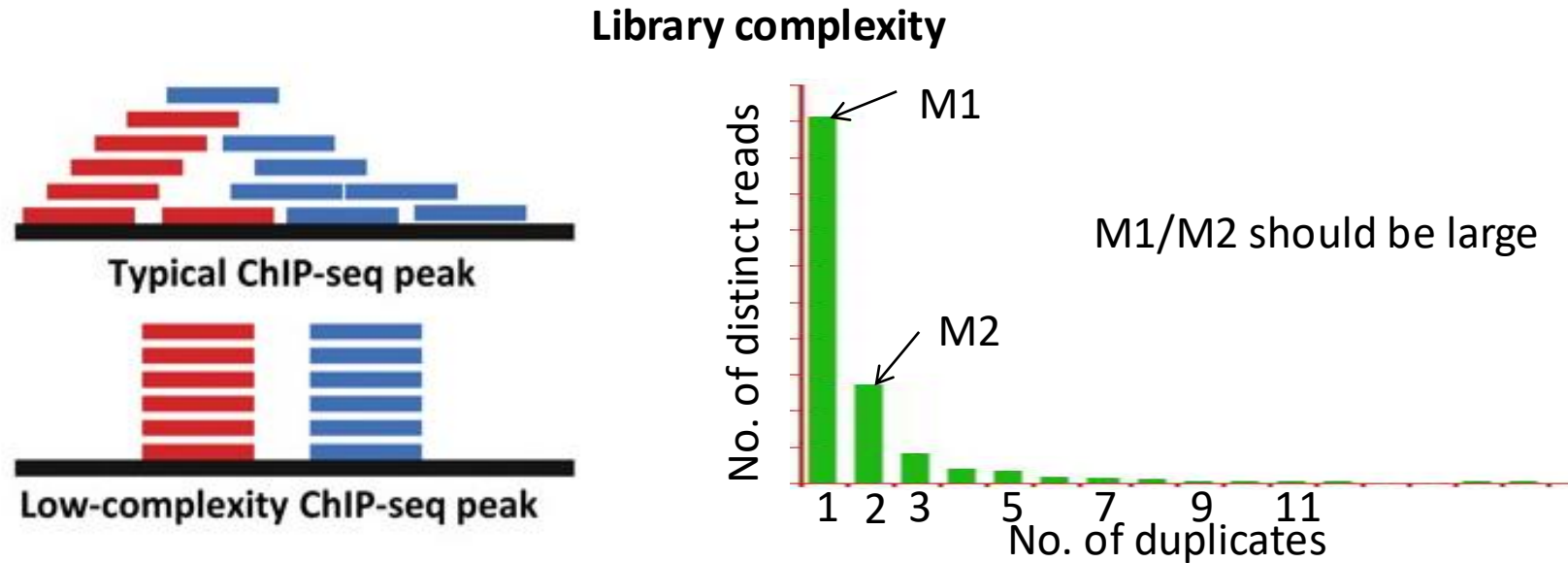
Absence of reads in a region could be due to:

- No assembly coverage in that region (e.g. peri-centromeric region)
- Too many reads mapping to this location (e.g. repetitive element)
- No activity observed in this location (e.g. inactive / quiescent / dead regions)

Dealing with mappability biases:

- 'Black-listed' regions, promiscuous across many datasets
- 'White-listed' regions, for which at least some dataset has unique reads

QC4: Library complexity: non-redundant fraction



How many distinct uniquely mapping read? How many duplicates?

If your sample does not contain sufficient DNA and/or you over-sequence, you will simply be repeatedly sequencing PCR duplicates of a restricted pool of distinct DNA fragments. This is known as a **low-complexity library** and is not desirable.

- **Histogram of no. of duplicates**
- Non-redundant fraction (NRF) =
$$\frac{\text{No. of 'distinct' unique-mapping reads}}{\text{No. of unique-mapping reads}}$$
- NRF should be > 0.8 when $10\text{M} < \text{\#reads} < 80\text{M}$ unique-mapping reads

Cross-correlation analysis

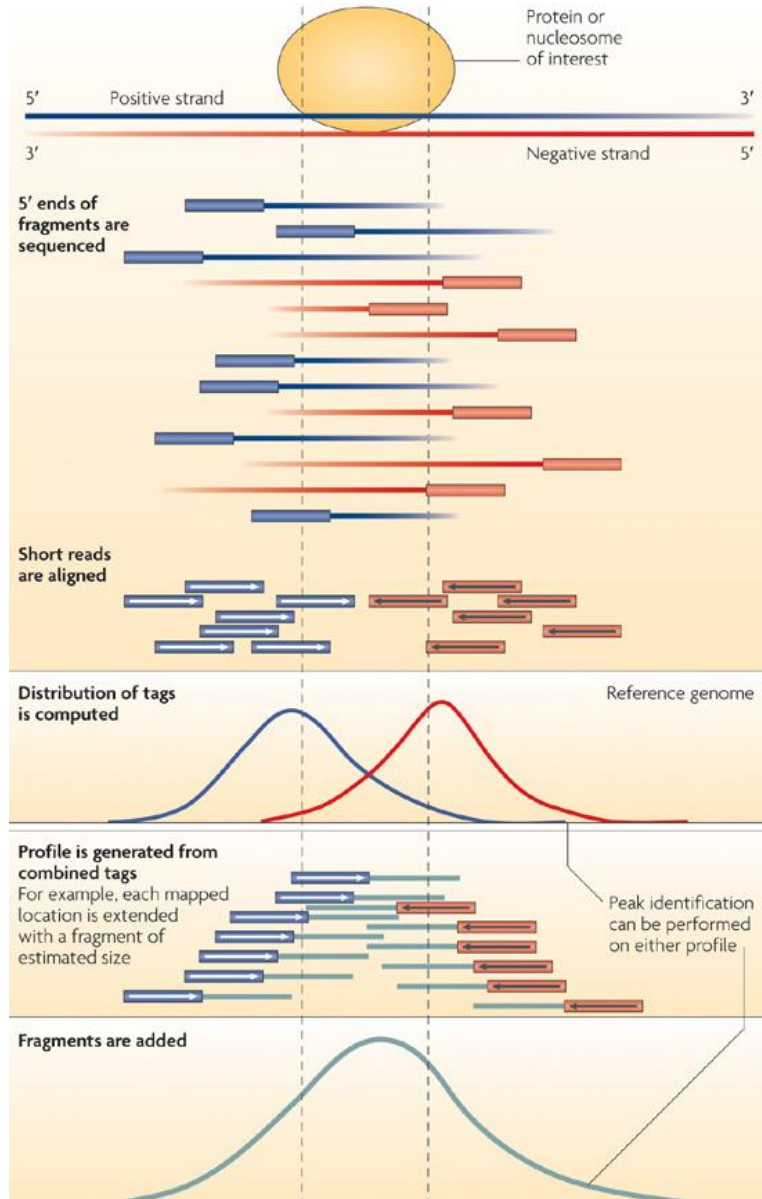
Exploiting forward and reverse reads

Fragment-length peak

Phantom read-length peak

ChIP-seq: exploiting forward and reverse reads

(Chromatin immunoprecipitation followed by sequencing)



Multiple IP fragments are obtained corresponding to each binding event

Ends of the fragments are sequenced i.e. "Short-reads/tags"

- Typically ~36 bp, 50 bp, 76 bp or 101 bp

Single-end (SE) sequencing

- Randomly sequence one of the ends of each fragment

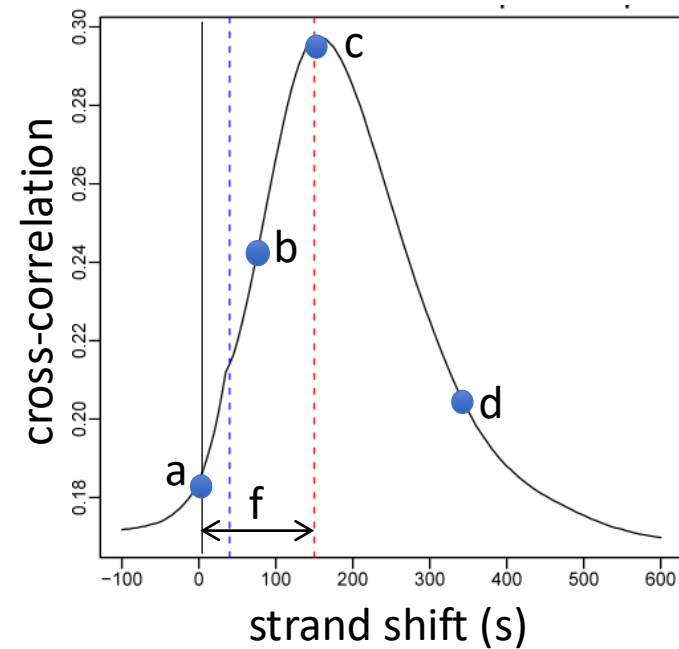
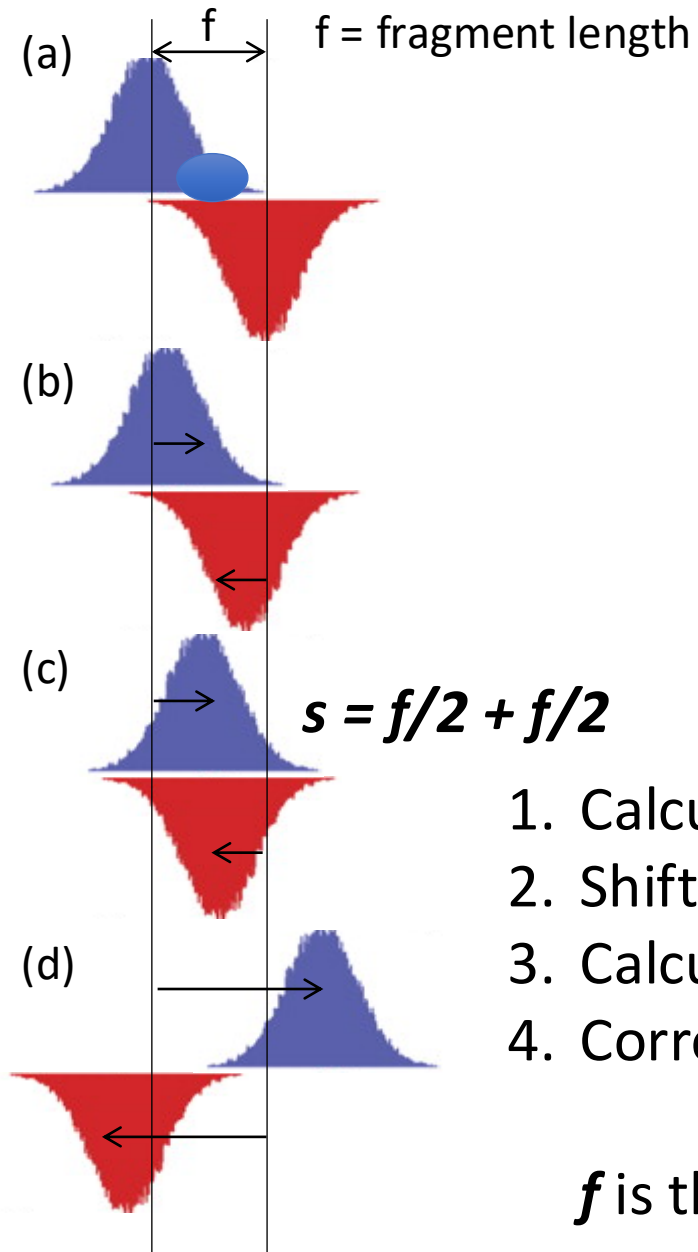
Paired-end (PE) sequencing

- sequence both ends of each fragment

Canonical "stranded mirror distribution of short-reads" after mapping reads to genome

- Heaps of reads on the **+ strand** and **- strand** separated by a distance $\sim$ fragment length

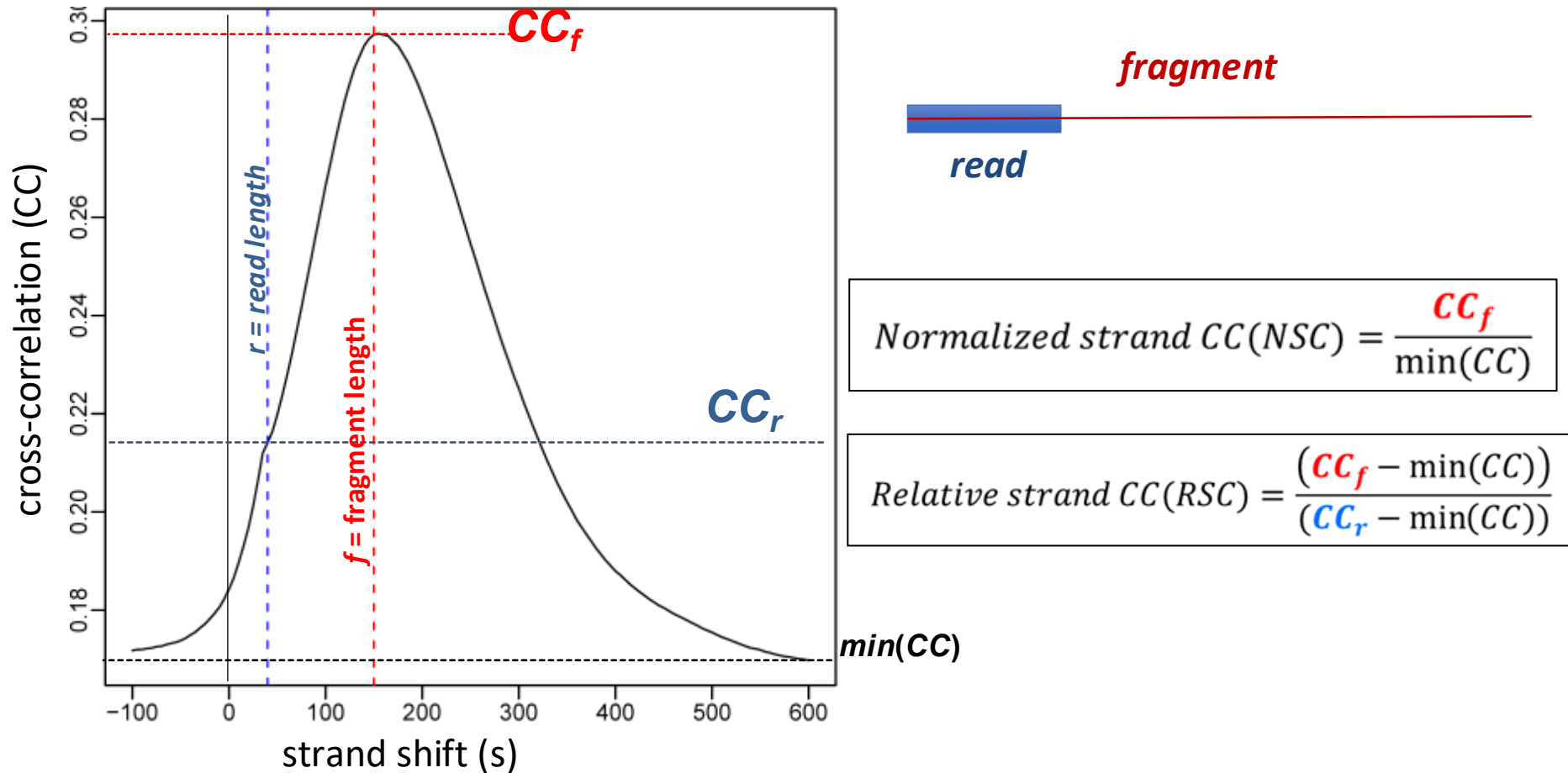
Strand cross-correlation (CC) analysis



1. Calculate forward and reverse strand signals
2. Shift both by specified offset towards each other
3. Calculate correlation of two signals at that shift
4. Correlation peaks at **fragment length** offset f

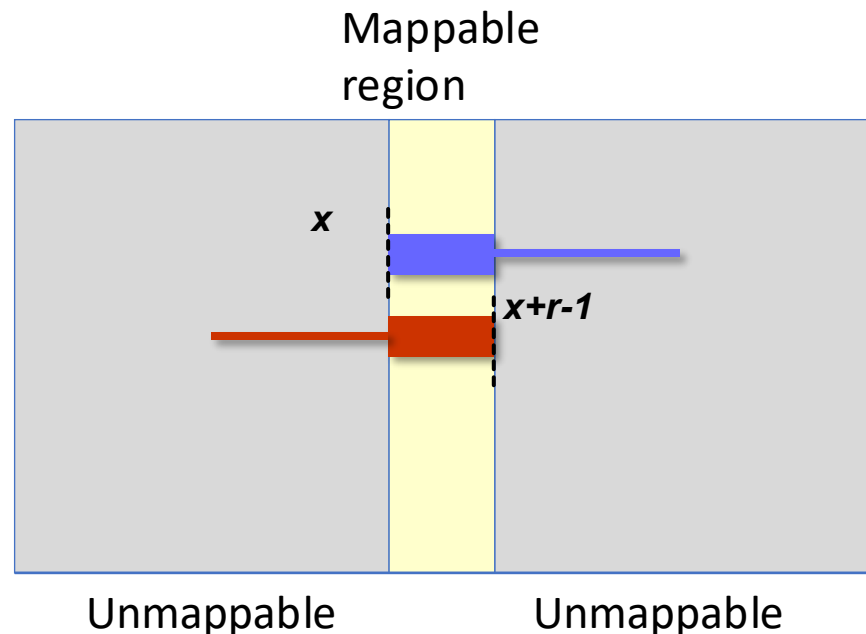
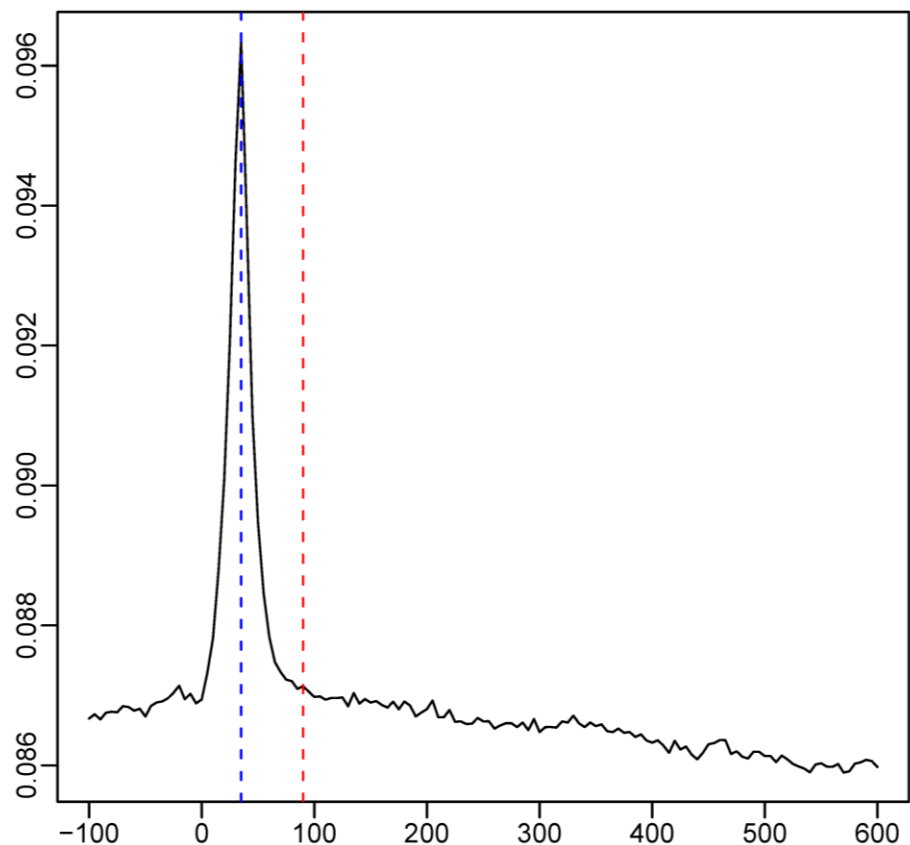
f is the length at which ChIP DNA is fragmented

Cross-correlation at *read* vs. *fragment* length



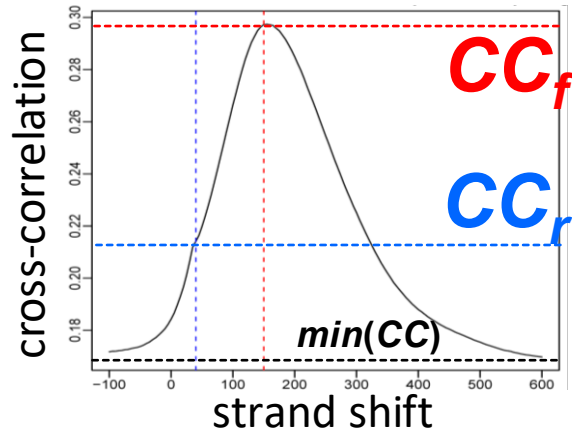
- Sign of a good dataset:
 - High absolute cross-correlation at *fragment* length (NSC)
 - High *fragment* length CC relative to *read* length CC (RSC)

Where does *read* cross-correlation come from?

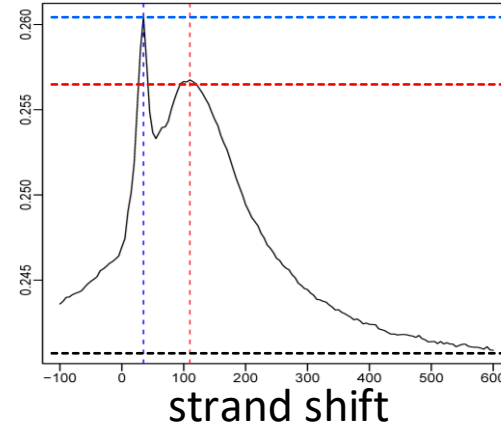


- Input dataset (no ChIP) shows 'phantom' peak at *read* length only
- Due to read mappability:
 - If position 'x' is uniquely mappable on + strand
 - Then position 'x+r-1' is uniquely mappable on – strand
- *Fragment*-length peak should always dominate the read-length peak

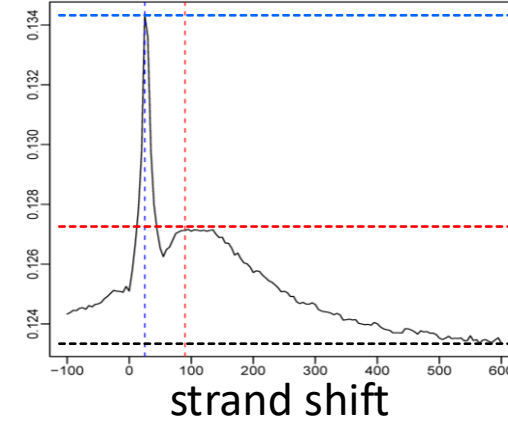
Example of good, medium, bad CC datasets



Highly quality



Medium quality



Low quality

$$\text{Normalized strand CC(NSC)} = \frac{CC_f}{\min(CC)}$$

$$\text{Relative strand CC(RSC)} = \frac{(CC_f - \min(CC))}{(CC_r - \min(CC))}$$

For highly enriched datasets, fragment length cross-correlation peak should be able to beat read-length phantom peak

RSC should be > 1

Peak calling: signal vs. background

Key idea: Find genomic regions with more reads than expected by chance

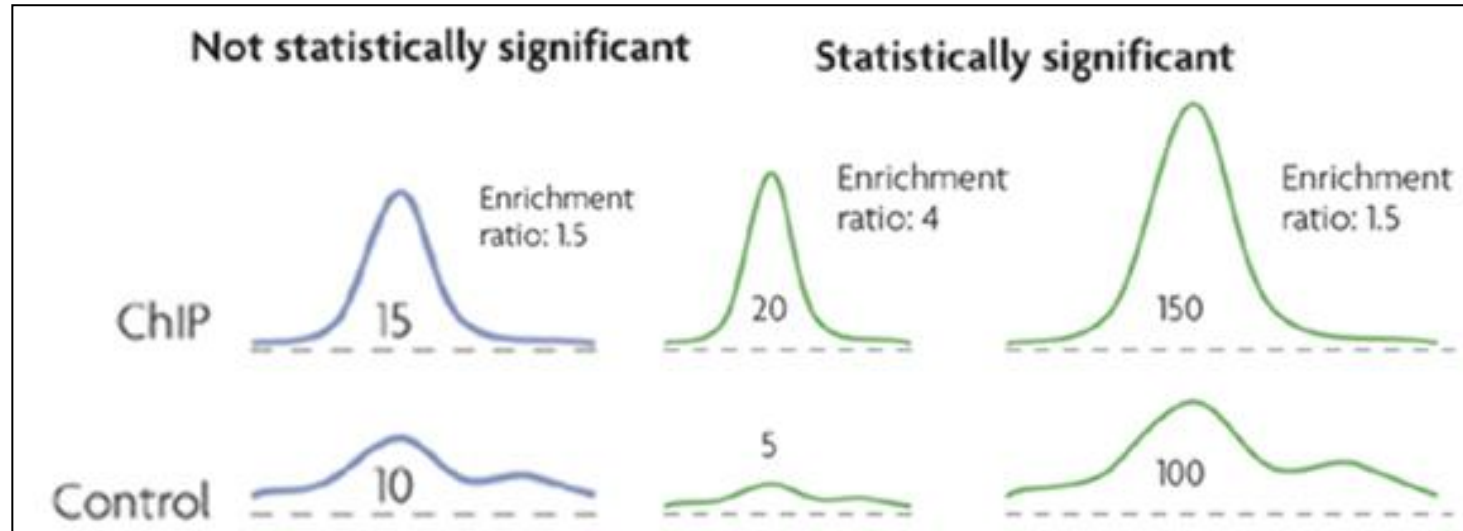
- Divide genome into bins (e.g., 200 bp)
- Count reads in each bin
- Compare ChIP vs Input (control)
- Statistical test: Is enrichment significant?

Common approaches:

- **MACS2:** Poisson model, local background
- **normR:** Binomial mixture model
- **DiffBind:** Differential binding analysis

Multiple testing: FDR correction across all bins!

Peak calling: detect regions of enrichment



Goal: Transform read counts into **normalized intensity signal**

Steps:

1. Estimate fragment-length f using strand cross-correlation analysis
2. Extend each read from 5' to 3' direction to fragment length f
3. Sum intensity for each base in 'extended reads' from both strands
4. Perform same operation on input-DNA control data (correct for sequencing depth differences)
5. Calculate enrichment ratio value for every position in the genome

Result: Enrichment fold difference for ChIP / control signal

Peak calling thresholds

Poisson p-value thresholds

- Read count model: Locally-adjusted' Poisson distribution

$$P(count = x) = \frac{\lambda_{local}^x \exp(-\lambda_{local})}{x!}$$

- $\lambda_{local} = \max(\lambda_{BG}, [\lambda_{1k}, \lambda_{5k}, \lambda_{10k}])$ estimated from control data
- Poisson p -value = $P(count \geq x)$
- q -value : Multiple hypothesis correction

Peaks: Genomic locations that pass a user-defined p -value (e.g. $1e-5$) or q -value (e.g. 0.01) threshold

Empirical False discovery rates

- Swap ChIP and input-DNA tracks
- Recompute p -values
- At each p -value, eFDR = Number of control peaks / Number of ChIPpeaks
- Use an FDR threshold to call peaks

Issues with peak calling thresholds

Cannot set a universal threshold for empirical FDRs and p-values

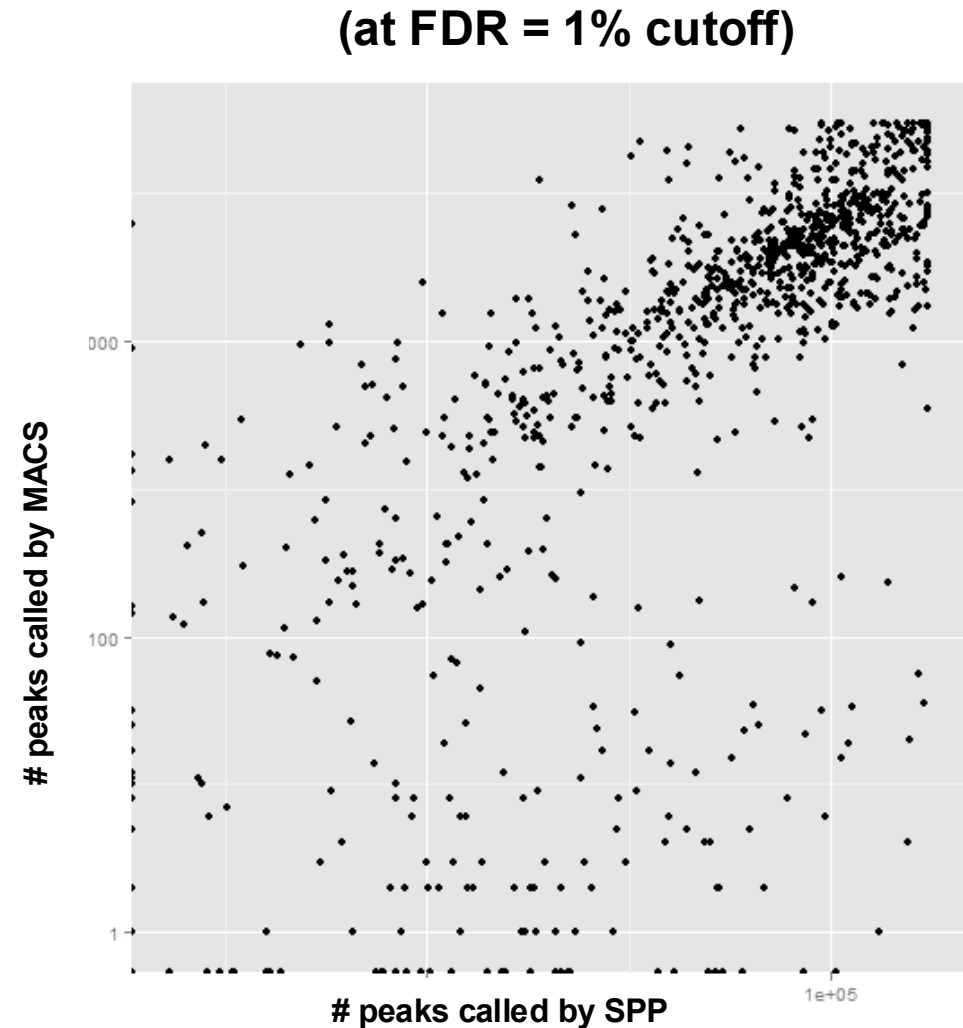
- Depends on ChIP and input sequencing depth
- Depends on binding ubiquity of factor
- Stronger antibodies get an advantage

FDRs quite unstable

- Small changes in threshold => massive changes in peak numbers

Difficult to compare results across peak callers with a fixed threshold

- Different methods to compute eFDR or q-values



ChIP-seq Peak Calling Exercise

```
library(AnnotationHub)
library(rtracklayer)

data_dir <- "../data/chipseq/"
dir.create(data_dir, showWarnings = FALSE, recursive = TRUE)

chr <- "chr21" # Focus on chr21 to keep data manageable

# Download ENCODE CTCF ChIP peaks
peaks_file <- paste0(data_dir, "ctcf_gm12878_peaks.rds")
if.needed(peaks_file, {
  cat("Downloading ENCODE CTCF peaks...\n")
  ah <- AnnotationHub()
  query_peaks <- query(ah, c("CTCF", "GM12878", "narrowPeak", "ENCODE"))
  chip_peaks_all <- query_peaks[[1]]
  chip_peaks <- chip_peaks_all[seqnames(chip_peaks_all) == chr]
  saveRDS(chip_peaks, file = peaks_file)
})
chip_peaks <- readRDS(peaks_file)
```

ChIP-seq Peak Calling Exercise

```
# Download ENCODE DNase-seq peaks (open chromatin for comparison)
dnase_file <- paste0(data_dir, "dnase_gm12878_peaks.rds")
if (!file.exists(dnase_file)) {
  cat("Downloading ENCODE DNase-seq data...\n")
  ah <- AnnotationHub()
  query_dnase <- query(ah, c("DNase", "GM12878", "narrowPeak", "ENCODE"))
  if (length(query_dnase) > 0) {
    dnase_peaks_all <- query_dnase[[1]]
    dnase_peaks <- dnase_peaks_all[seqnames(dnase_peaks_all) == chr]
    saveRDS(dnase_peaks, file = dnase_file)
    cat(sprintf("Saved %d DNase peaks\n", length(dnase_peaks)))
  } else {
    cat("No DNase data found\n")
    saveRDS(GRanges(), file = dnase_file)
  }
}
dnase_peaks <- readRDS(dnase_file)
```

Peak Calling with normr

```
## Create genomic bins
binsize <- 1000
bins <- GRanges(chr, IRanges(start = seq(1, 48e6, binsize),
                               width = binsize))

## Count reads in bins
chip_counts <- countOverlaps(bins, chip_reads)
dnase_counts <- countOverlaps(bins, dnase_reads)

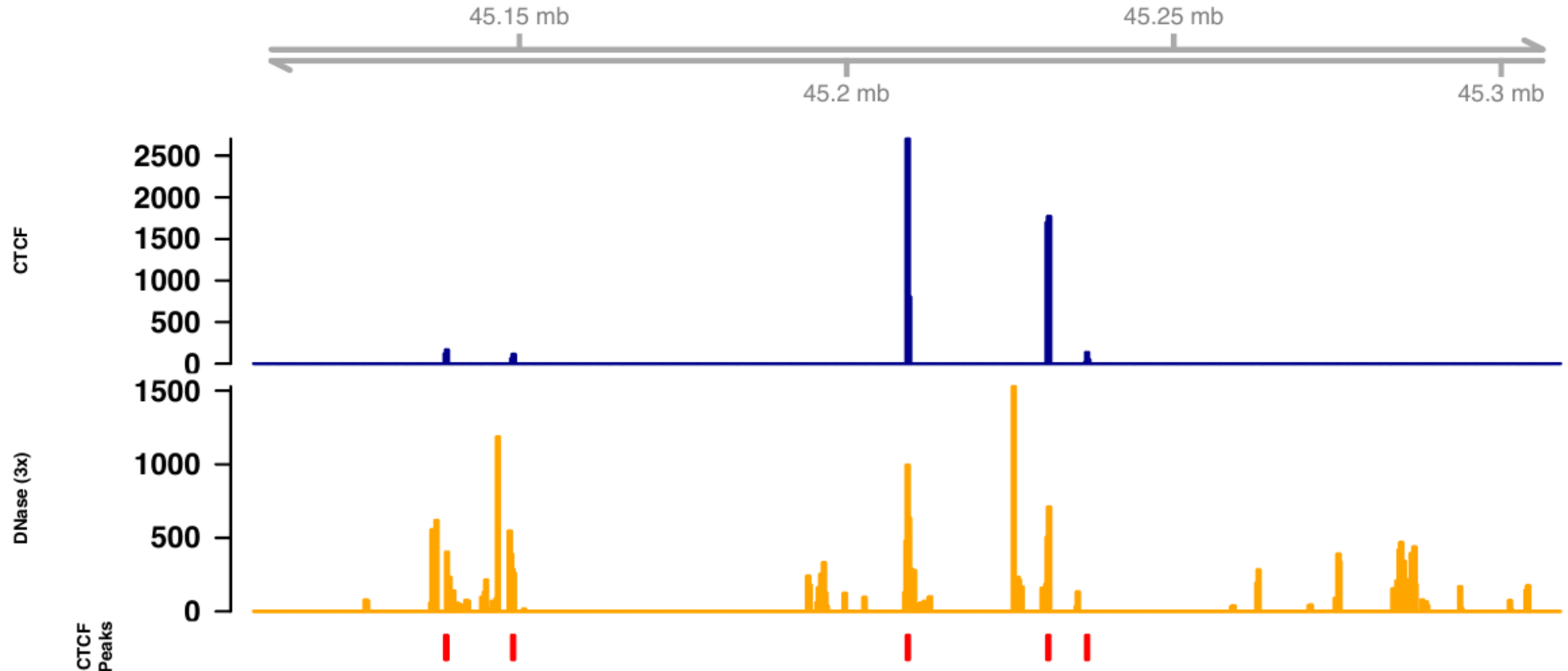
## Call peaks using normR
fit <- normr::enrichR(treatment = chip_counts,
                     control = dnase_counts,
                     genome = bins,
                     verbose = FALSE)

## Get significant peaks (FDR < 0.05)
peaks_called <- normr::getRanges(fit)
peaks_sig <- peaks_called[peaks_called$qvalue < 0.05]
```

- Foreground (CTCF) vs. background (control, DNase)
- Enrichment-based Binomial Tests
- Input: piled signals
- Output: genomic regions (BED)
- Narrow vs. broad peaks

Visualizing CTCF Binding Sites (using Gviz)

CTCF ChIP-seq on chr21:45,109,226-45,309,226



Selecting meaningful peaks using reproducibility

Use peak ranks in replicate experiments

IDR: Irreproducible Discovery Rate

<http://anshul.kundaje.net/projects/idr>

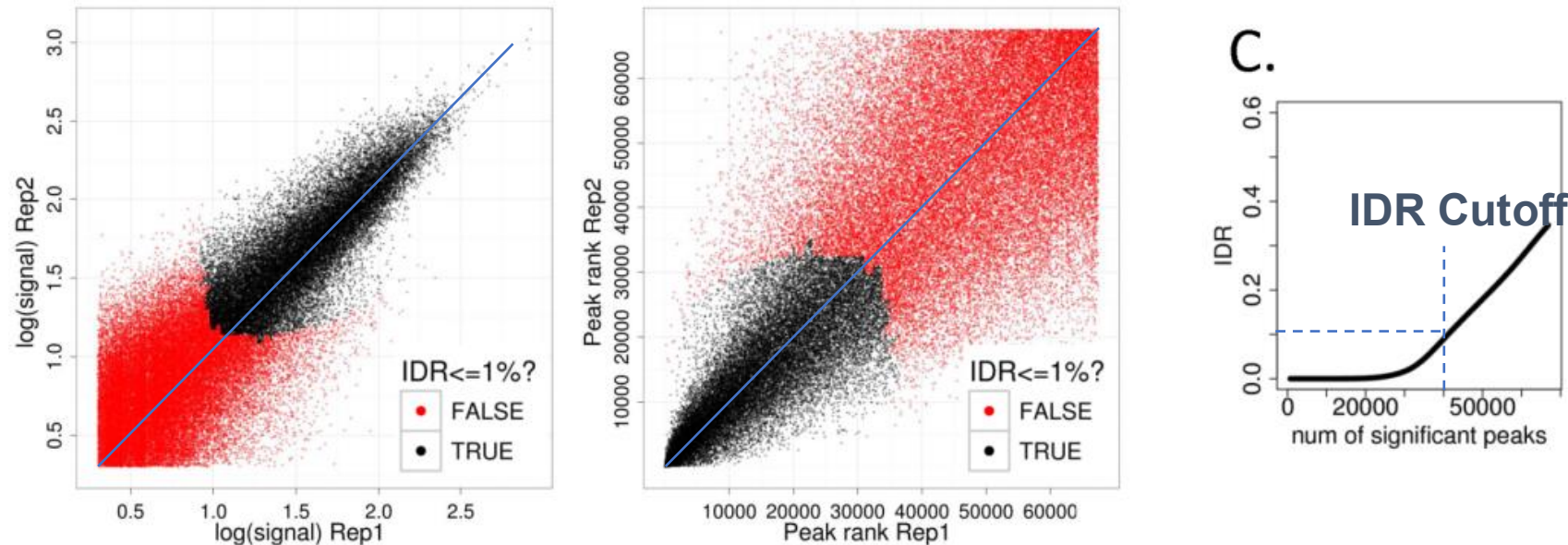
A. Kundaje, Q. Li , B. Brown, J. Rozowsky, S. Wilder, M. Gerstein, I. Dunham, E. Birney, P. Bickel

How to combine two replicates



- Challenge:
 - Replicates show small differences in peak heights
 - Many peaks in common, but many are unique
- Problem with simple solutions:
 - Union: too lenient, keeps garbage from both
 - Intersection: too stringent, throws away good peaks
 - Sum: does not exploit independence of two datasets

IDR idea: Exploit peak rank similarity in replicates



- Key idea: True peaks will be highly ranked in both replicates
 - Keep going down rank list, until ranks are no longer correlated
 - This cutoff could be different for the two replicates
 - The actual peaks included may differ between replicates
- Adaptively learn optimal peak calling threshold
 - **FDR** threshold of 10% $\rightarrow$ 10% of peaks are false (widely used)
 - **IDR** threshold of 10% $\rightarrow$ 10% of peaks are not reproducible

The IDR model: A two component mixture

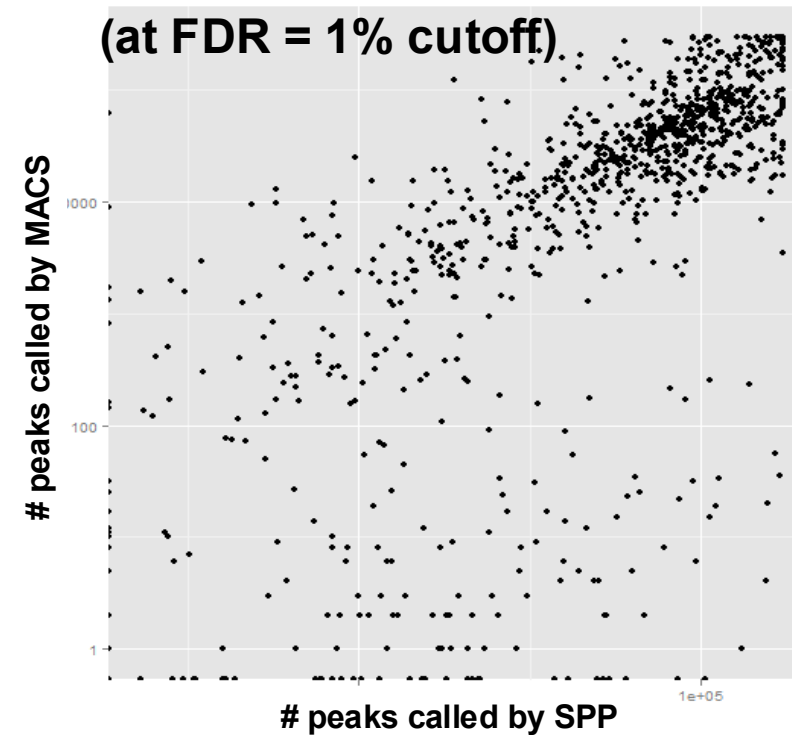
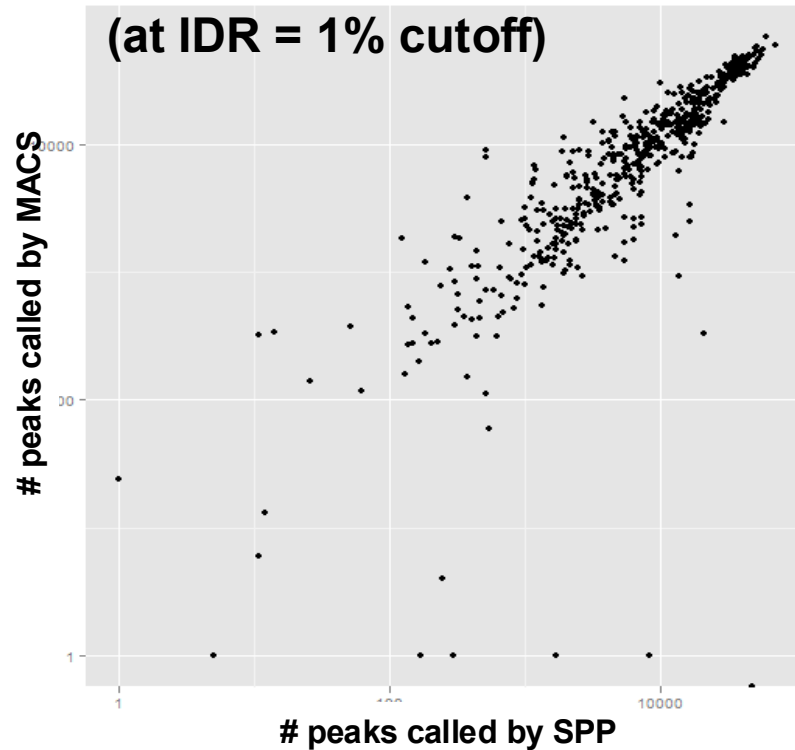
- Looking only at ranks means that the marginals are uniform, so all the information is encoded in the joint distribution.
- Model the joint distribution of ranks as though it came from a two component Gaussian mixture model:

$$(x, y) \sim pN(\mu, \mu, \sigma, \sigma, \rho) + (1 - p)N(0, 0, 1, 1, 0)$$

- This can be fit via an EM-like algorithm.

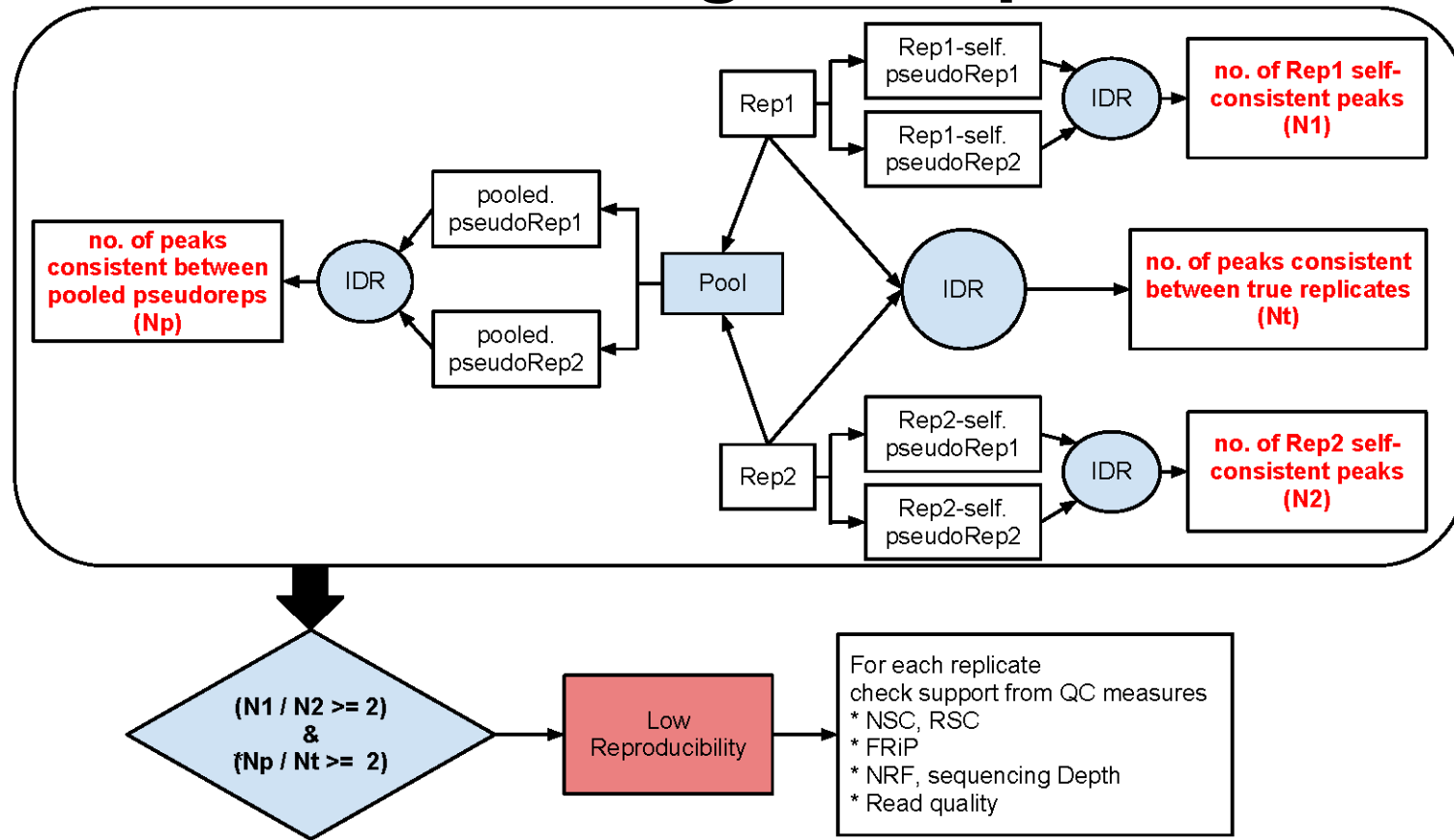
IDR leads to higher consistence between peak callers

IDR = Irreproducible Discovery Rate FDR = False Discovery Rate



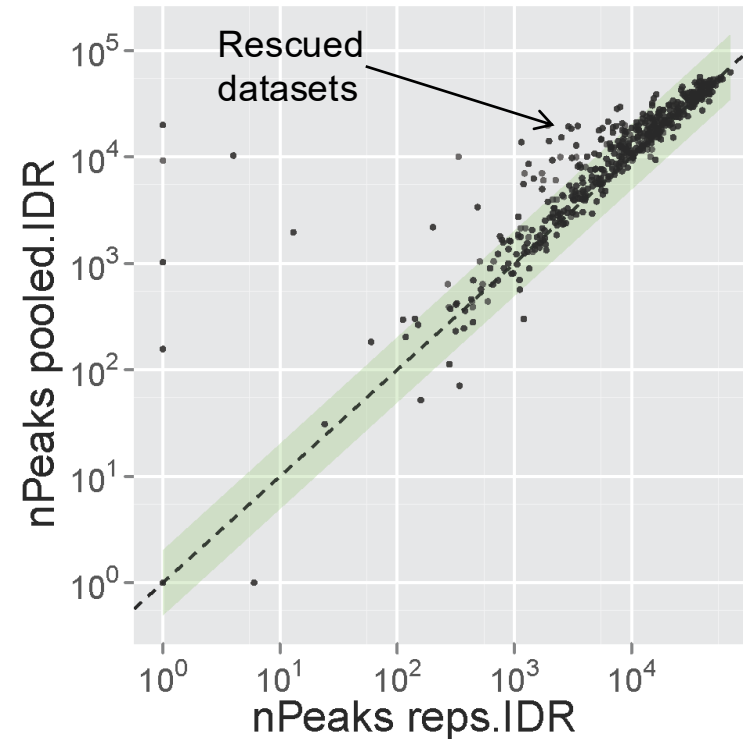
- Compare number of peaks found by two different peak callers
- IDR thresholds are far more robust and comparable than FDR
- FDR only relies on enrichment over input, IDR exploits replicates

What if we don't have good replicates?



- IDR pipeline uses replicates when they are available
 - IDR pipeline also evaluates each replicate individually
 - Pooling strategy to generate pseudo-replicates
- ➔ Can pin-point 'bad' replicates that may lead to low reproducibility
- ➔ Can estimate IDR thresholds when replicates are not available

Only one good replicate: Pseudo-replicates



- IDR pipeline can be used to rescue datasets with only one good replicate (using pseudo-replicates)
- IDR pipeline can also be used to call optimal thresholds on a dataset with a single replicate (e.g. when there isn't enough material to perform multiple reps)

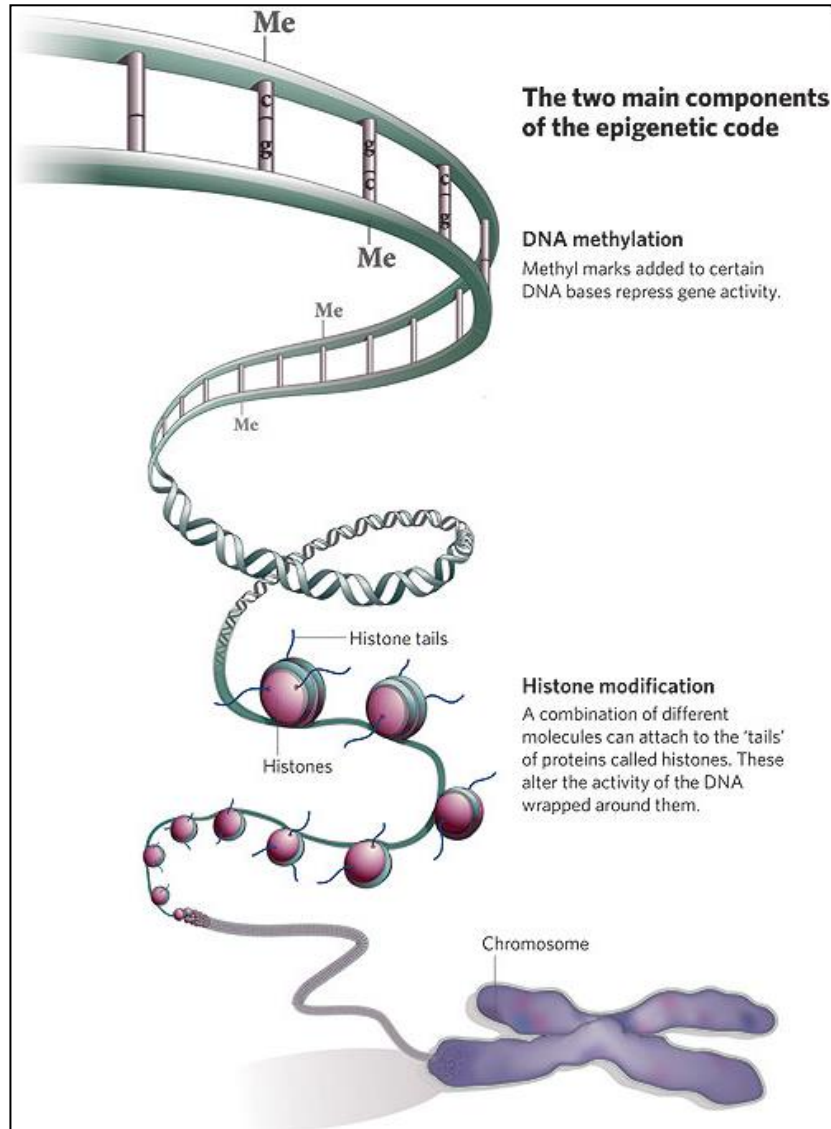
Key Concepts from ChIP-seq Peak Calling

- **Biological:** ChIP-seq identifies protein-DNA binding sites
- **Statistical** models:
 - Poisson/Binomial models for count data
 - Local background estimation
 - Multiple testing correction (FDR)
- **Computational** pipeline:
 - Millions of bins → massive multiple testing problem
 - Need efficient algorithms (MACS2, normr)
- **Quality control:**
 - Peak width distribution (sharp vs broad)
 - Fraction of reads in peaks (FRiP score)
 - Replicate concordance

Today's lecture

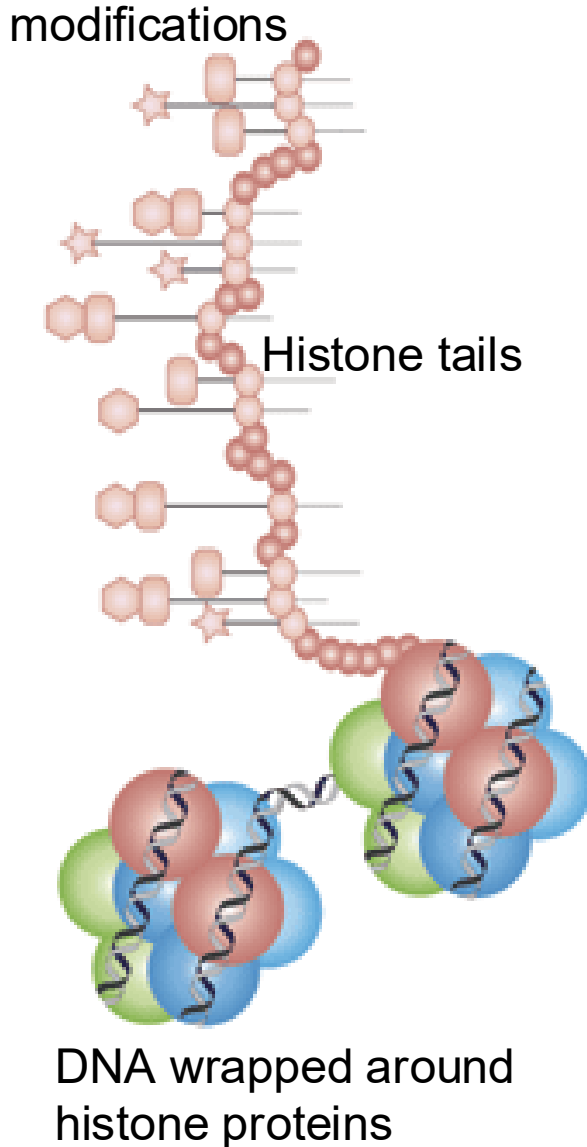
- 1 Technologies for measuring regulatory activities
- 2 DNA Methylation (credit: Keegan Korthauer)
- 3 Multiomic Data Integration with Regulatory Genomics

Chromatin signatures for genome annotation



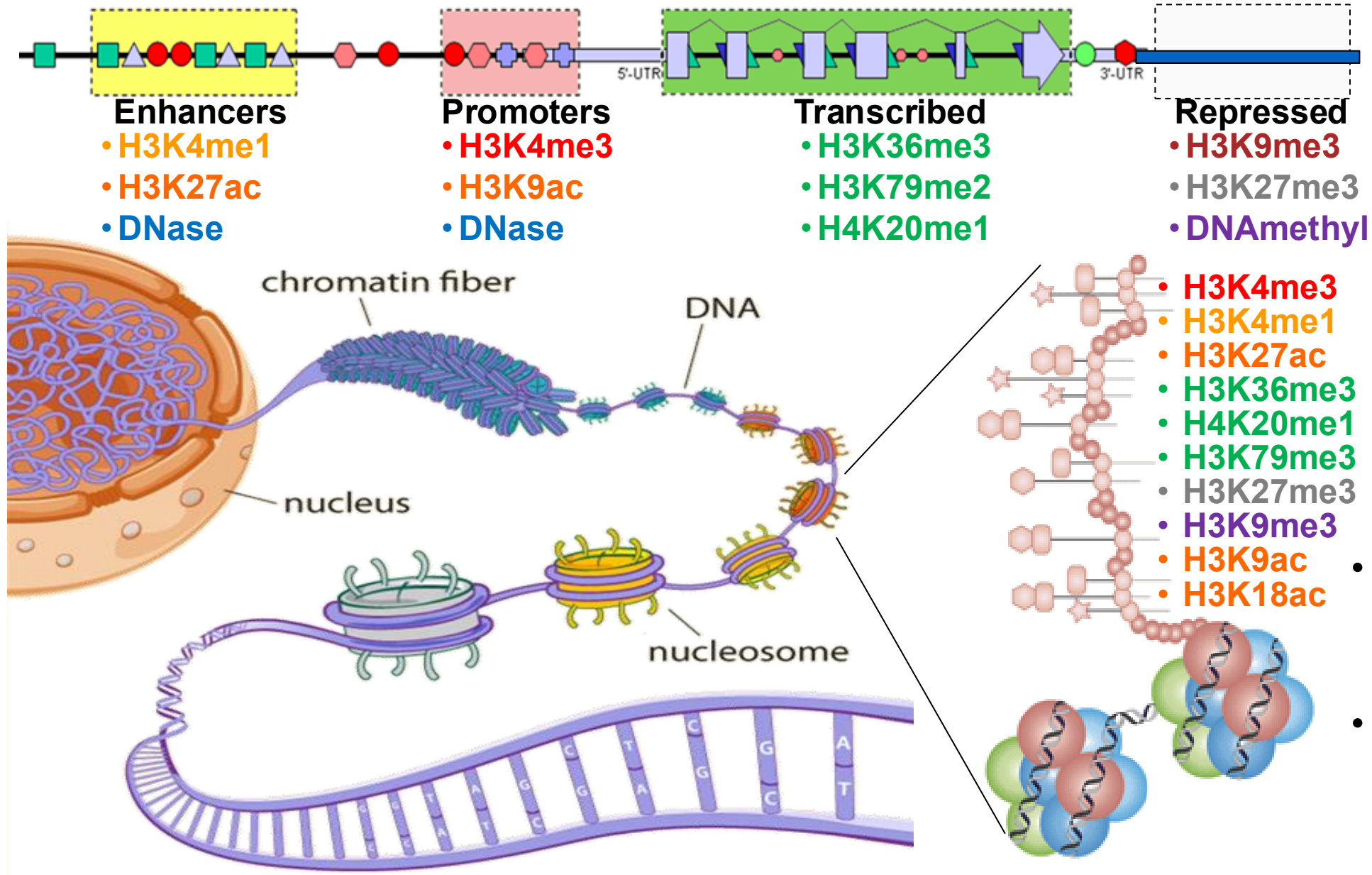
- **Challenges**
 - Dozens of marks
 - Complex combinatorics
 - Diversity and dynamics
- **Histone code hypothesis**
 - Distinct function for distinct combinations of marks?
 - Both additive and combinatorial effects
- **How do we find biologically relevant ones?**
 - Unsupervised approach
 - Probabilistic model
 - Explicit combinatorics

100s of histone tail modifications



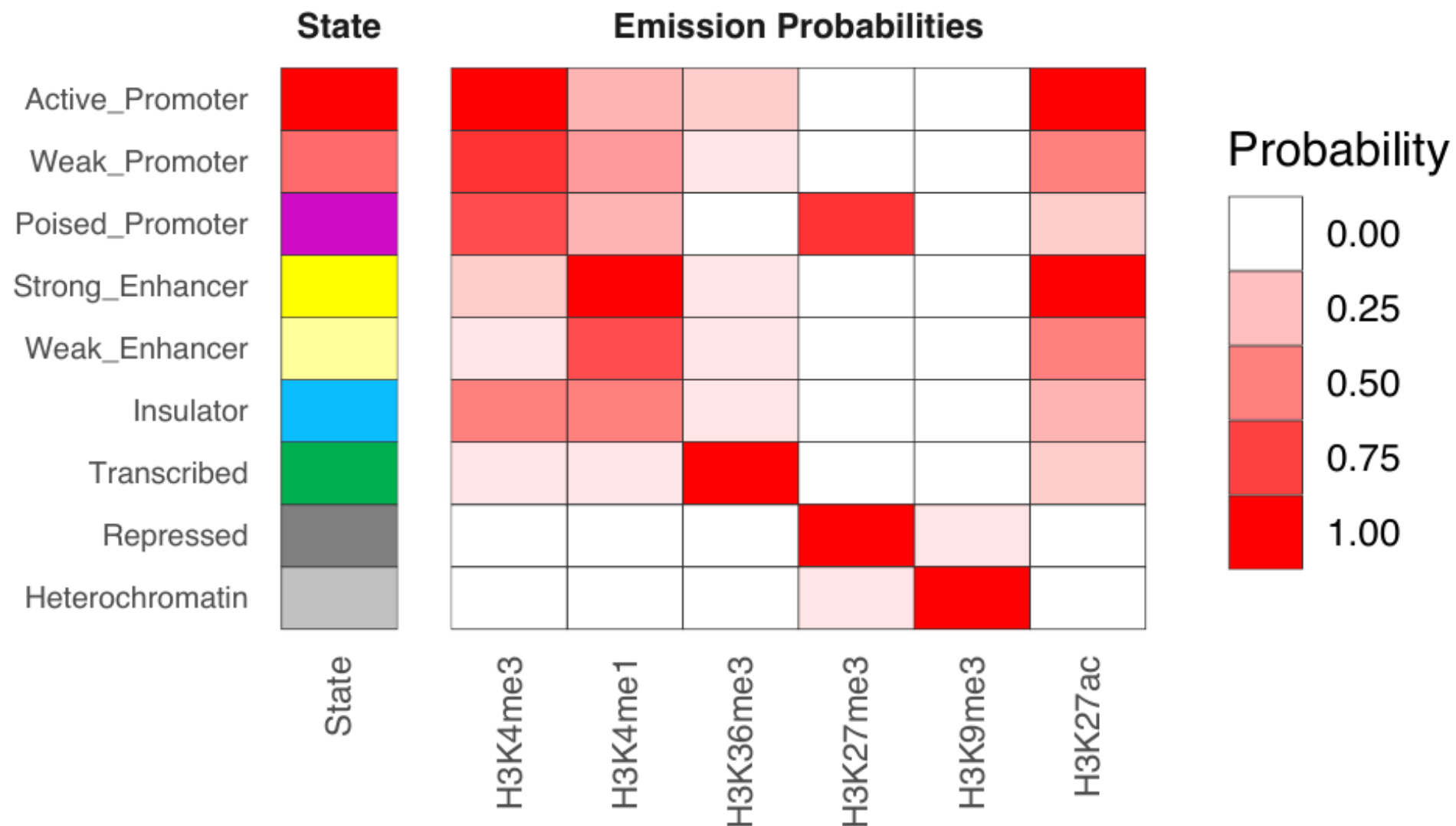
- 100+ different histone modifications
 - Histone protein → H3/H4/H2A/H2B
 - AA residue → Lysine4(K4)/K36...
 - Chemical modification → Met/Pho/Ubi
 - Number → Me-Me-Me(me3)
 - Shorthand: H3K4me3, H2BK5ac
- In addition:
 - DNA modifications
 - Methyl-C in CpG / Methyl-Adenosine
 - Nucleosome positioning
 - DNA accessibility
- The constant struggle of gene regulation
 - TF/histone/nucleo/GFs/Chrom compete

Combinations of marks encode epigenomic state



- 100s of known modifications, many new still emerging
- Systematic mapping using ChIP-, Bisulfite-, DNase-Seq

ChromHMM: Emission Probabilities



ChromHMM: Integrating Multiple Histone Marks

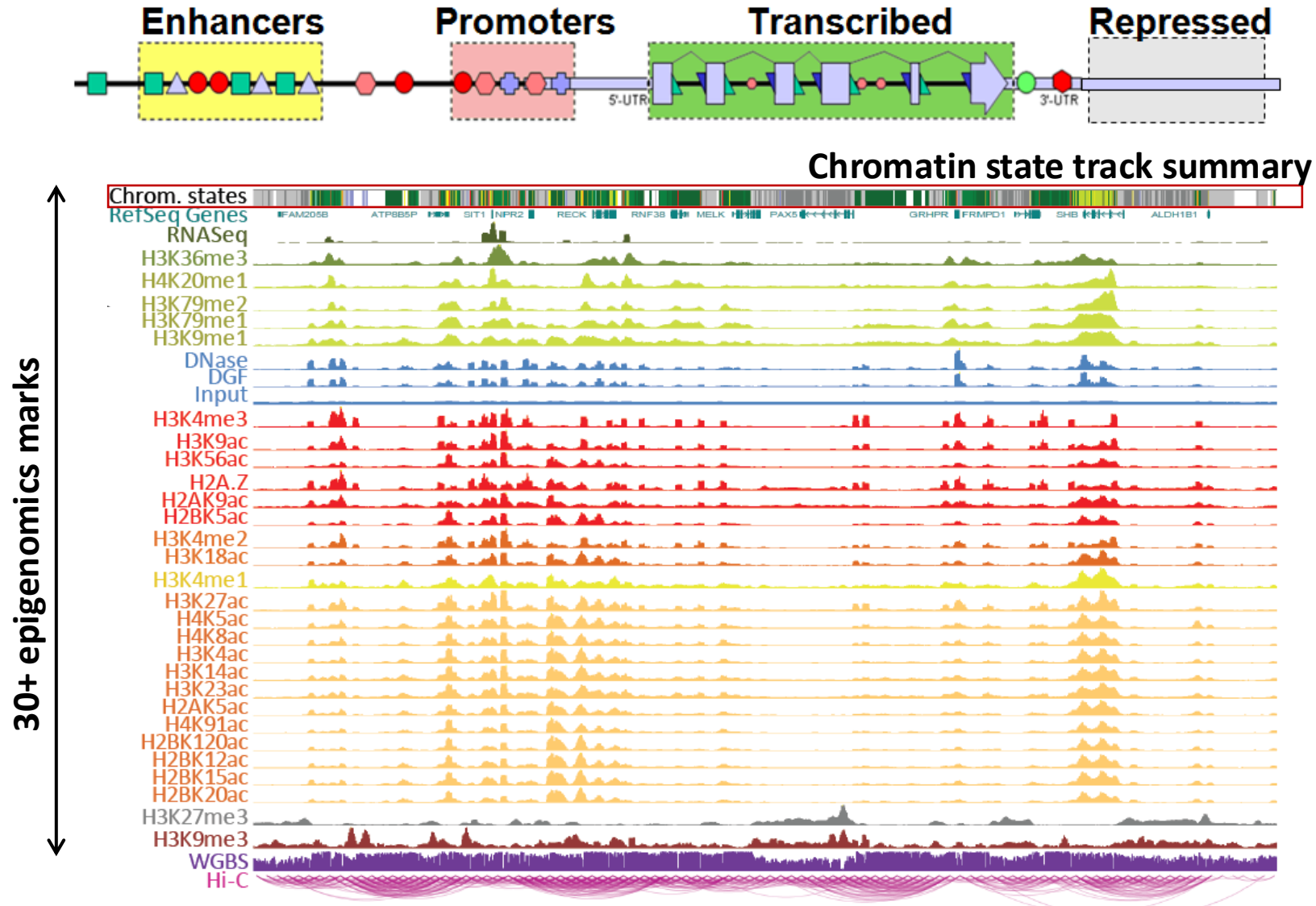
How it works:

- Input: Multiple histone modification ChIP-seq signals
- Model: Hidden Markov Model learns chromatin states
- Each state defined by emission probabilities (previous slide)
- Output: Genome segmented into functional states

In our genome browser:

- ChromHMM track shows where each state occurs
- CTCF peaks often coincide with specific states (insulators, enhancers)

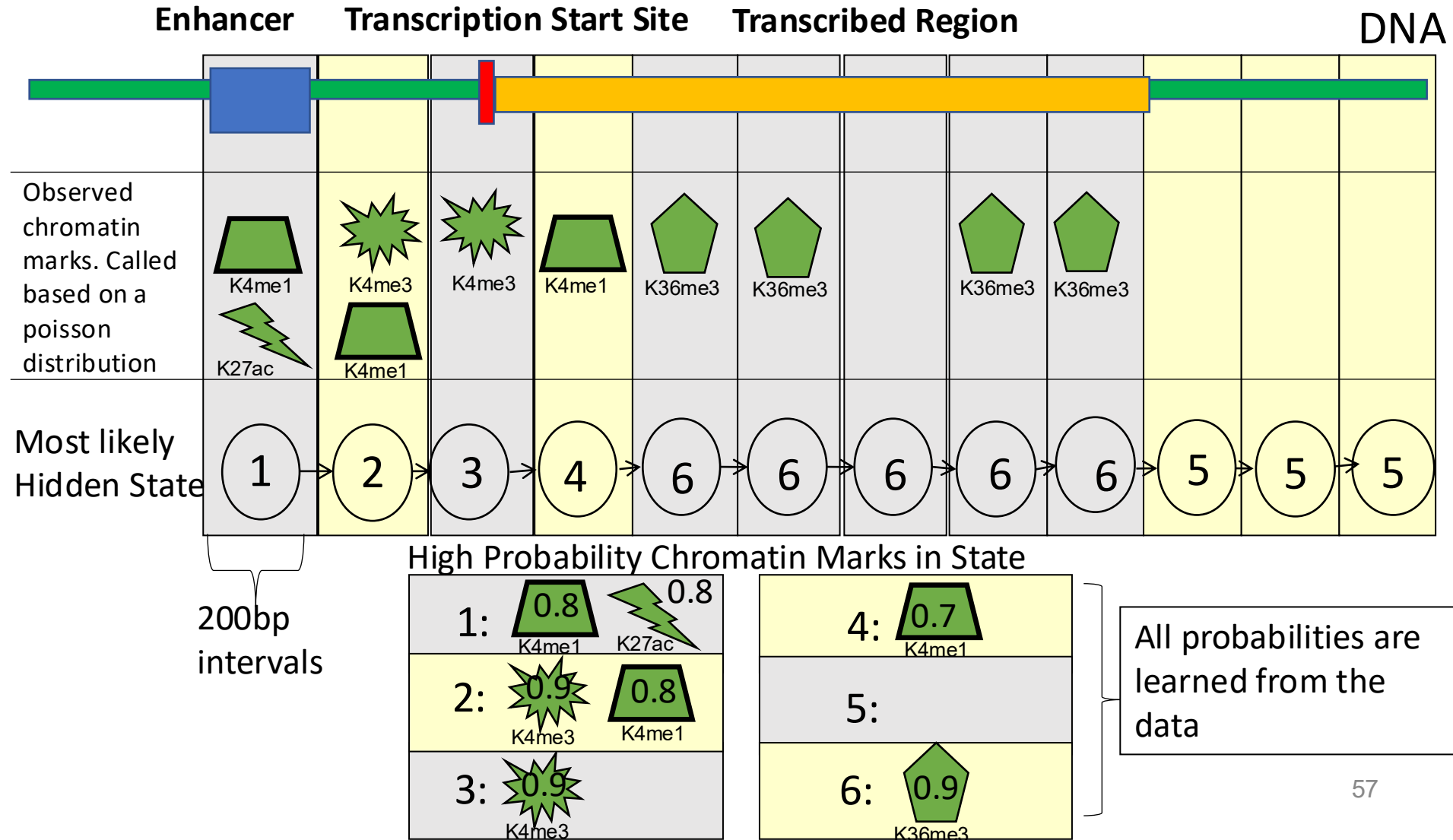
Summarize multiple marks into chromatin states



WashU Epigenome Browser

ChromHMM: multi-variate hidden Markov model

Multivariate HMM for Chromatin States



57

ENCODE: Study nine marks in nine human cell lines

9 marks

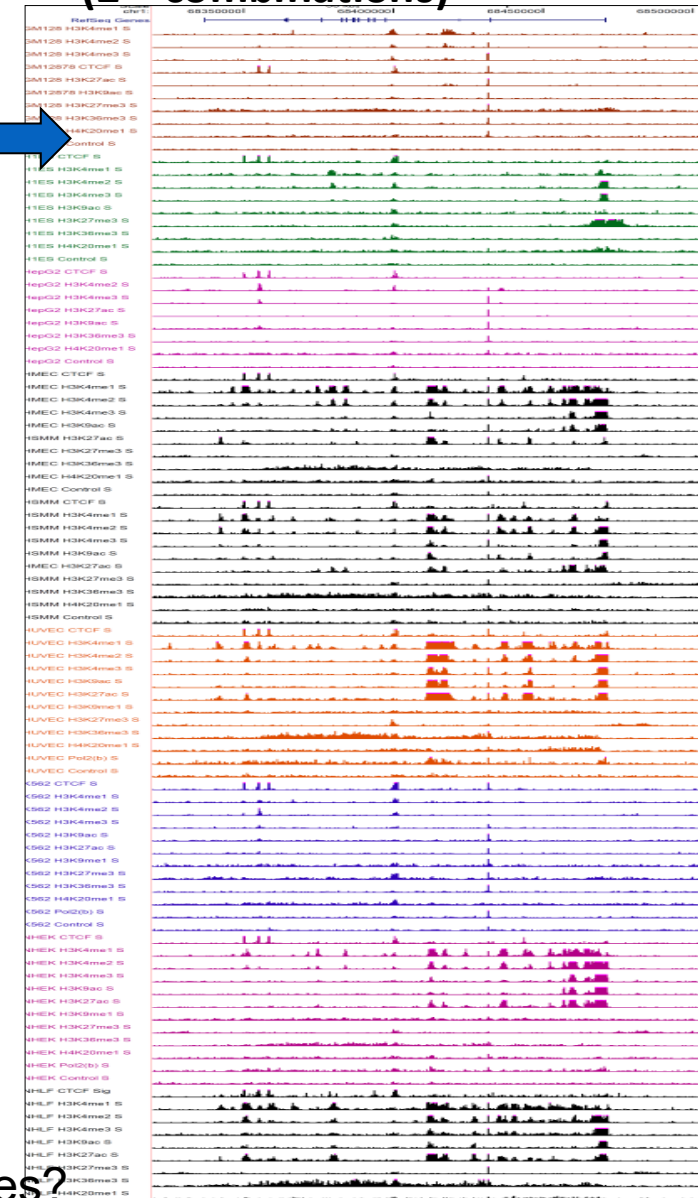
H3K4me1
H3K4me2
H3K4me3
H3K27ac
H3K9ac
H3K27me3
H4K20me1
H3K36me3
CTCF
+WCE
+RNA

9 human cell types

HUVEC	Umbilical vein endothelial
NHEK	Keratinocytes
GM12878	Lymphoblastoid
K562	Myelogenous leukemia
HepG2	Liver carcinoma
NHLF	Normal human lung fibroblast
HMEC	Mammary epithelial cell
HSMM	Skeletal muscle myoblasts
H1	Embryonic

X

81 Chromatin Mark Tracks
(2^8 combinations)



Brad Bernstein ENCODE Chromatin Group

b.

State	CTCF	H3K27me3	H3K36me3	H4K20me1	H3K4me1	H3K4me2	H3K4me3	H3K27ac	H3K9ac	WCE
1	16	2	2	6	17	93	99	96	98	2
2	12	2	6	9	53	94	95	14	44	1
3	13	72	0	9	48	78	49	1	10	1
4	11	1	15	11	96	99	75	97	86	4
5	5	0	10	3	88	57	5	84	25	1
6	7	1	1	3	58	75	8	6	5	1
7	2	1	2	1	56	3	0	6	2	1
8	92	2	1	3	6	3	0	0	1	1
9	5	0	43	43	37	11	2	9	4	1
10	1	0	47	3	0	0	0	0	0	1
11	0	0	3	2	0	0	0	0	0	0
12	1	27	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0
13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
14	22	28	19	41	6	5	26	5	13	37
15	85	85	91	88	76	77	91	73	85	78

Chromatin Mark Observation Frequency (%)

How to learn single set of chromatin states?

ENCODE: Study 9 marks in nine human cell lines

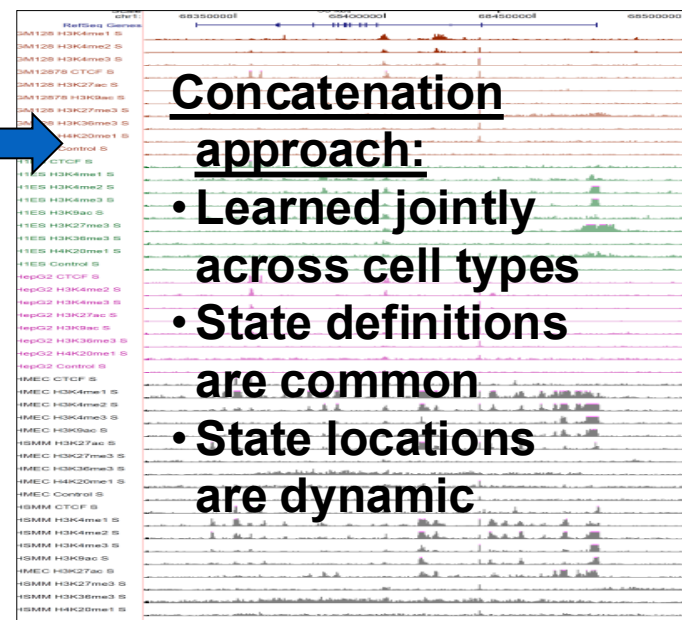
9 marks

H3K4me1
H3K4me2
H3K4me3
H3K27ac
H3K9ac
H3K27me3
H4K20me1
H3K36me3
CTCF
+WCE
+RNA

X

HUVEC	Umbilical vein endothelial
NHEK	Keratinocytes
GM12878	Lymphoblastoid
K562	Myelogenous leukemia
HepG2	Liver carcinoma
NHLF	Normal human lung fibroblast
HMEC	Mammary epithelial cell
HSMM	Skeletal muscle myoblasts
H1	Embryonic

81 Chromatin Mark Tracks

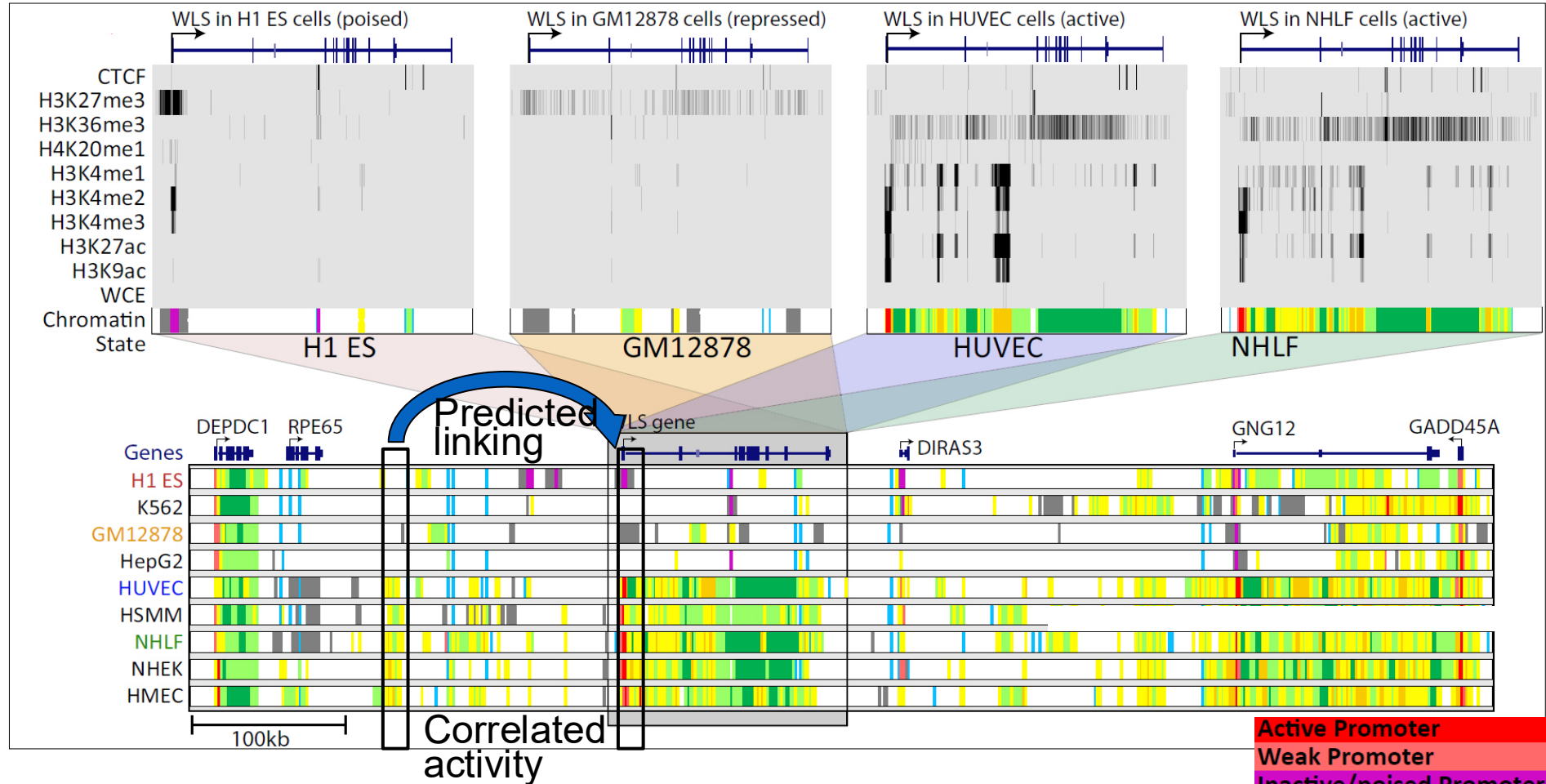


Brad Bernstein ENCODE Chromatin

b.

Chromatin States	State	Chromatin Mark Observation Frequency (%)									Coverage			Median Length	+/-2kb TSS	Conserved non-exon	DNase (K562)	C-Myc (K562)	NF-kB (GM12878)	Transcript	Nuclear Lamina (NHLF)	Candidate state annotation
		CTCF	H3K27me3	H3K36me3	H4K20me1	H3K4me1	H3K4me2	H3K4me3	H3K27ac	H3K9ac	WCE	Median	H1 ES	GM								
1	16	2	2	6	17	93	99	96	98	2	0.6	0.5	1.2	1.0	83	3.8	23.3	82.0	40.7	0.2	0.15	Active Promoter
2	12	2	6	9	53	94	95	14	44	1	0.5	1.2	1.3	0.4	58	2.8	15.3	12.6	5.8	0.6	0.30	Weak Promoter
3	13	72	0	9	48	78	49	1	10	1	0.2	4.0	1.0	0.6	49	4.3	10.8	3.1	1.0	0.4	0.68	Inactive/poised Promoter
4	11	1	15	11	96	99	75	97	86	4	0.7	0.1	1.1	0.6	23	2.7	23.1	31.8	49.0	1.3	0.05	Strong enhancer
5	5	0	10	3	88	57	5	84	25	1	1.2	0.2	0.7	0.6	3	1.8	13.6	6.3	15.8	1.4	0.10	Strong enhancer
6	7	1	1	3	58	75	8	6	5	1	0.9	1.3	1.0	0.2	17	2.4	11.9	5.7	7.0	1.1	0.31	Weak/poised enhancer
7	2	1	2	1	56	3	0	6	2	1	1.9	1.2	1.1	0.4	4	1.5	5.1	0.6	2.4	1.3	0.20	Weak/poised enhancer
8	92	2	1	3	6	3	0	0	1	1	0.5	1.4	1.0	0.4	3	1.5	12.8	2.5	1.2	1.1	0.61	Insulator
9	5	0	43	43	37	11	2	9	4	1	0.7	1.3	1.0	0.8	4	1.1	4.5	0.7	0.8	2.4	0.02	Transcriptional transition
10	1	0	47	3	0	0	0	0	0	1	4.3	0.6	1.2	3.0	1	0.9	0.3	0.0	0.0	2.5	0.11	Transcriptional elongation
11	0	0	3	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	12.5	1.3	0.8	2.6	2	0.9	0.3	0.0	0.1	1.9	0.24	Weak transcribed
12	1	27	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	4.1	0.3	0.7	2.8	5	1.4	0.3	0.0	0.1	0.8	0.63	Polycomb-repressed
13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	71.4	1.0	1.0	10.0	1	0.9	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.7	1.30	Heterochrom; low signal
14	22	28	19	41	6	5	26	5	13	37	0.1	0.9	1.2	0.6	3	0.4	1.9	0.3	0.2	0.4	1.44	Repetitive/CNV
15	85	85	91	88	76	77	91	73	85	78	0.1	0.9	1.0	0.2	1	0.2	5.9	9.5	7.4	0.4	1.30	Repetitive/CNV

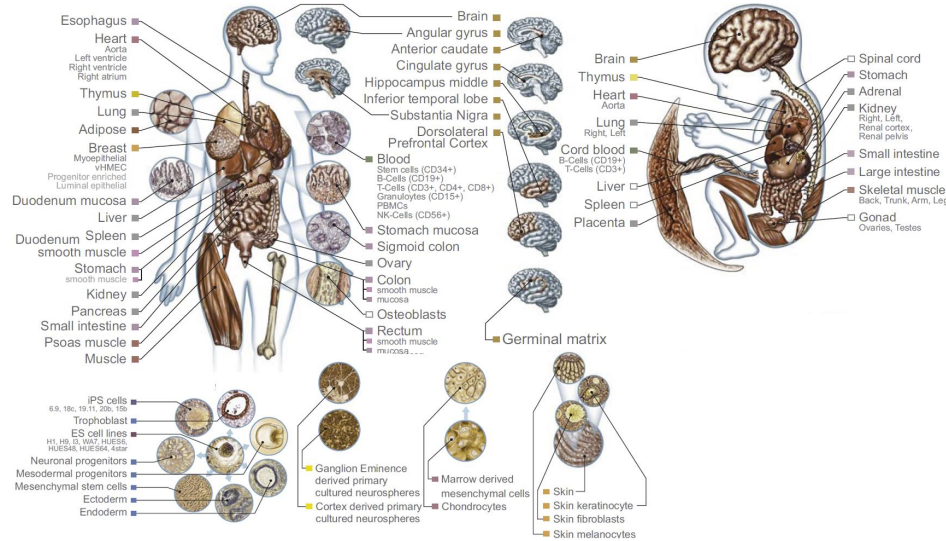
Chromatin states dynamics across nine cell types



- Single annotation track for each cell type
- Summarize cell-type activity at a glance
- Can study 9-cell activity pattern across

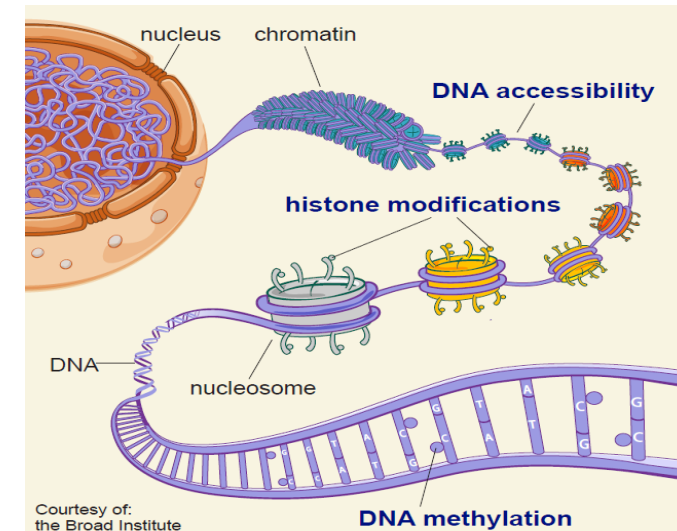
Epigenomic mapping across 100+ tissues/cell types

Diverse tissues and cells



X

Diverse epigenomic assays



Adult tissues and cells (brain, muscle, heart, digestive, skin, adipose, lung, blood...)

Fetal tissues (brain, skeletal muscle, heart, digestive, lung, cord blood...)

ES cells, iPS, differentiated cells
(meso/endo/ectoderm, neural, mesench...)



Histone modifications

- H3K4me3, H3K4me1, H3K36me3
- H3K27me3, H3K9me3, H3K27/9ac
- +20 more

Open chromatin:

- DNA accessibility

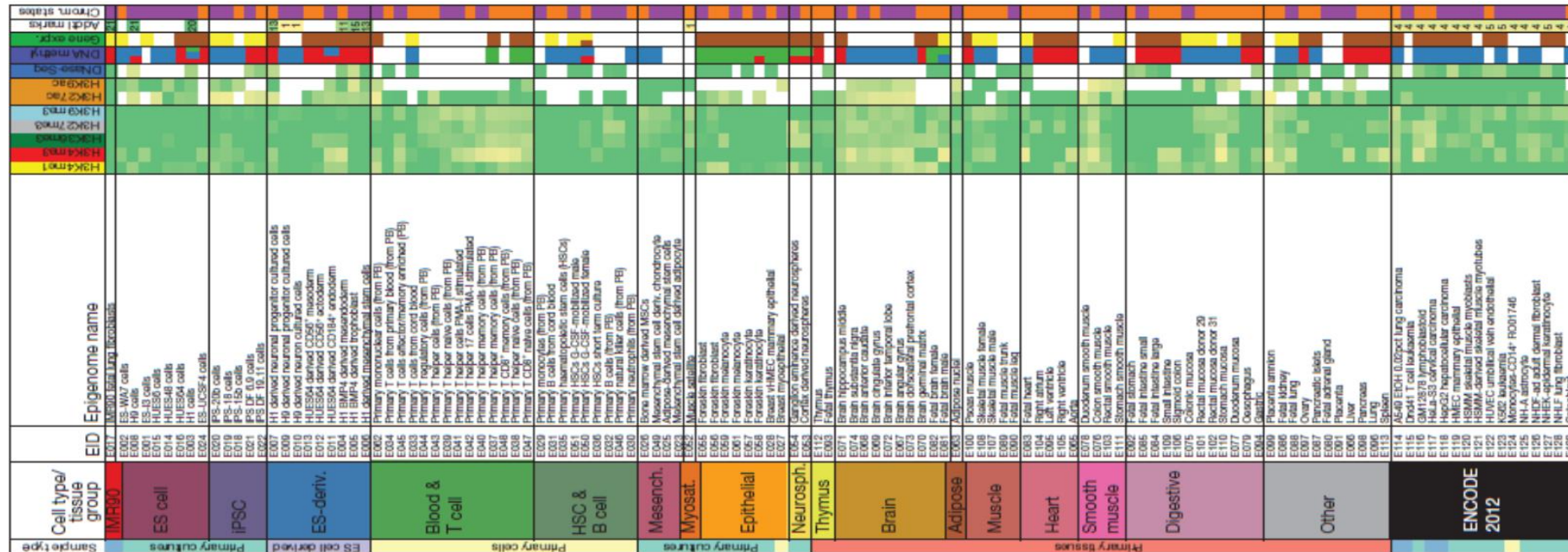
DNA methylation:

- WGBS, RRBS, MRE/MeDIP

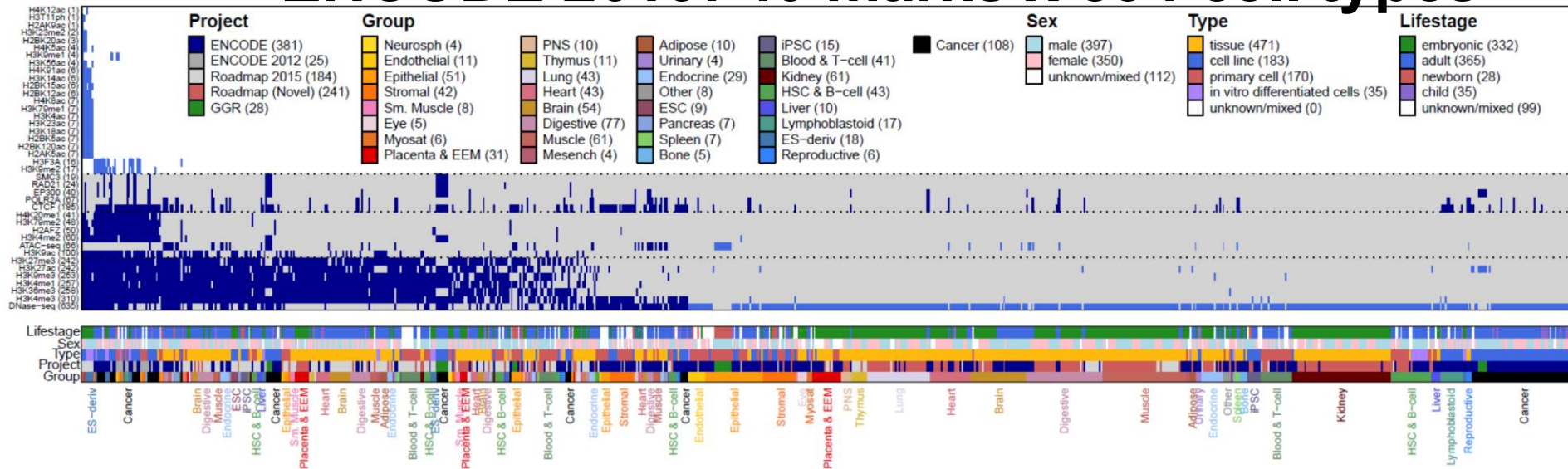
Gene expression

- RNA-seq, Exon Arrays

Roadmap 2015: 12 marks x 127 cell types



ENCODE 2019: 40 marks x 834 cell types



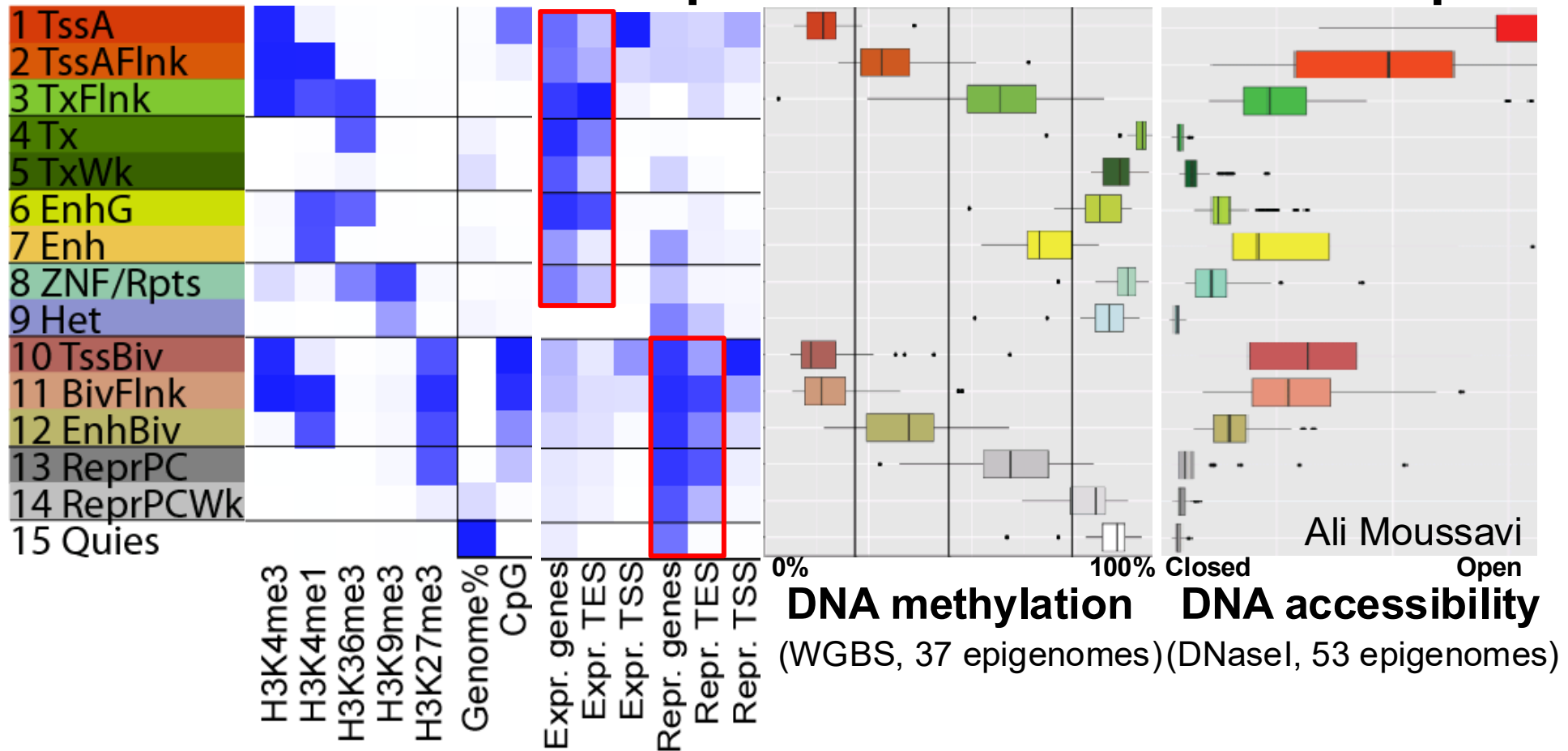
Chromatin states across 127 epigenomes



Reveal epigenomic variability: enh/prom/tx/repr/het

Anshul Kundaje

States show distinct mCpG, DNase, Tx, Ac profiles



TssA vs. **TssBiv**: diff. activity, both open, both unmethylated!

Enh vs. ReprPC: diff. activity, both intermediate DNase/Methyl

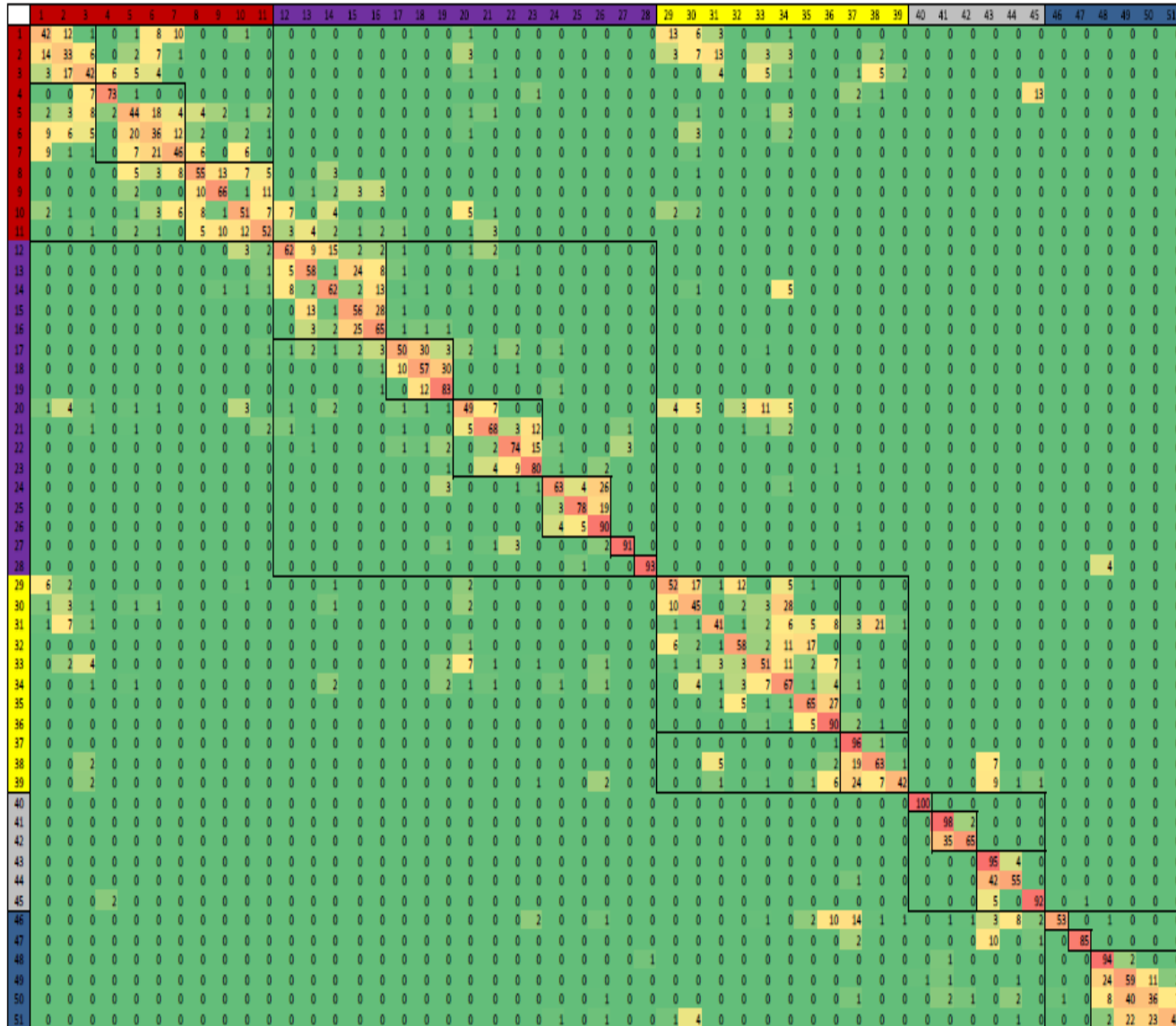
Tx: Methylated, closed, actively transcribed

➔ Distinct modes of repression: H3K27me3 vs. **DNAm** vs. **Het**

Emission Parameter Matrix $e_k(\mathbf{x}_i)$ to learn biology

state	H3K14ac	H3K23ac	H4K12ac	H2AK9ac	H4K16ac	H2AK5ac	H4K91ac	H3K4ac	H2BK20ac	H3K18ac	H2BK120ac	H3K27ac	H2BK5ac	H2BK12ac	H3K36ac	H4K5ac	H4K8ac	H3K9ac	Poli	CTCF	H2AZ	H3K4me3	H3K4me2	H3K4me1	H3K9me1	H3K79me3	H3K79me2	H3K79me1	H3K27me1	H2BK5me1	H4K20me1	H3K36me3	H3K36me1	H3R2me1	H3R2me2	H3K27me2	H3K27me3	H4R3me2	H3K9me2	H3K9me3	H4K20me3
1	3.8	23.6	24.2	18.0	37.7	25.5	95.2	94.8	94.3	99.2	99.6	99.7	98.9	79.1	88.6	93.6	86.9	83.6	51.6	15.7	87.5	94.2	93.8	64.2	87.0	3.8	3.3	12.0	19.4	11.6	3.8	0.5	2.6	1.9	2.1	0.2	0.1	0.2	0.5	0.1	1.8
2	2.5	17.5	9.2	3.2	5.9	6.3	44.6	44.4	47.0	73.2	74.1	85.9	71.2	22.1	33.5	61.9	63.3	35.4	18.1	10.9	91.2	86.7	90.4	66.9	78.3	2.4	2.2	7.9	17.6	8.7	2.3	0.6	2.2	1.7	1.5	0.4	0.5	0.2	0.4	0.1	1.4
3	0.5	5.8	1.8	1.0	0.9	1.2	12.3	9.5	8.8	22.6	21.3	22.8	12.1	2.2	4.2	8.4	12.8	7.1	11.2	16.3	77.1	93.9	80.3	45.6	74.2	1.5	1.3	4.6	4.3	7.0	8.8	0.2	1.4	2.1	1.5	0.2	2.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	1.2
4	0.1	0.8	0.1	0.4	0.3	0.2	1.5	0.9	0.7	2.1	2.1	0.5	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.3	1.9	6.2	19.0	77.9	20.8	21.1	26.4	0.3	0.0	0.1	0.0	1.3	14.9	0.1	0.2	1.4	0.9	0.0	10.2	0.1	0.1	0.4	1.3
5	0.0	0.2	0.8	1.3	2.0	0.4	26.6	12.6	6.7	15.8	23.1	26.8	24.3	1.5	4.3	0.9	1.4	7.7	53.5	20.6	21.8	87.0	11.2	2.7	15.7	6.3	3.8	2.5	0.0	5.5	14.2	0.0	0.3	0.2	0.6	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.0	1.5
6	0.1	1.8	3.6	6.9	6.1	1.9	74.5	63.5	53.0	75.7	84.3	89.4	86.7	20.8	41.5	20.5	21.6	62.7	69.2	25.5	61.2	98.3	37.4	7.1	40.3	5.3	2.7	5.6	0.6	6.0	11.6	0.0	0.5	0.4	0.9	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1	1.6
7	1.2	8.7	20.6	43.0	53.7	9.8	98.7	98.6	95.7	99.4	99.9	99.9	99.9	76.5	93.3	81.8	76.6	99.2	88.0	26.9	77.1	99.7	38.3	2.2	37.9	32.1	24.9	14.0	2.6	6.5	16.2	0.1	1.0	0.5	1.2	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.0	1.9
8	1.2	12.7	5.2	11.9	5.6	6.8	56.9	56.1	37.5	52.4	69.8	89.1	85.5	21.3	24.8	16.7	10.3	60.8	62.1	12.0	31.4	96.7	51.7	14.9	45.3	86.3	80.1	23.8	1.7	6.7	42.2	4.5	0.4	1.1	0.9	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.5	
9	0.5	7.2	3.0	1.1	0.5	2.1	4.0	7.4	2.4	2.5	11.6	35.3	28.0	2.7	2.8	2.0	1.8	8.6	34.7	4.2	4.5	79.2	41.5	23.8	36.1	86.0	82.6	12.0	1.9	6.7	43.5	7.4	0.2	0.6	0.7	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.2	0.4	
10	4.1	24.8	13.1	17.5	24.4	37.0	90.4	88.6	82.0	89.8	95.5	97.0	95.1	54.0	56.4	67.2	45.7	55.7	46.6	10.2	40.8	84.6	92.3	91.4	92.8	67.1	67.2	63.4	29.2	53.8	65.2	4.5	6.8	5.7	3.4	0.1	0.0	0.3	0.1	0.0	1.0
11	1.6	21.0	3.9	3.8	3.2	8.4	28.0	26.1	14.5	22.6	37.6	56.8	47.4	6.0	6.4	13.5	8.8	18.4	30.9	6.9	20.1	92.4	93.5	94.3	94.5	73.8	74.2	55.1	24.0	57.2	79.9	8.9	6.6	4.4	2.5	0.1	0.0	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.7
12	3.6	17.0	8.9	2.2	14.1	34.9	60.3	51.0	38.8	55.6	56.6	53.3	55.3	11.9	11.5	30.0	15.4	1.7	18.0	2.7	0.7	5.4	58.2	96.0	77.8	87.4	87.0	76.3	41.6	79.8	82.2	13.4	3.1	6.4	3.6	0.3	0.0	0.7	0.2	0.1	0.4
13	1.2	10.8	3.6	0.7	2.5	7.4	9.1	6.5	2.6	2.5	6.5	7.7	5.5	0.5	1.0	5.5	3.3	0.3	10.2	1.5	0.0	2.4	56.2	83.7	82.9	92.7	92.6	64.4	38.2	80.0	89.8	12.0	2.4	3.3	2.1	0.3	0.0	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.3
14	0.7	5.3	7.9	1.0	2.4	18.0	19.8	20.7	14.6	7.9	24.5	20.1	21.8	6.7	6.6	11.3	8.6	0.3	5.9	1.7	2.1	1.3	8.0	33.0	16.3	61.8	62.1	37.9	9.7	14.3	18.3	9.7	0.2	1.7	1.2	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.3	0.4	1.0
15	0.2	1.9	2.9	0.3	0.3	1.5	0.8	1.3	0.3	0.2	1.2	1.5	1.2	0.2	0.4	0.7	1.2	0.1	6.0	0.7	0.0	0.2	11.0	17.3	29.3	84.7	82.2	33.1	8.0	26.4	56.2	5.2	0.2	0.7	0.9	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.6	0.2
16	0.0	0.3	0.4	0.1	0.1	0.5	0.4	0.6	0.2	0.1	0.5	0.4	0.3	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.6	0.3	0.1	0.1	1.2	2.8	3.9	29.0	25.2	8.5	0.7	1.3	7.9	1.2	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.4	0.1
17	1.2	9.8	2.8	0.9	2.4	7.8	6.8	6.1	2.3	4.0	3.5	8.4	3.5	0.3	1.0	9.3	6.6	0.5	3.5	1.1	0.4	1.0	52.3	68.9	83.7	22.7	23.5	61.2	48.3	64.7	57.3	21.8	2.8	4.9	2.0	1.0	0.1	0.5	0.5	0.1	0.5
18	0.3	2.6	2.1	0.4	0.5	2.4	1.4	1.6	0.5	0.6	0.9	1.6	0.7	0.2	0.5	1.9	1.9	0.1	1.6	0.7	0.1	0.1	10.4	9.7	29.1	15.0	13.5	34.0	14.9	19.9	21.4	10.6	0.5	1.2	0.9	0.5	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.2	0.2
19	0.1	0.3	0.5	0.2	0.1	0.5	0.1	0.3	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.0	0.4	0.3	0.0	0.0	0.5	0.2	2.0	4.4	2.9	7.3	1.0	1.0	2.3	1.4	0.0	0.2	0.3	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.4	0.1
20	2.5	10.7	5.4	3.1	9.9	26.2	58.2	48.8	41.7	49.3	54.8	57.1	51.5	13.0	14.1	31.6	21.7	4.0	14.5	6.7	15.6	20.9	56.8	97.1	70.5	5.4	5.6	33.8	31.1	52.6	38.4	7.4	3.4	6.9	3.8	0.5	0.1	0.7	0.3	0.0	1.0
21	0.2	0.8	2.0	1.3	7.2	11.3	32.3	15.4	11.5	5.7	18.6	8.4	12.4	2.1	1.2	3.2	2.3	0.5	15.1	6.5	0.6	4.7	17.0	68.7	33.3	8.7	6.4	37.2	9.6	65.4	87.7	9.2	1.3	7.1	5.3	0.1	0.2	1.4	0.0	0.0	0.8
22	0.1	0.1	1.1	0.6	6.2	2.4	7.8	1.8	0.6	0.1	1.5	0.8	1.5	0.1	0.1	0.7	0.7	0.1	8.5	1.0	0.0	0.0	5.3	8.4	14.6	15.5	9.1	50.0	9.6	77.5	94.1	22.9	0.5	5.6	4.6	0.1	0.0	1.4	0.0	0.1	0.7
23	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.4	2.0	1.6	4.9	1.2	0.5	0.2	0.9	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	1.4	1.1	0.0	0.0	0.5	2.6	1.4	0.5	0.1	5.4	1.3	19.4	36.8	2.5	0.1	1.4	1.5	0.1	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.0	0.2
24	0.3	1.8	2.1	0.9	3.2	3.8	4.0	2.3	0.9	0.6	1.1	3.6	1.9	0.1	0.4	3.7	3.9	0.3	2.2	1.0	0.1	0.1	6.0	4.5	17.2	1.3	0.2	15.6	29.8	29.3	7.1	49.5	1.3	4.7	2.2	1.0	0.0	0.6	0.3	0.1	0.3
25	0.1	0.3	0.8	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.3	0.3	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.5	0.3	0.1	0.1	0.4	0.7	0.1	0.8	0.4	0.0	0.1	0.4	0.1	1.4	0.8	0.1	2.0	8.8	2.8	0.4	60.1	0.4	1.1	0.9	0.6	0.1	0.2	0.3	1.7	0.3
26	0.1	0.2	0.6	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.1	0.2	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.3	0.2	0.0	0.1	0.2	0.4	0.0	0.6	0.3	0.0	0.0	0.3	0.1	0.4	0.2	0.0	0.8	2.3	0.9	0.2	4.2	0.1	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.0
27	0.0	0.5	4.4	0.4	1.3	1.2	1.3	0.7	0.3	0.1	0.7	2.1	2.4	0.1	0.1	1.6	2.7	0.1	21.7	1.4	0.0	0.0	1.1	1.1	3.5	4.6	1.2	9.9	3.0	7.1	31.7	34.0	0.2	0.7	1.1	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.0	0.3	0.1
28	0.0	0.0	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.4	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.3	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.0	1.3	0.3	0.0	0.3	0.2	0.5	0.5	13.8	3.4	5.7	1.3	3.0	1.5	68.8	0.1	2.7	2.7	0.3	0.2	0.8	0.4	43.0	74.9
29	4.6	8.4	11.1	6.6	20.4	54.7	88.5	88.1	89.6	86.6	95.3	86.3	86.9	68.1	60.2	67.6	42.6	10.4	13.6	3.8	24.2	7.6	24.7	84.4	25.8	4.9	5.6	14.9	17.6	21.7	5.0	2.9	0.9	4.8	3.1	0.4	0.1	0.4	0.8	0.2	4.4
30	1.2	3.6	8.4	2.4	2.6	13.5	24.9	34.5	34.4	24.6	52.1	60.1	64.6	27.4	23.8	20.7	16.7	3.2	9.1	2.9	12.0	6.9	8.8	35.8	6.5	2.8	2.9	4.4	3.7	3.0	1.0	2.8	0.1	0.9	1.0	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.4	0.6	3.4
31	1.7	7.6	4.7	1.7	2.4	6.8	17.7	18.4	21.5	37.9	31.6	35.4	20.1	9.3	13.0	48.3	57.7	3.3	1.2	5.9	69.0	10.5	16.1	41.8	11.0	0.6	0.5	1.2	10.7	2.2	0.0	1.1	1.4	2.0	1.3	1.1	0.5	0.2	0.8	0.2	1.1
32	1.4	1.6	1.0	1.9	8.1	50.1	72.4	57.2	60.9	42.5	57.6	12.1	14.8	23.6	19.5	16.0	5.4	2.1	1.6	1.7	3.6	0.1	2.1	41.4	5.0	1.8	1.7	12.2	10.9	17.1	4.1	4.1	0.9	6.5	3.0	1.3	0.3	0.6	0.5	0.3	3.8
33	1.2	4.6	0.9	0.9	1.2	9.8	12.9	10.3	7.0	12.7	10.5	9.8	5.7	1.3	2.1	6.3	4.1	0.4	2.6	4.3	8.6	1.5	16.3	77.1	23.5	0.7	0.5	5.1	10.3	10.8	3.9	1.8	1.1	2.9	1.6	0.7	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.4
34	0.2	0.7	2.0	0.5	0.7	5.4	7.2	6.2	4.9	1.2	8.9	5.7	6.2	2.9	2.2	2.3	2.3	0.1	1.5	0.9	1.0	0.2	0.6	6.3	1.0	1.9	1.7	5.2	2.6	2.2	0.6										

Transition matrix a_{kl}



- Learns spatial relationships between neighboring states
- Reveals distinct sub-groups of states
- Reveals transitions between different groups

Assay for Transposase-Accessible Chromatin (ATAC)

Goal: Map open chromatin regions genome-wide

Key insight: No antibody needed!

Protocol:

- 1 Tn5 transposase + DNA
- 2 Cuts accessible chromatin preferentially
- 3 Adds sequencing adapters
- 4 Sequence DNA fragments
- 5 Map reads to genome
- 6 **Call peaks**

Advantages:

- Fast protocol (~3 hours)
- Small cell numbers (500-50K cells)
- No antibodies required
- Genome-wide view

ATAC-seq vs. ChIP-seq

ATAC-seq:

- Measures **chromatin accessibility**
- All open regions (enhancers, promoters, etc.)
- No protein specificity
- No antibody needed
- Cheaper, faster

Use cases:

- Map all regulatory elements
- Compare cell states
- Find active enhancers
- TF footprinting

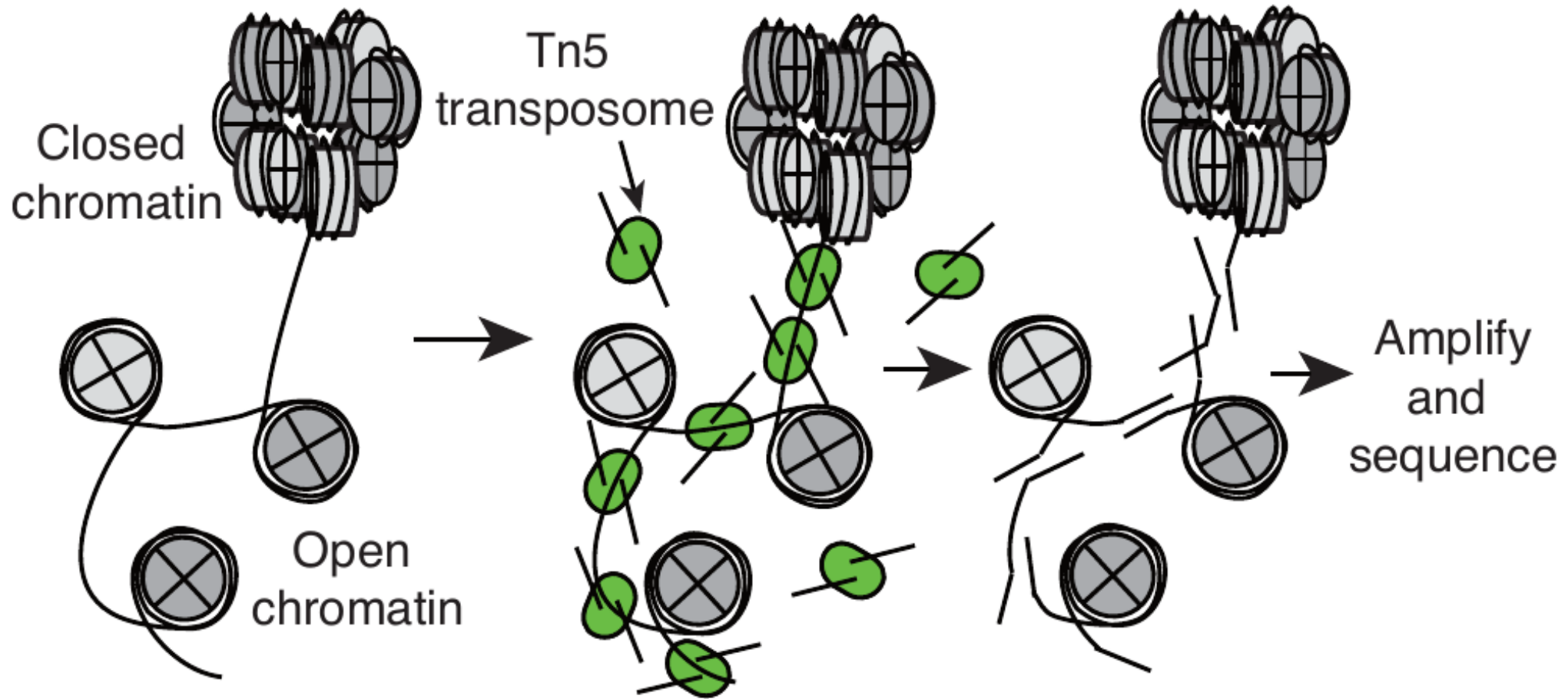
ChIP-seq:

- Measures **protein-DNA binding**
- Specific protein of interest
- Requires good antibody
- More expensive

Use cases:

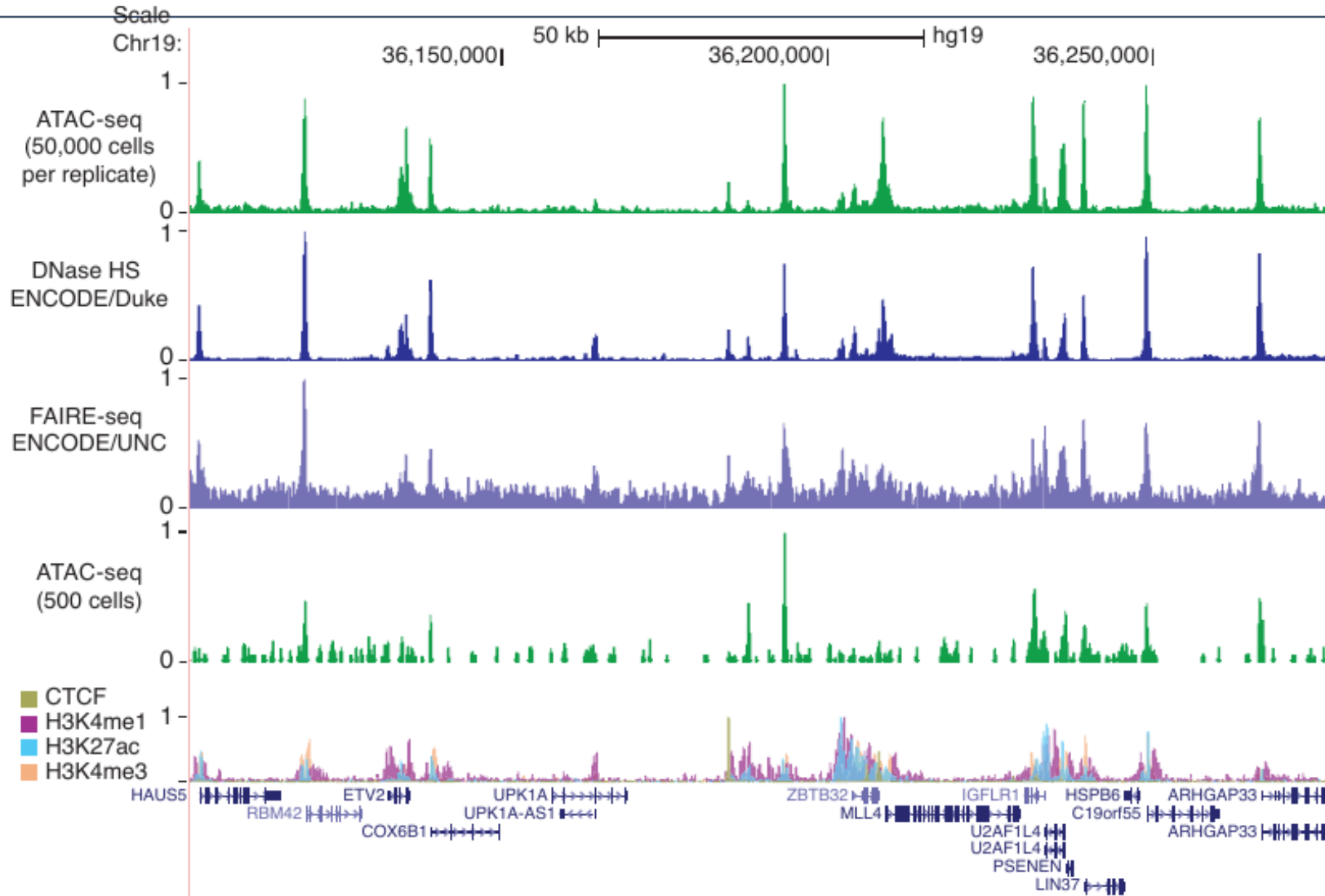
- Find TF binding sites
- Map histone modifications
- Validate ATAC peaks
- Mechanistic studies

ATAC-seq produces regular fragment sizes



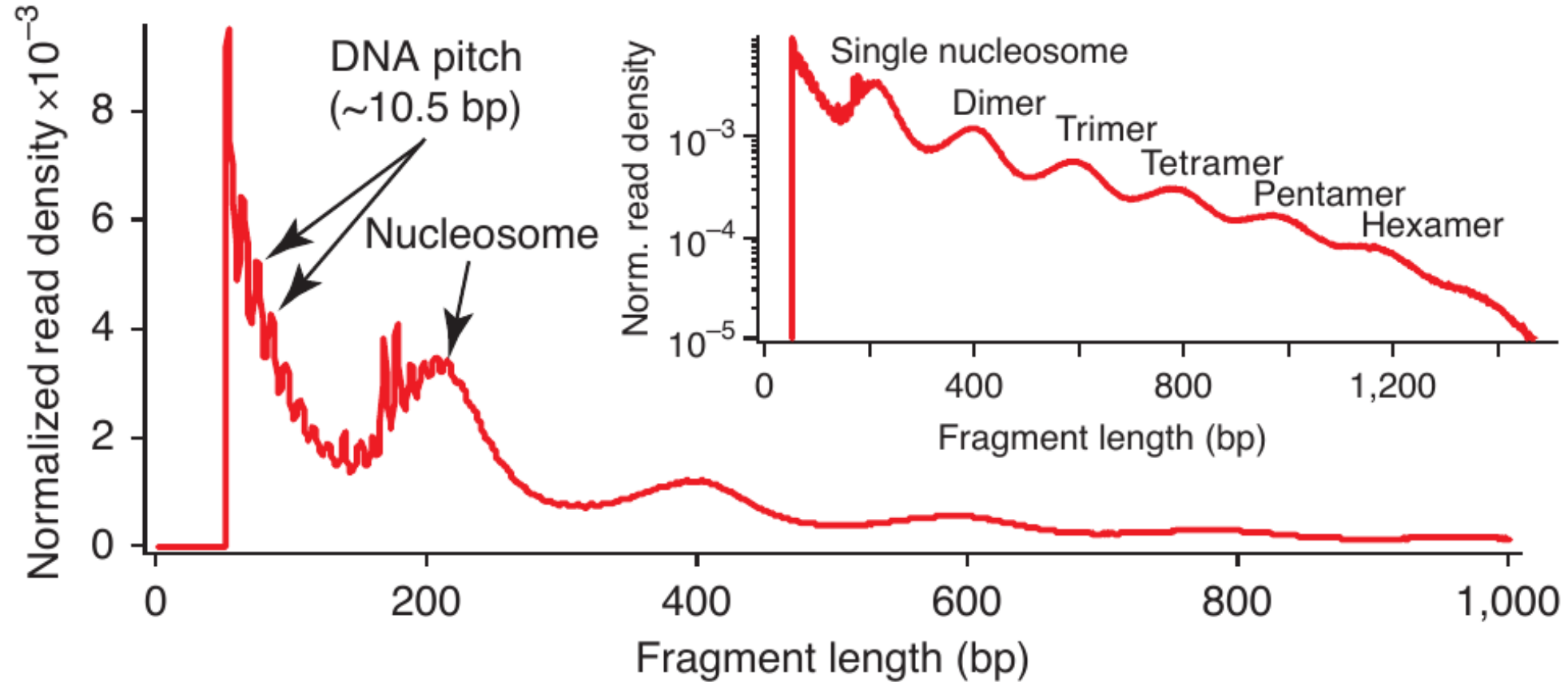
Tn5: cuts open DNA and insert adapter sequence.

ATAC-seq produces regular fragment sizes



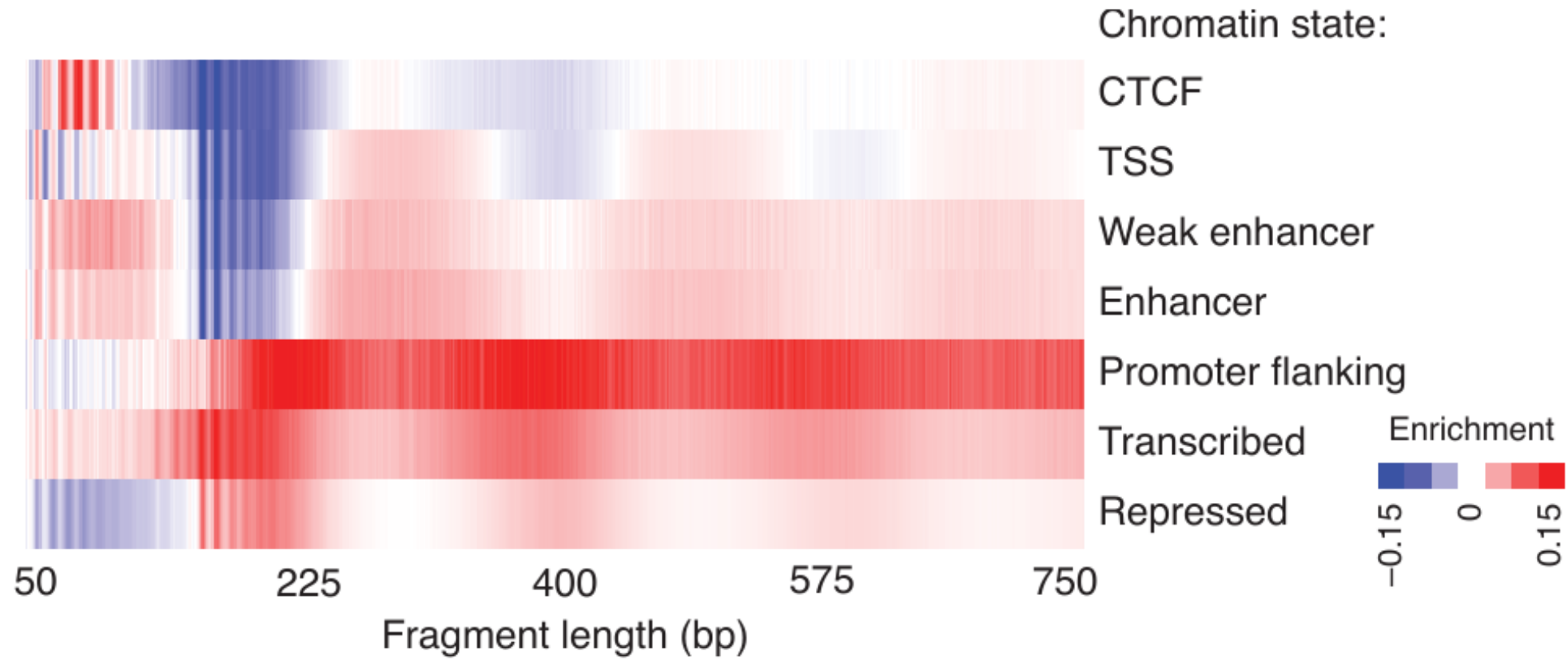
(Buenrostro et al. 2013)

ATAC-seq produces regular fragment sizes



(Buenrostro et al. 2013)

ATAC-seq produces regular fragment sizes



ATAC-seq enriches known gene regulatory elements in genome

(Buenrostro et al. 2013)

Differential Accessibility Analysis

```
# After peak calling, create count matrix  
# Rows = genomic bins, Columns = samples  
count_matrix <- matrix(...) # Read counts per bin per sample  
  
colData <- data.frame( # Set up experimental design  
  condition = factor(c(rep("Control", 3), rep("Treatment", 3)))  
)  
  
dds <- DESeqDataSetFromMatrix(countData = count_matrix, # Run differential accessibility  
  colData = colData, # (same as RNA-seq!)  
  design = ~ condition)  
  
dds <- DESeq(dds)  
results <- results(dds, contrast = c("condition", "Treatment", "Control"))  
  
sig_regions <- results[results$padj < 0.05, ] # Get significant regions (FDR < 0.05)
```

Key point: Same statistical framework as RNA-seq (DESeq2)!

ATAC-seq Applications

1. Identify regulatory elements

- Promoters (at TSS)
- Enhancers (distal peaks)
- Silencers
- Insulators

2. Compare cell types/states

- Development
- Differentiation
- Disease vs healthy

3. TF footprinting

- Bound TF → protected DNA
- Dip in signal at TF motif
- Infer active TFs

4. Integration

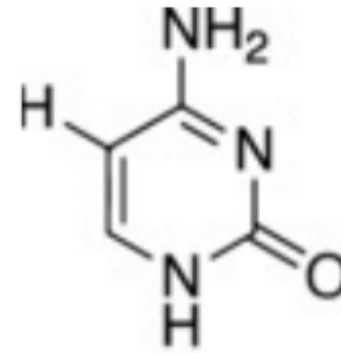
- ATAC + RNA-seq → **link enhancers to genes**
- ATAC + ChIP-seq → TF binding
- ATAC + GWAS → **functional variants**

Today's lecture

- 1 Technologies for measuring regulatory activities
- 2 DNA Methylation (credit: Keegan Korthauer)**
- 3 Multiomic Data Integration with Regulatory Genomics

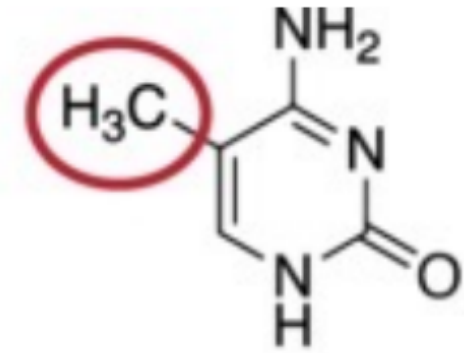
What is DNA Methylation?

- **5-methylcytosine (5mC)**: a methyl group added to cytosine at CpG dinucleotides
- **Heritable**: copied faithfully during DNA replication (by DNMT1)
- **Regulatory role**:
 - CpG islands at promoters → gene silencing when methylated
 - Enhancer activity correlates with hypomethylation
 - Imprinting, X-inactivation

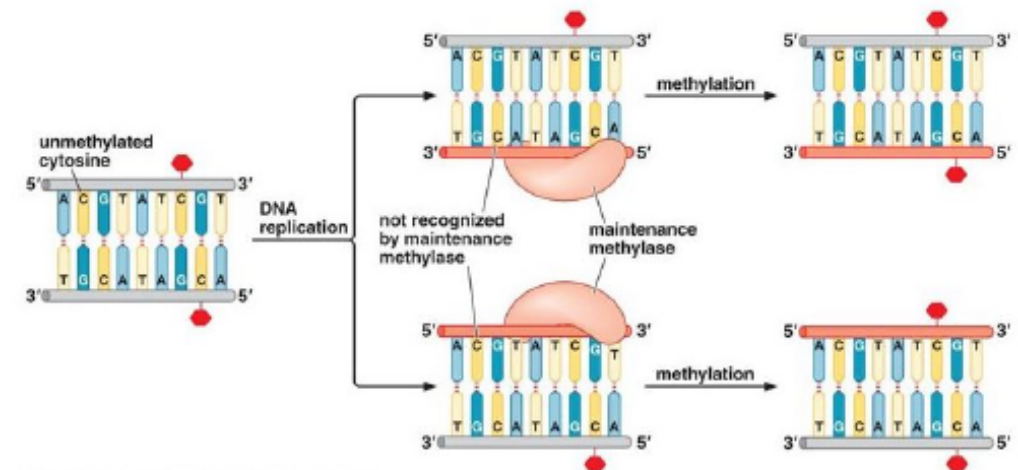


Cytosine

epigentek.com

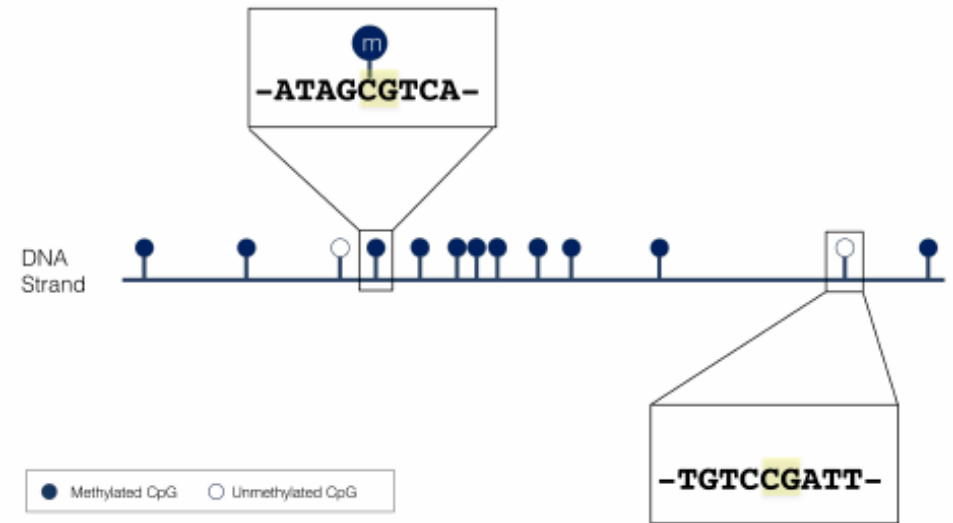
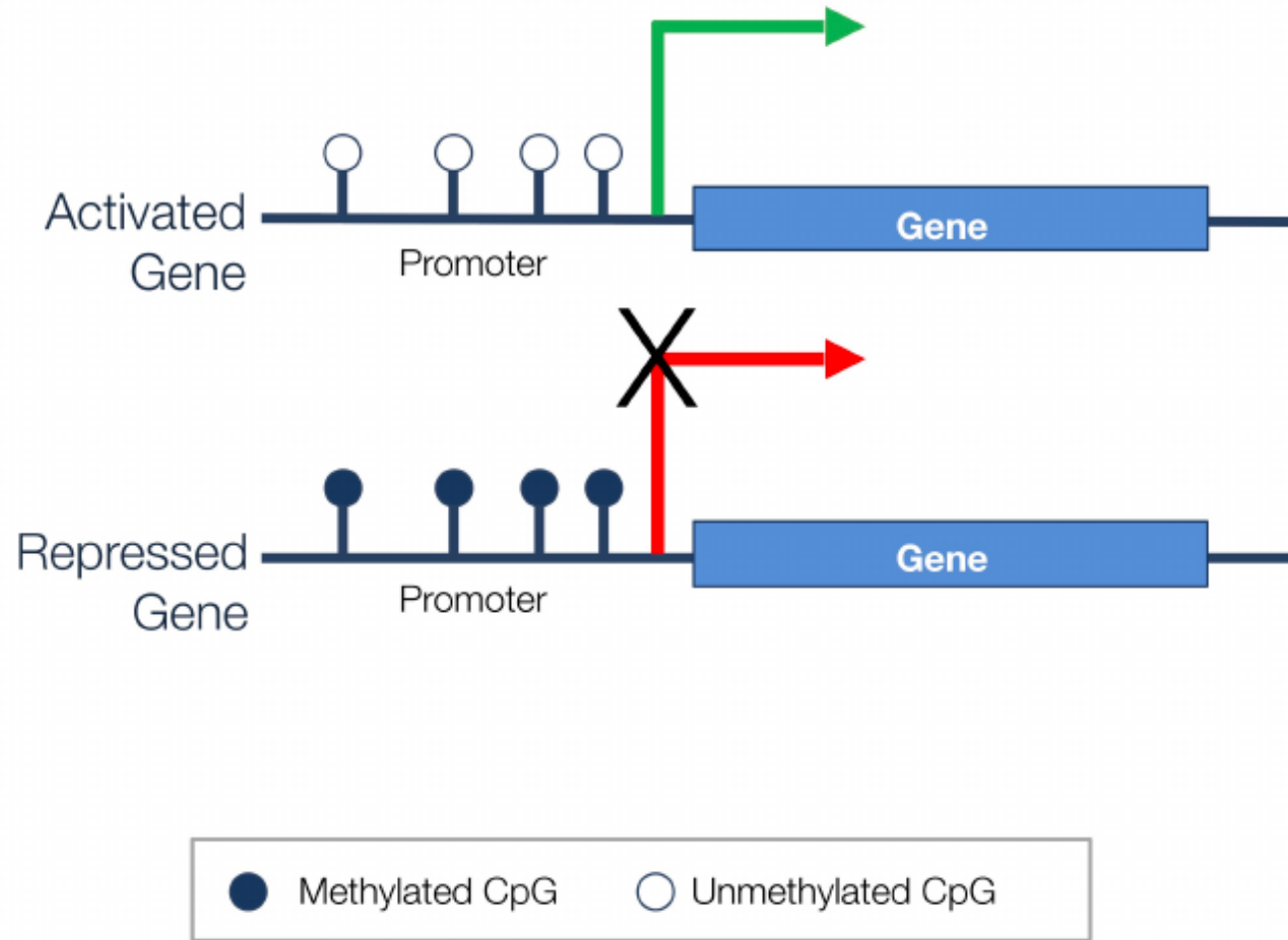


methylated Cytosine

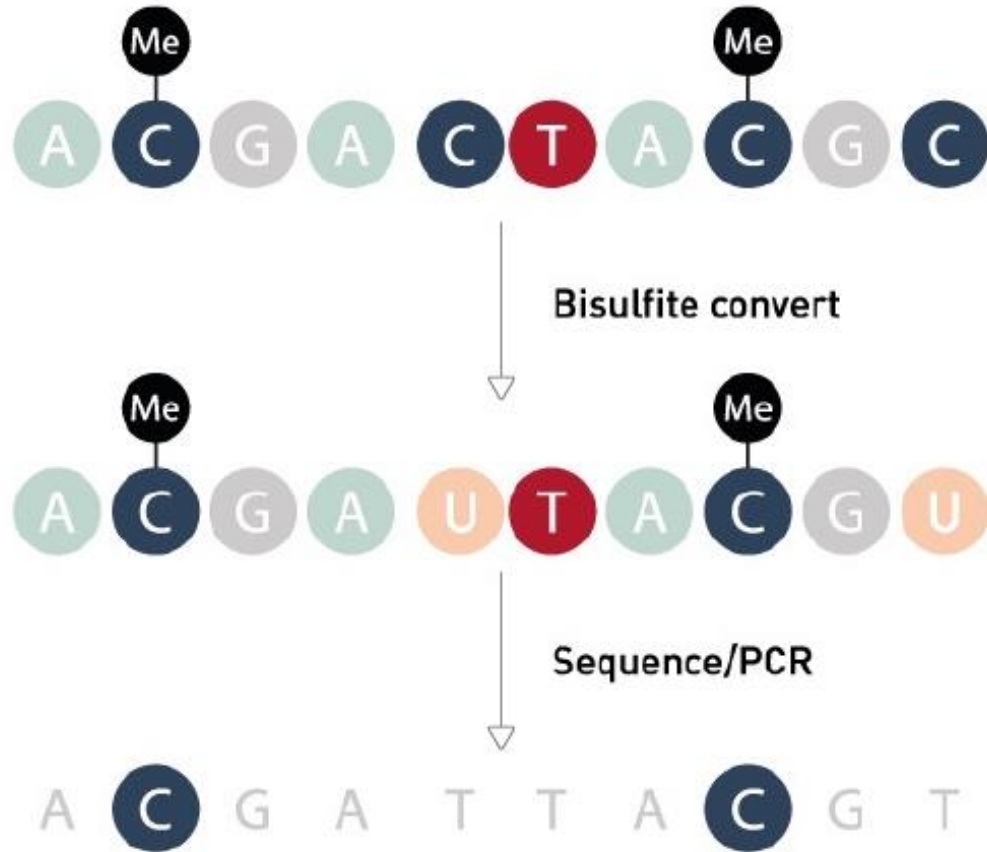


slideplayer.com

DNA Methylation and Gene Regulation

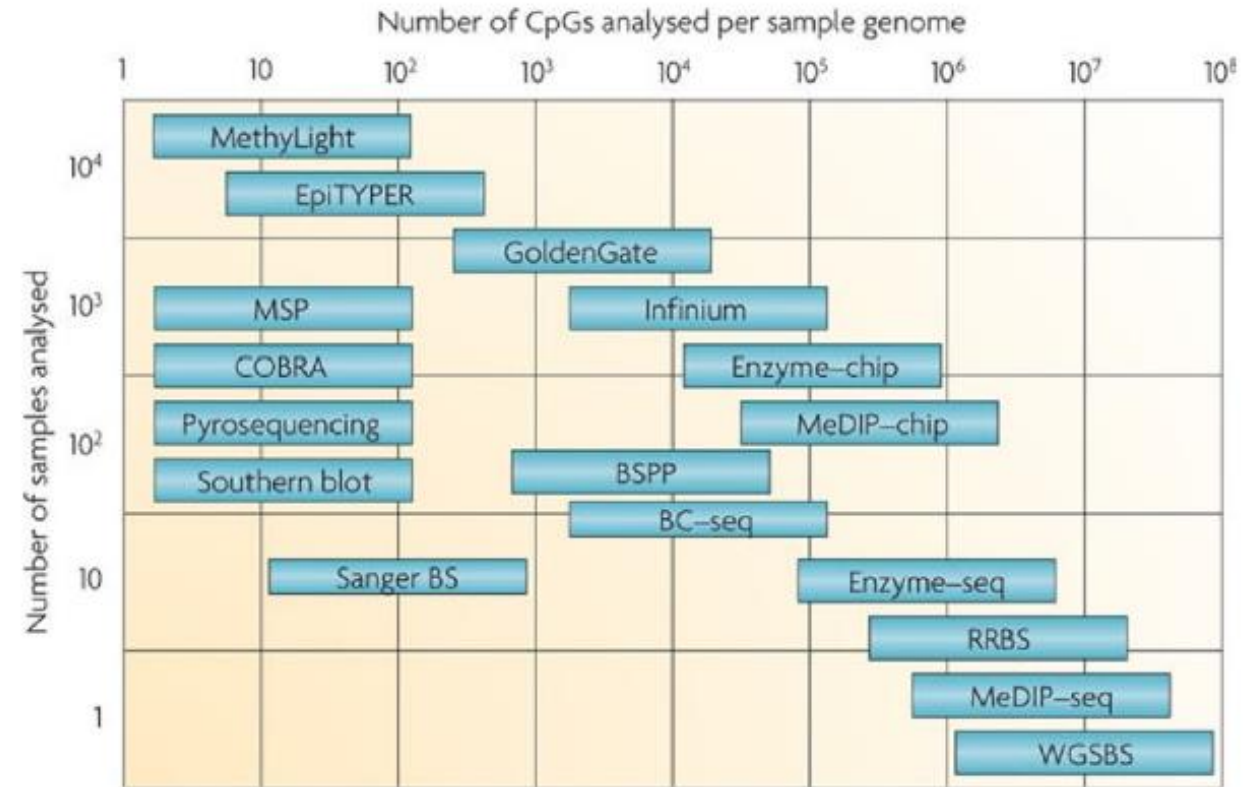


Measuring DNA Methylation



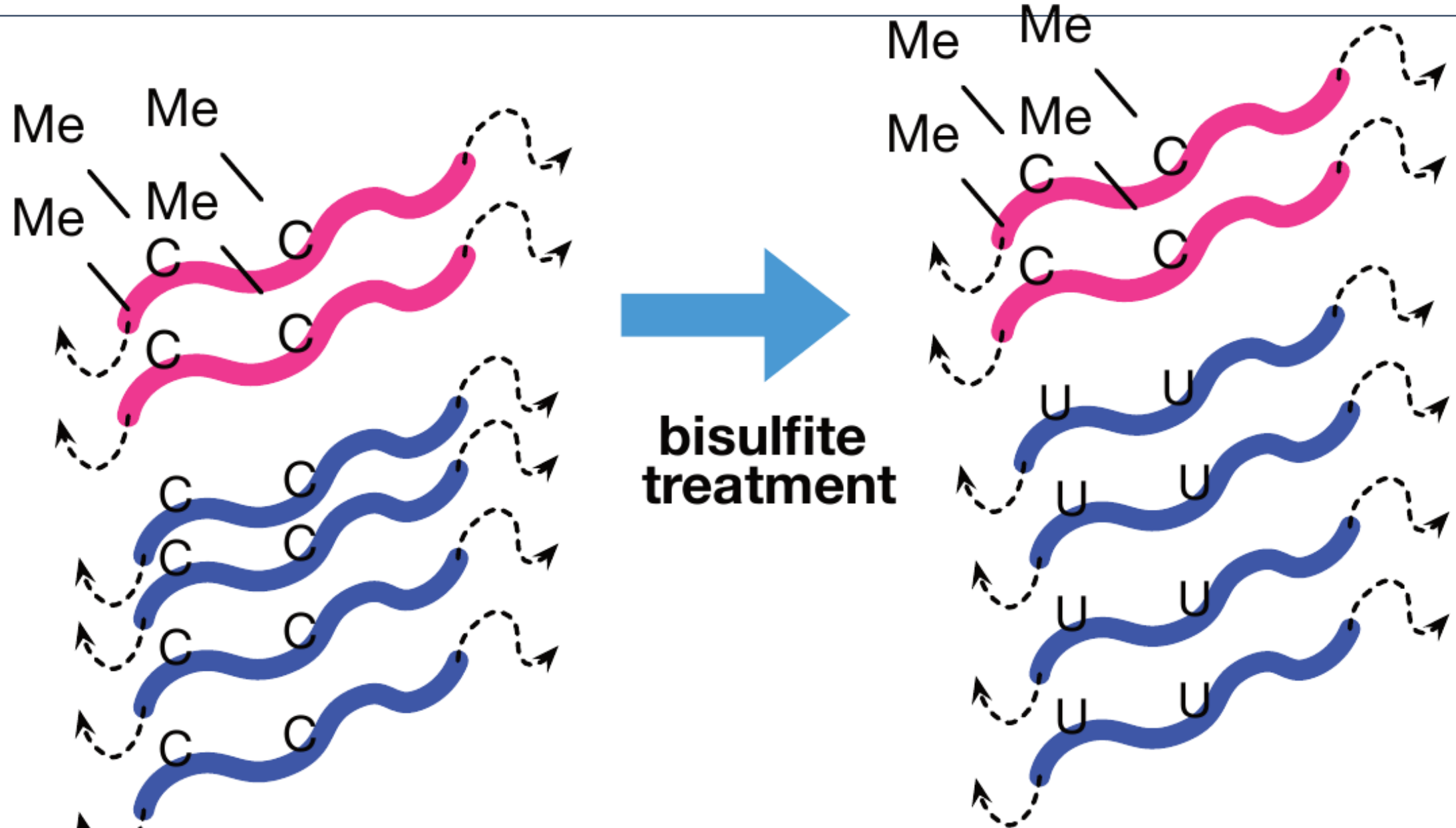
Compare with reference genome

Bisulfite conversion (diagenode.com)



(Laird 2010)

Bisulfite Sequencing



Beta (β) values

- Combine two measurements for each CpG probe, measure level of methylation:

$$\beta = \frac{\text{methylated intensity}}{(\text{methylated intensity} + \text{unmethylated intensity})}$$

- Range from 0 to 1
- Easily interpretable as a **methylation proportion**
- Best used for **visualization**

M-values

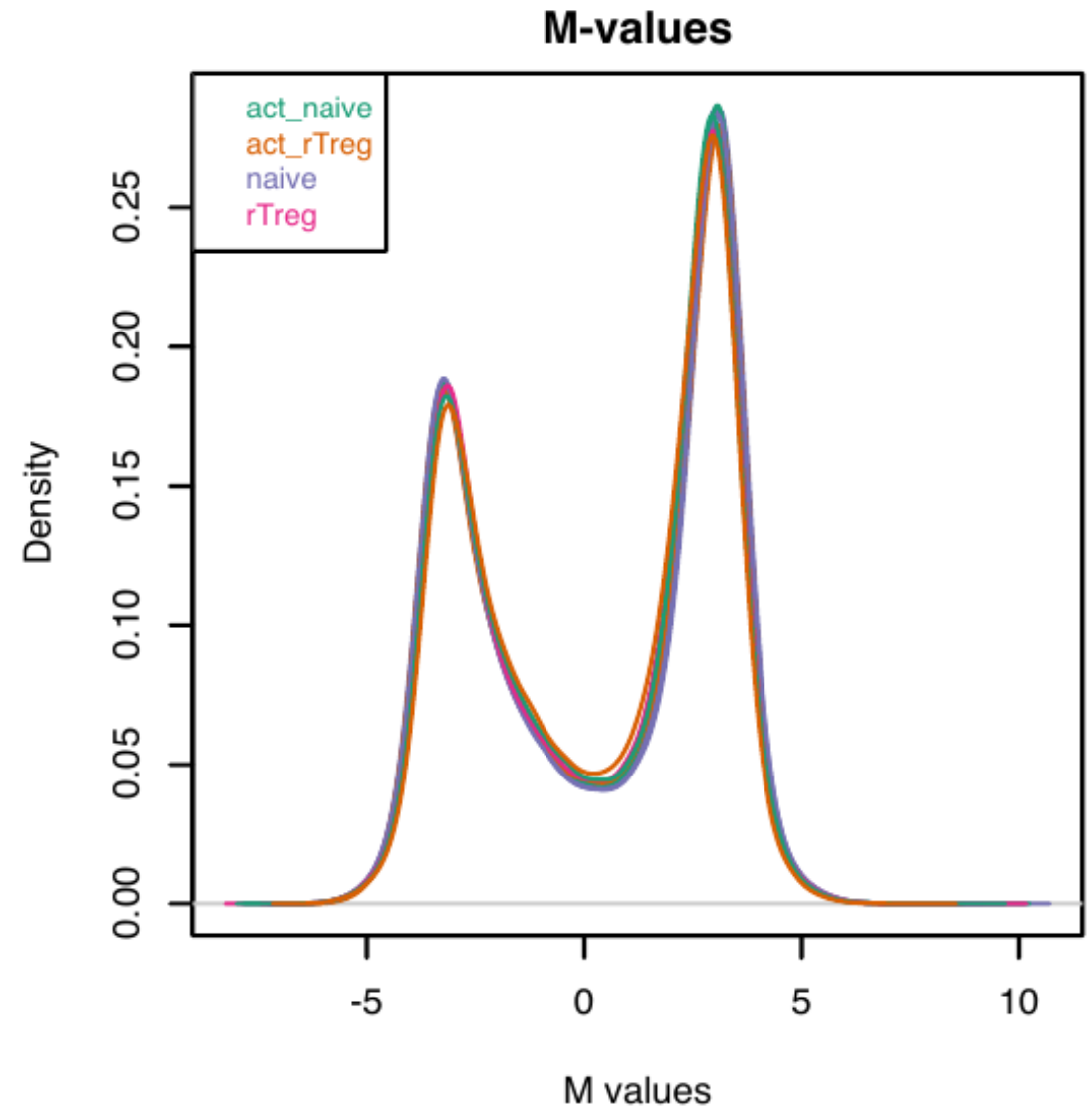
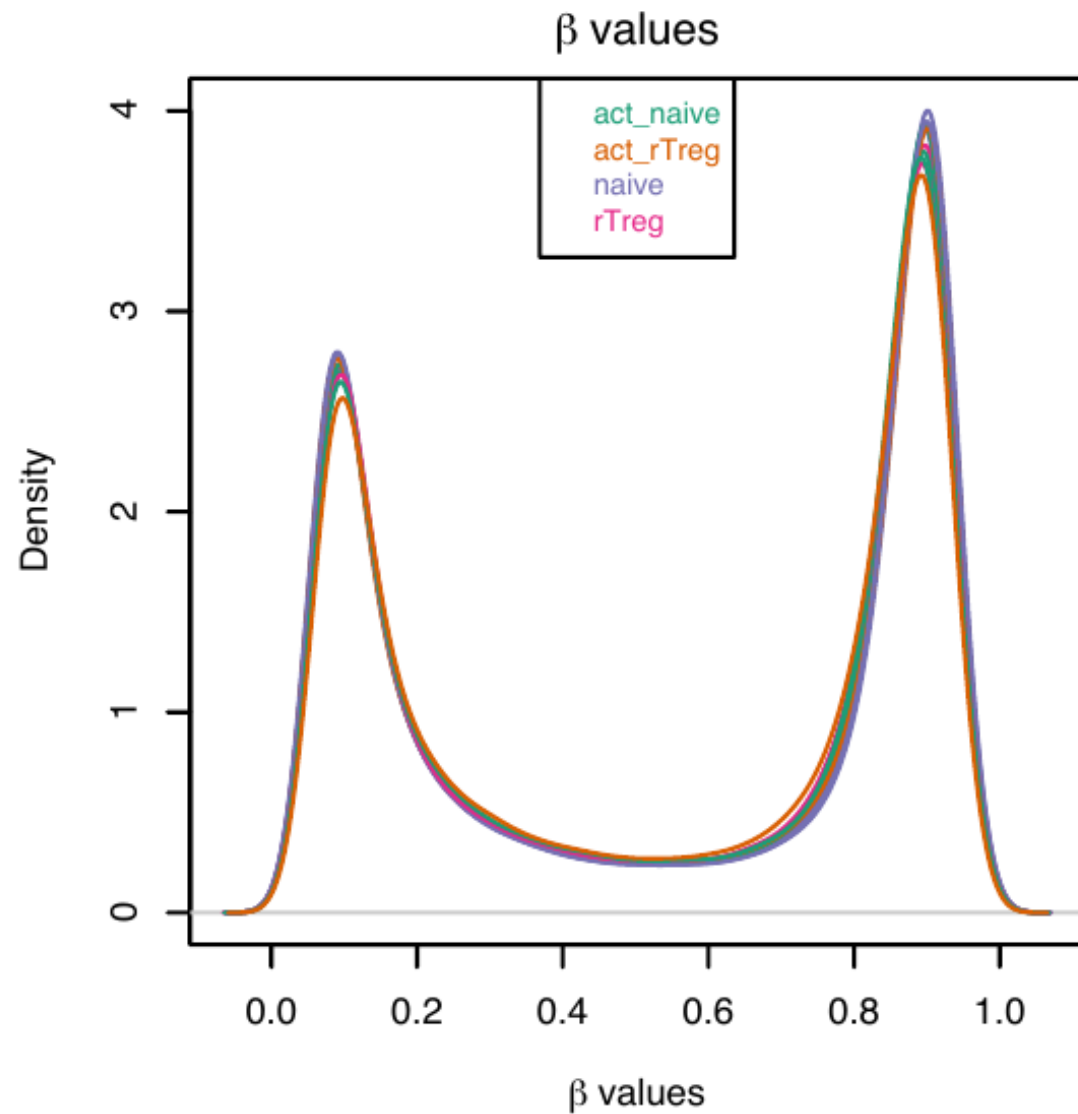
- Transformed β values:

$$M = \log_2 \left(\frac{\text{methylated intensity}}{\text{unmethylated intensity}} \right) = \log_2 \left(\frac{\beta}{1 - \beta} \right)$$

- The *logit* transformation — maps a proportion onto the real line
- Alleviates heteroscedasticity of β values (recall: Binomial(n, p) variance $= np(1 - p)$)
- Best used for **statistical testing**

(Du et al. 2010)

Comparing β and M values



Methylation Array Analysis Workflow

- Analysis strategy: **linear regression on M-values** (limma)
- Key R packages:
 - minfi — preprocessing and normalization of array data
 - limma — differentially methylated cytosines (DMC)
 - dmrseq / bumphunter — differentially methylated **regions** (DMR)
- Example dataset: sorted T cells (Zhang et al. 2013)
 - Naive vs. activated naive T cells
 - GEO: GSE49667

Differentially Methylated Cytosines (DMC)

```
library(limma)
cellType <- factor(targets$Sample_Group)
individual <- factor(targets$Sample_Source)
design <- model.matrix(~ cellType + individual, data = targets)

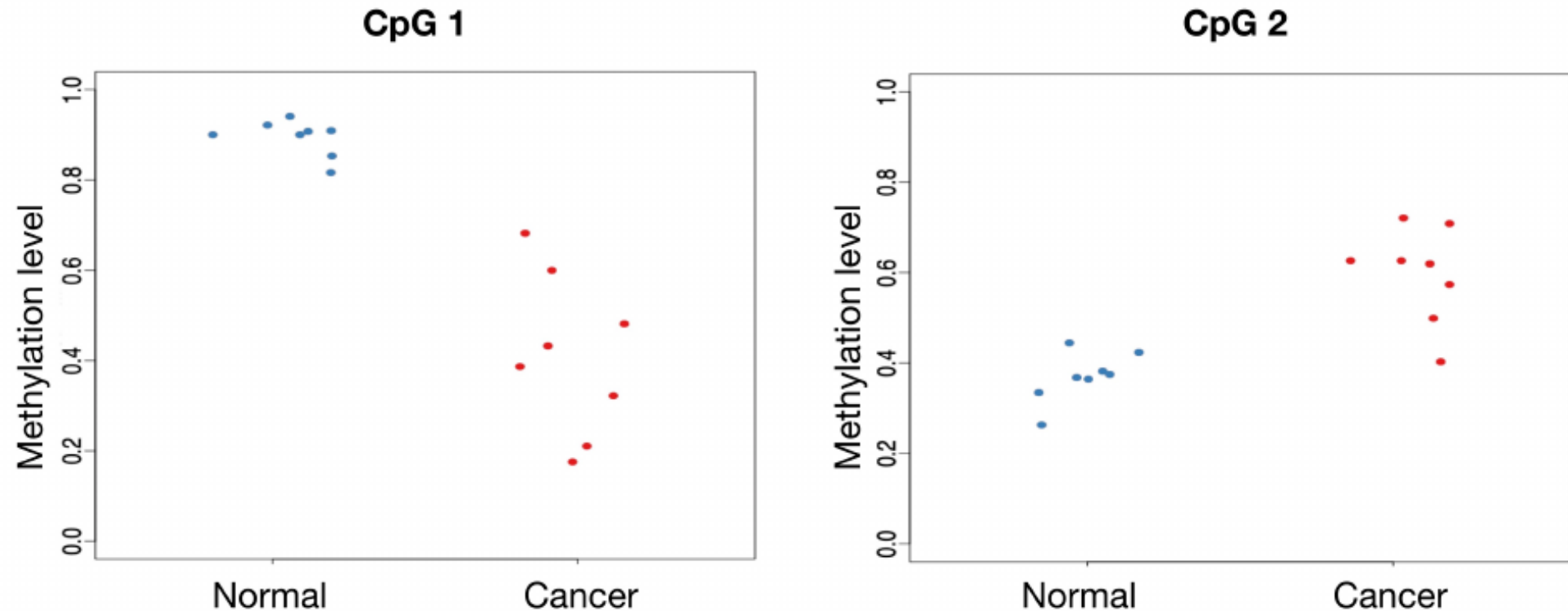
## Fit one linear model per CpG probe
mfit <- lmFit(mVals, design)
cfits <- eBayes(mfit)

## Top differentially methylated CpGs (naive vs. act_naive)
topTable(cfits, coef = "cellTypenaive", number = 5)
```

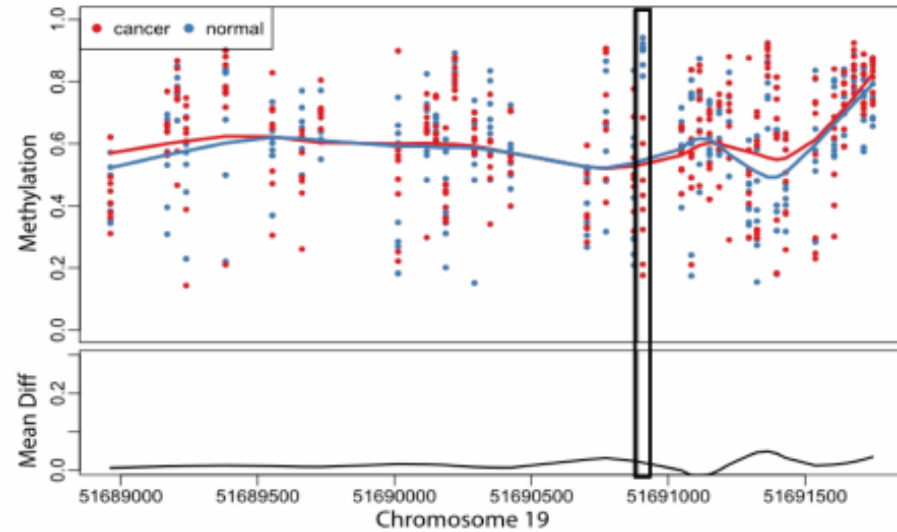
##		logFC	AveExpr	t	P.Value	adj.P.Val	B
##	cg15459165	-3.892074	-1.47895212	-22.09541	1.993958e-08	0.002793543	6.810420
##	cg19704755	-4.139885	0.09100138	-20.35779	3.787335e-08	0.002793543	6.594795
##	cg13531460	3.484448	-0.63132888	20.23020	3.978221e-08	0.002793543	6.577256
##	cg17137500	-3.007052	-2.47635924	-20.21569	4.000601e-08	0.002793543	6.575245
##	cg17048073	-3.650550	-0.87247048	-20.04737	4.270889e-08	0.002793543	6.551674

DMCs vs DMRs

- Individual CpG tests → **differentially methylated cytosines (DMCs)**
- Methylation of nearby CpGs is **correlated** and regulated in tandem
- Grouping nearby significant CpGs → **differentially methylated regions (DMRs)**

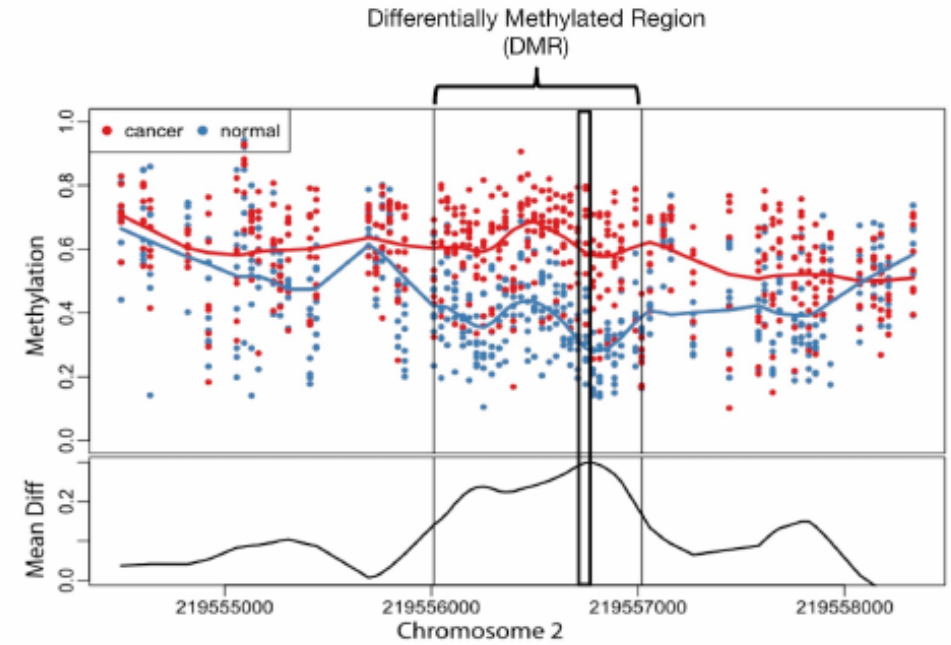


DMCs vs DMRs



CpG 1

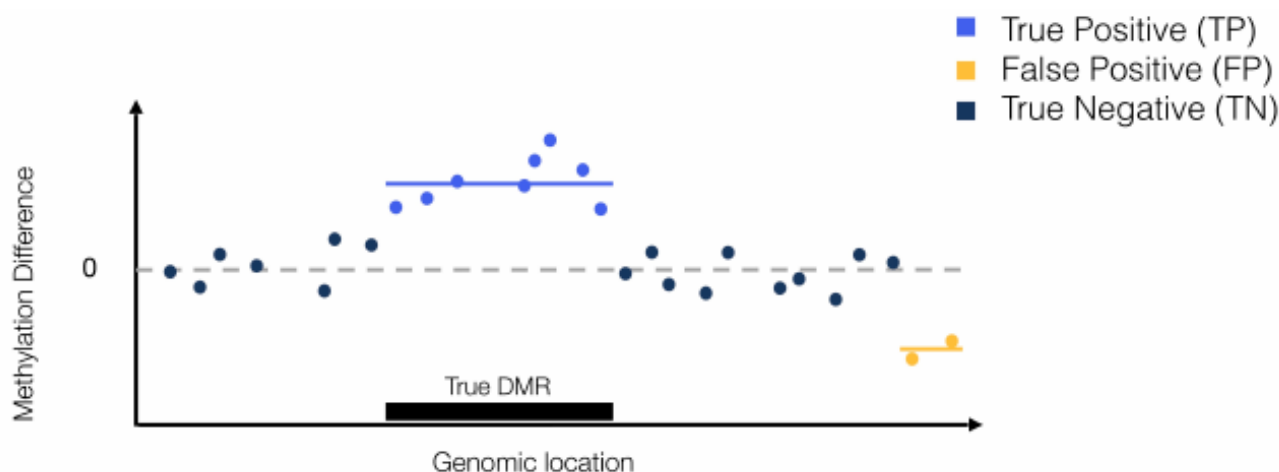
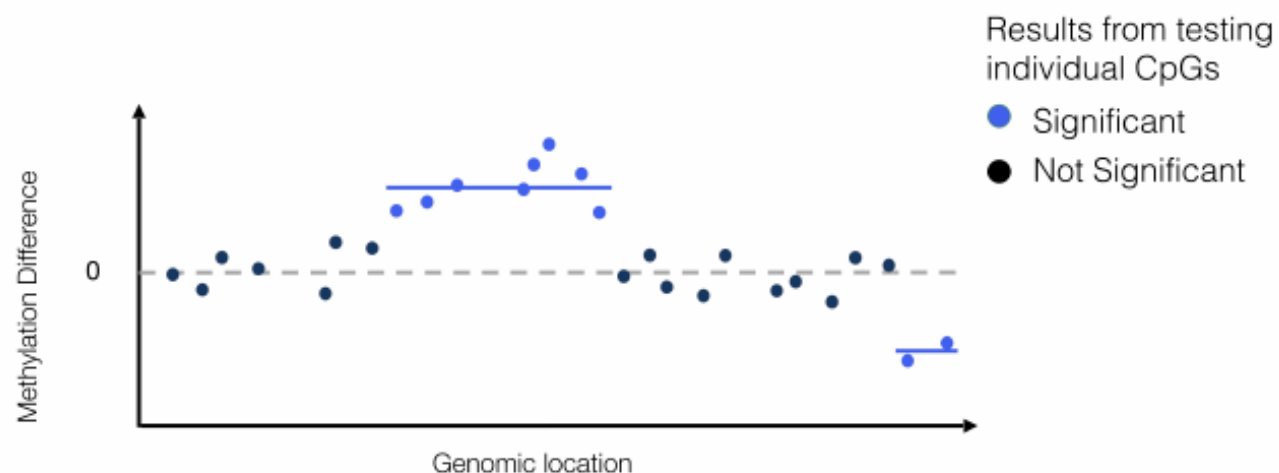
Adapted from Jaffe et al., 2012 (*Int J Epidemiol*)



CpG 2

Adapted from Jaffe et al., 2012 (*Int J Epidemiol*)

FDR at the Region Level



- Grouping significant CpGs post-hoc **inflates FDR**

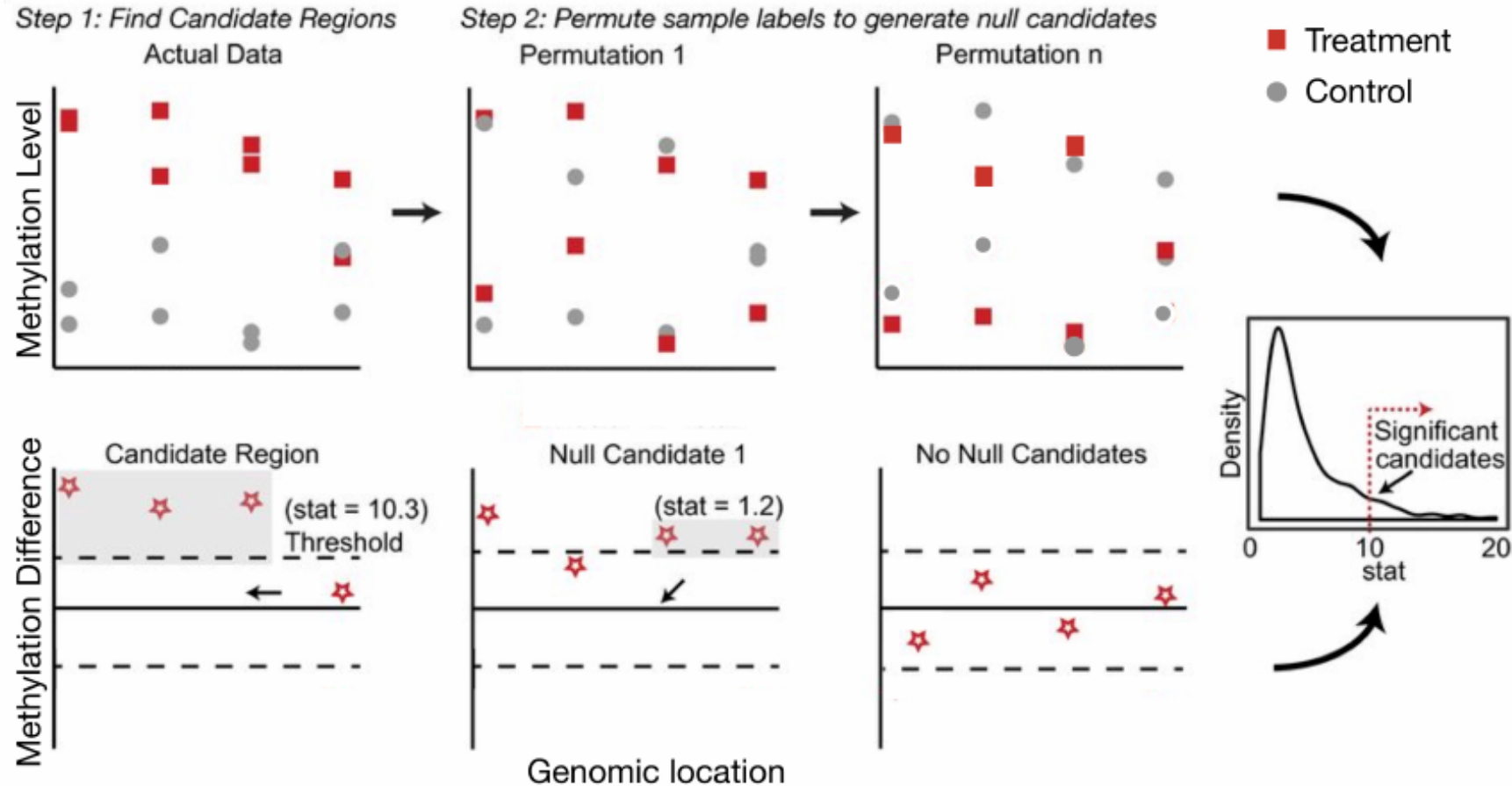
$$FDR_{CpG} = \frac{2}{10} = 0.20$$

$$FDR_{DMR} = \frac{1}{2} = 0.50$$

- Need to model region-level signal directly

BSmooth (Hansen et al. 2012), DSS (Park and Wu 2016)

Accurate DMR Inference: dmrseq

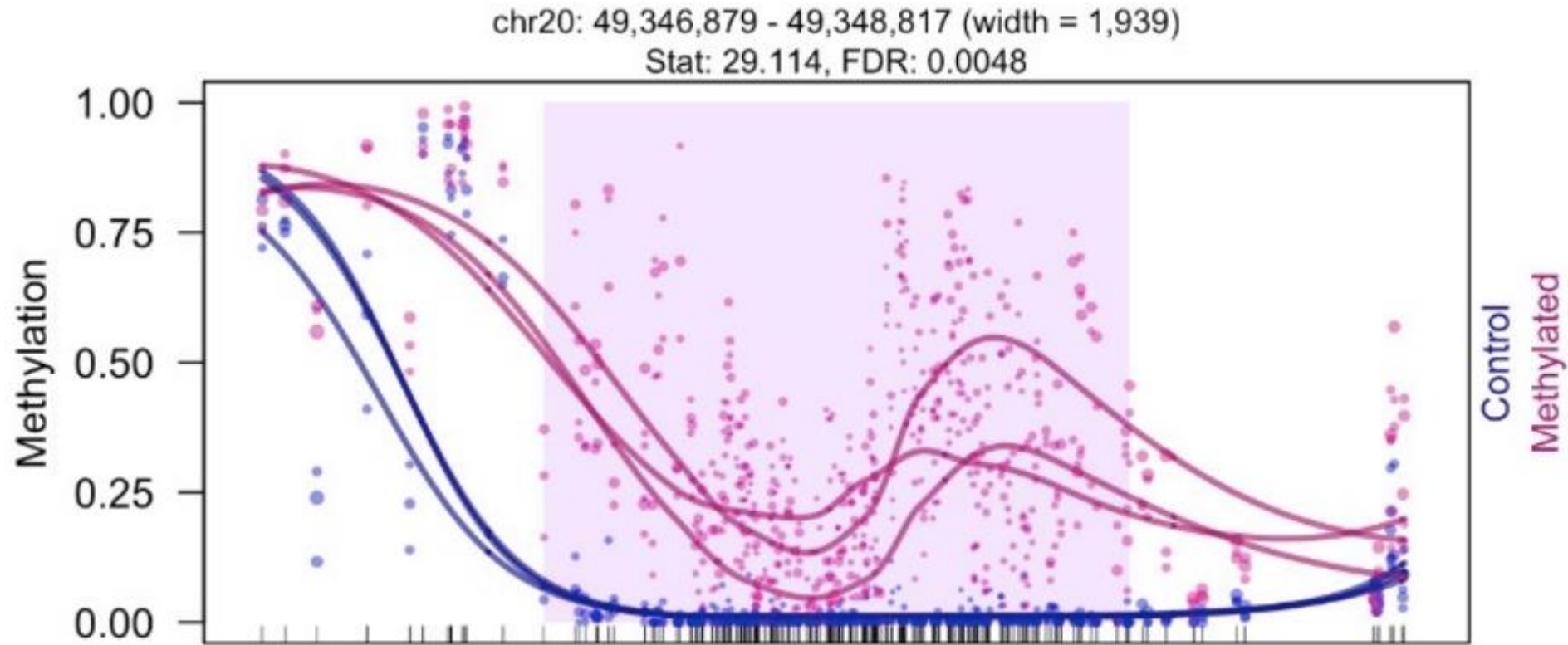


- Model correlated methylation signal over region
- Permutation for accurate FDR control



(Korthauer et al. 2019)

dmrseq Output



- *De novo* regions with FDR estimate
- Ranked by effect size of methylation difference
- Can adjust for covariates

Summary: DNA Methylation Analysis

- **Data:** Illumina arrays $\rightarrow$ per-CpG β values (proportions)
- **Model:** linear regression on logit-transformed M-values
 - Same limma framework as gene expression microarrays
 - Additive models, interactions, paired designs all apply
- **Output:**
 - **DMC** analysis: per-probe test (limma)
 - **DMR** analysis: region-level modelling (dmrseq/bumphunter)
- **Back-transform** estimates to β scale for biological interpretation:

$$\hat{\beta} = \frac{2^{\hat{M}}}{1 + 2^{\hat{M}}}$$

Today's lecture

- 1 Technologies for measuring regulatory activities
- 2 DNA Methylation (credit: Keegan Korthauer)
- 3 Multiomic Data Integration with Regulatory Genomics**

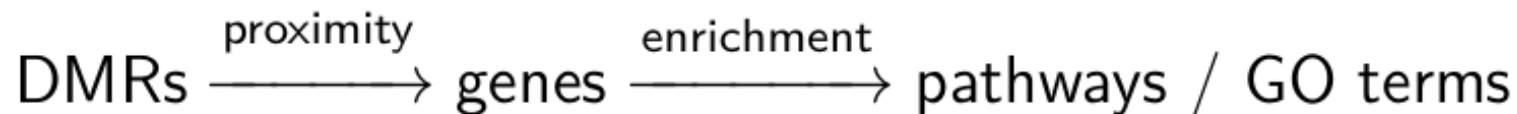
From DMRs to Biological Meaning

We found differentially methylated regions — now what?

Key questions:

- Which **genes** are near these regions?
- Which **biological processes** are affected?

Workflow:



This generalises to **any** set of genomic regions: ATAC peaks, ChIP peaks, GWAS loci

Standard Enrichment: A Problem

Naive approach: map each region to its nearest gene, collect gene list, run hypergeometric test

Why this fails:

- Gene-dense regions contribute many genes → **inflated hits**
- Distal enhancers (>5 kb) are silently ignored
- Background is “all genes”, not “all genomic space”

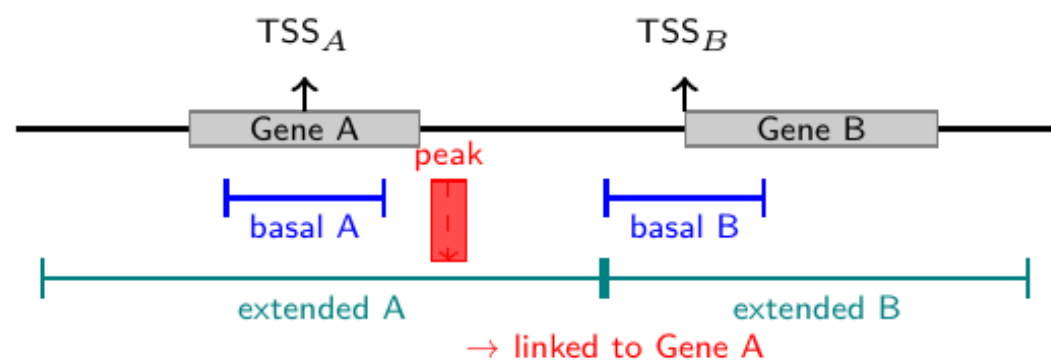
Example: a peak between a 50-gene cluster and an intergenic desert → the cluster dominates

Regions → Enrichment Directly

GREAT (McLean et al. 2010). Each gene gets a **regulatory domain**:

Basal domain: ± 5 kb around TSS (always kept)

Extended domain: expands up to 1 Mb, until the next gene's basal boundary



A region can be linked to **multiple** genes; background = all genomic space

GREAT: Why It Works Better

	Standard	GREAT
Input	gene list	genomic regions
Background	all genes	all genome
Long-range	ignored	up to 1 Mb
Gene density bias	yes	corrected

Useful for: ATAC peaks, ChIP peaks, DMRs, GWAS loci

GREAT Step 1: Prepare Input Regions

```
library(rGREAT)
library(TxDb.Hsapiens.UCSC.hg19.knownGene)

## chip_peaks loaded earlier - keep standard chromosomes
std_chrs <- paste0("chr", c(1:22, "X", "Y"))
ctcf_gr <- GRanges(as.character(seqnames(chip_peaks)),
                  IRanges(start(chip_peaks), end(chip_peaks)))
ctcf_gr <- ctcf_gr[as.character(seqnames(ctcf_gr)) %in% std_chrs]
cat(length(ctcf_gr), "CTCF peaks ready\n")
```

446 CTCF peaks ready

- Regions = CTCF ChIP-seq peaks (GM12878, whole genome)
- Same syntax for DMRs, ATAC peaks, or GWAS loci

GREAT Step 2: Run Enrichment

```
great_file <- "../data/great_ctcf_gobp.rds"
if.needed(great_file, {
  great_res <- great(ctcf_gr,
                    gene_sets = "GO:BP",
                    tss_source = "TxDb.Hsapiens.UCSC.hg19.knownGene",
                    verbose    = FALSE)
  saveRDS(great_res, great_file)
})
great_res <- readRDS(great_file)
```

- gene_sets: "GO:BP", "GO:MF", "KEGG", "MSigDB:H", ...
- tss_source: genome-specific gene model
- Returns a GreatObject (region-gene links + enrichment)

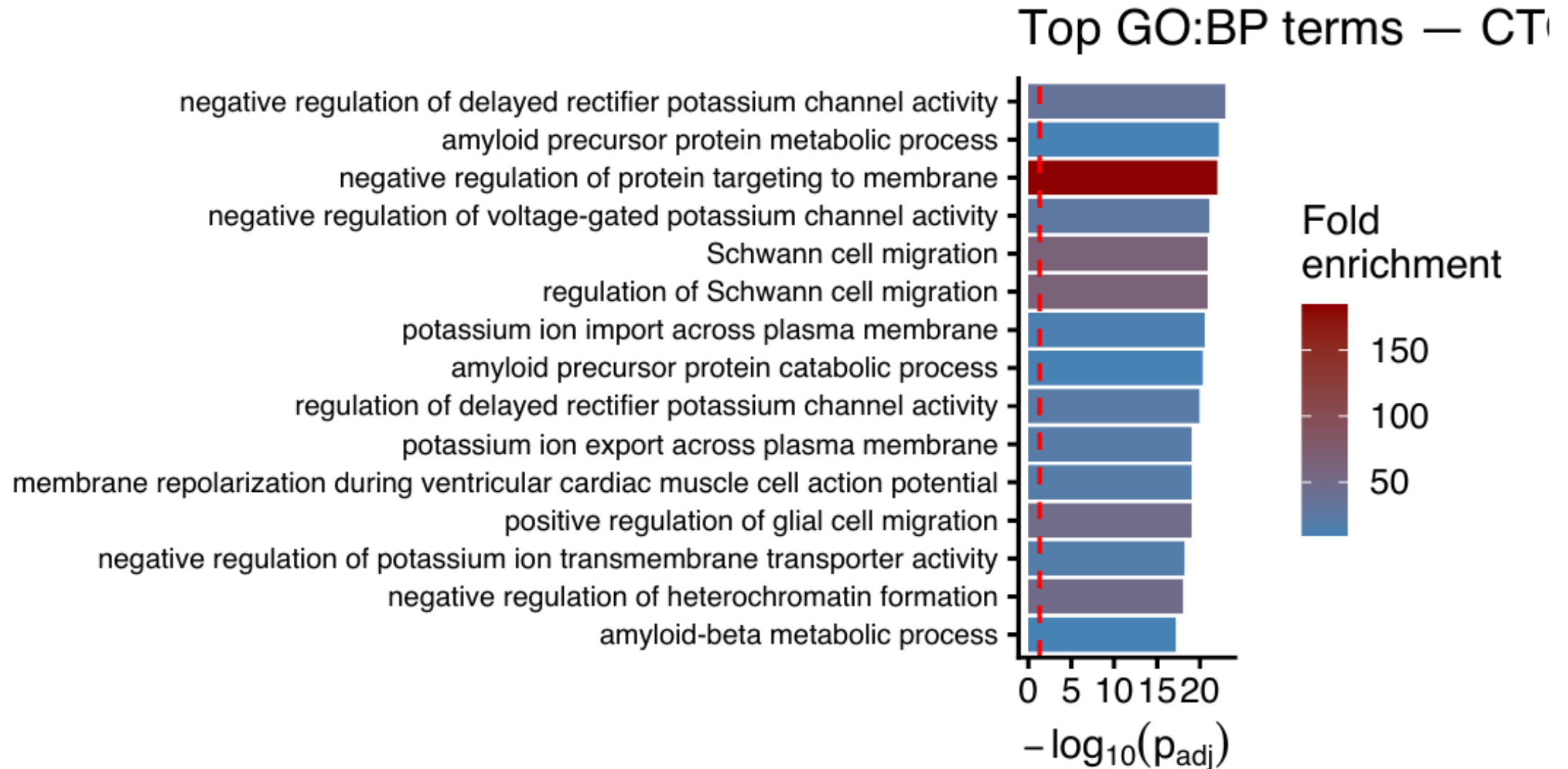
GREAT Step 3: Inspect Results

```
tb <- getEnrichmentTable(great_res)
cols <- c("description", "observed_region_hits",
          "fold_enrichment", "p_adjust")
head(tb[order(tb$p_adjust), cols], 6)
```

```
##                                     description
## 1 negative regulation of delayed rectifier potassium channel activity
## 2                               amyloid precursor protein metabolic process
## 3               negative regulation of protein targeting to membrane
## 4   negative regulation of voltage-gated potassium channel activity
## 5                               Schwann cell migration
## 6               regulation of Schwann cell migration
##   observed_region_hits fold_enrichment    p_adjust
## 1                   22       36.12004 1.143964e-23
## 2                   38       10.23917 6.198902e-23
## 3                   13      183.74047 9.691236e-23
## 4                   22       27.65168 8.614990e-22
## 5                   16       66.46148 1.283780e-21
## 6                   16       66.46148 1.283780e-21
```

- fold_enrichment: observed / expected overlap, p_adjust: BH-corrected p-value

GREAT Step 4: Visualize Top Terms



GWAS Variants Are Mostly Non-Coding

Disease GWAS identifies thousands of associated variants

The puzzle: $>90\%$ of hits fall outside protein-coding exons

Key questions:

- Where do these variants **act**?
- Which **cell types** are disease-relevant?

Strategy: overlap GWAS loci with cell-type-specific epigenetic annotations

GWAS → Epigenetic States: The Approach

- 1 Collect GWAS summary statistics (SNPs with $P < 5 \times 10^{-8}$)
- 2 Download cell-type-specific chromatin annotations (e.g., Roadmap Epigenomics: 127 cell/tissue types)
- 3 For each cell type: test whether GWAS SNPs are **enriched** in active enhancers
- 4 The most enriched cell type = likely disease-relevant tissue

Statistical test: Fisher's exact test (or LD-score regression)

GWAS Step 1: Fetch RA Loci from GWAS Catalog

```
library(gwasrapidd)
ra_file <- "../data/ra_gwas_hits.rds"
if (!file.exists(ra_file)) {
  assoc <- get_associations(study_id = "GCST90132222")
  variants <- get_variants(study_id = "GCST90132222")
  ra <- merge(assoc@risk_alleles[, c("association_id", "variant_id")],
             variants@variants[, c("variant_id", "chromosome_name",
                                   "chromosome_position")],
             by = "variant_id")
  ra$CHR <- paste0("chr", ra$chromosome_name)
  saveRDS(ra, ra_file)
}
ra <- readRDS(ra_file)
cat(nrow(ra), "genome-wide significant RA loci (GCST90132222)\n")
```

144 genome-wide significant RA loci (GCST90132222)

- Study: 22,350 European ancestry samples (Okada et al. 2014)
- Coordinates: hg19 / GRCh37

GWAS Step 2: Build Locus Windows

```
## Expand each index SNP  $\pm 50$  kb (covers typical LD block)
sig_gr <- GRanges(ra$CHR,
                  IRanges(ra$chromosome_position - 50000,
                          ra$chromosome_position + 50000))
sig_gr <- sig_gr[start(sig_gr) > 0]

## Chromosome-proportional random background (hg19)
set.seed(42)
chr_sizes <- seqlengths(BSgenome.Hsapiens.UCSC.hg19::
                        BSgenome.Hsapiens.UCSC.hg19)[paste0("chr", 1:22)]
chr_s <- sample(names(chr_sizes), 5e4, replace = TRUE,
               prob = chr_sizes / sum(chr_sizes))
pos_s <- mapply(function(ch) sample(chr_sizes[ch] - 1e5, 1) + 50000, chr_s)
bg_gr <- GRanges(chr_s, IRanges(pos_s - 50000, pos_s + 50000))
cat(length(sig_gr), "locus windows,", length(bg_gr), "background windows\n")

## 144 locus windows, 50000 background windows
```

GWAS Step 3: Load Roadmap H3K27ac Enhancers

```
enh_dir    <- "../data/roadmap/"
enh_labels <- c(CD4_Naive  = "AH43615", CD4_Memory = "AH43684",
               CD19_Bcell = "AH44900", CD14_Mono  = "AH44890",
               Adult_Liver= "AH43458", Brain      = "AH43501")

## Load from locally cached RDS files (downloaded once via AnnotationHub)
enhancers <- lapply(names(enh_labels), function(ct)
  readRDS(paste0(enh_dir, ct, "_H3K27ac.rds")))
names(enhancers) <- names(enh_labels)
immune_cells <- c("CD4_Naive", "CD4_Memory", "CD19_Bcell", "CD14_Mono")
sapply(enhancers, length)  # peaks per cell type
```

##	CD4_Naive	CD4_Memory	CD19_Bcell	CD14_Mono	Adult_Liver	Brain
##	66232	92684	65749	61058	121020	188662

- H3K27ac = active enhancer / promoter mark
- Roadmap Epigenomics: 127 reference human epigenomes (Kundaje et al. 2015)

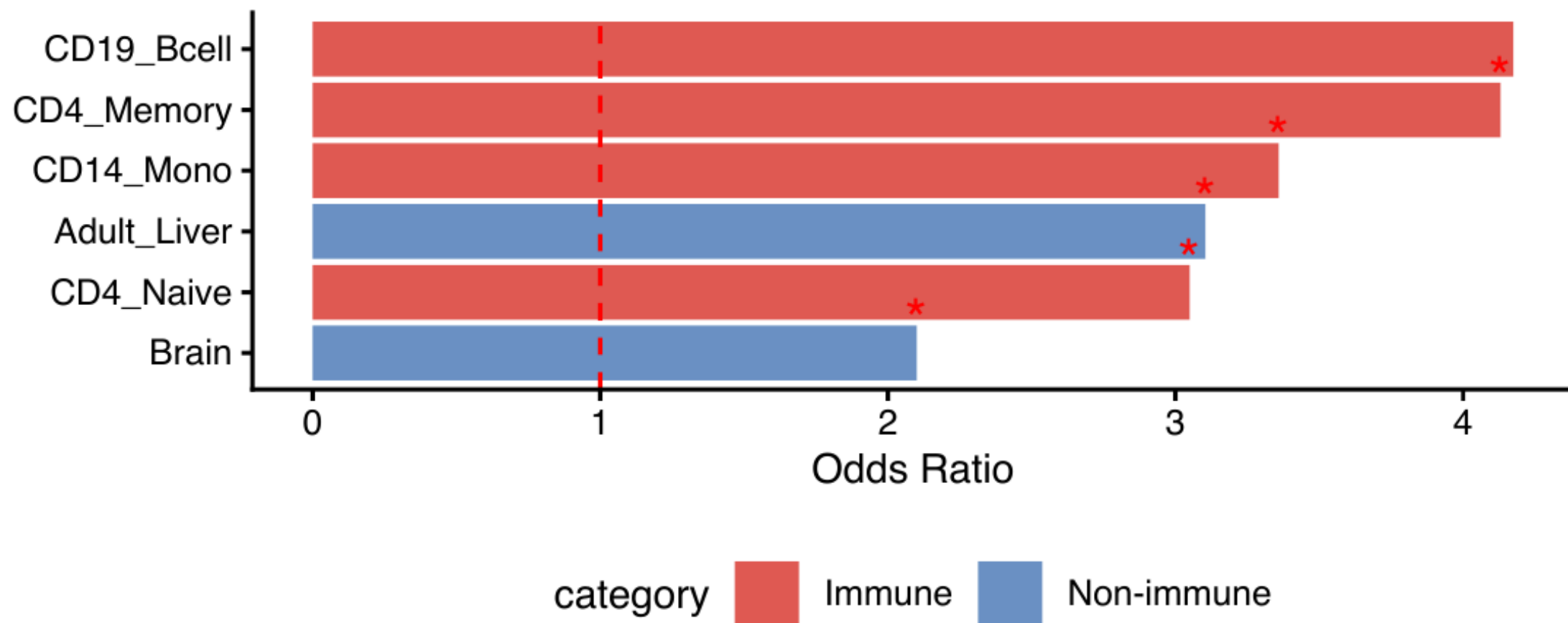
GWAS Step 4: Fisher's Exact Test per Cell Type

```
enr_file <- "../data/gwas_ra_enrichment.rds"
if.needed(enr_file, {
  enr <- do.call(rbind, lapply(names(enhancers), function(ct) {
    enh <- enhancers[[ct]]
    a <- sum(countOverlaps(sig_gr, enh) > 0)
    b <- length(sig_gr) - a
    c <- sum(countOverlaps(bg_gr, enh) > 0)
    d <- length(bg_gr) - c
    ft <- fisher.test(matrix(c(a, b, c, d), 2))
    data.frame(cell_type = ct, OR = ft$estimate,
               pval = ft$p.value, frac = a / length(sig_gr))
  )))
  enr$fdr <- p.adjust(enr$pval, "BH")
  enr$category <- ifelse(enr$cell_type %in% immune_cells, "Immune", "Non-immune")
  saveRDS(enr, enr_file)
})
enr <- readRDS(enr_file)
enr$cell_type <- factor(enr$cell_type, levels = enr$cell_type[order(enr$OR)])
```

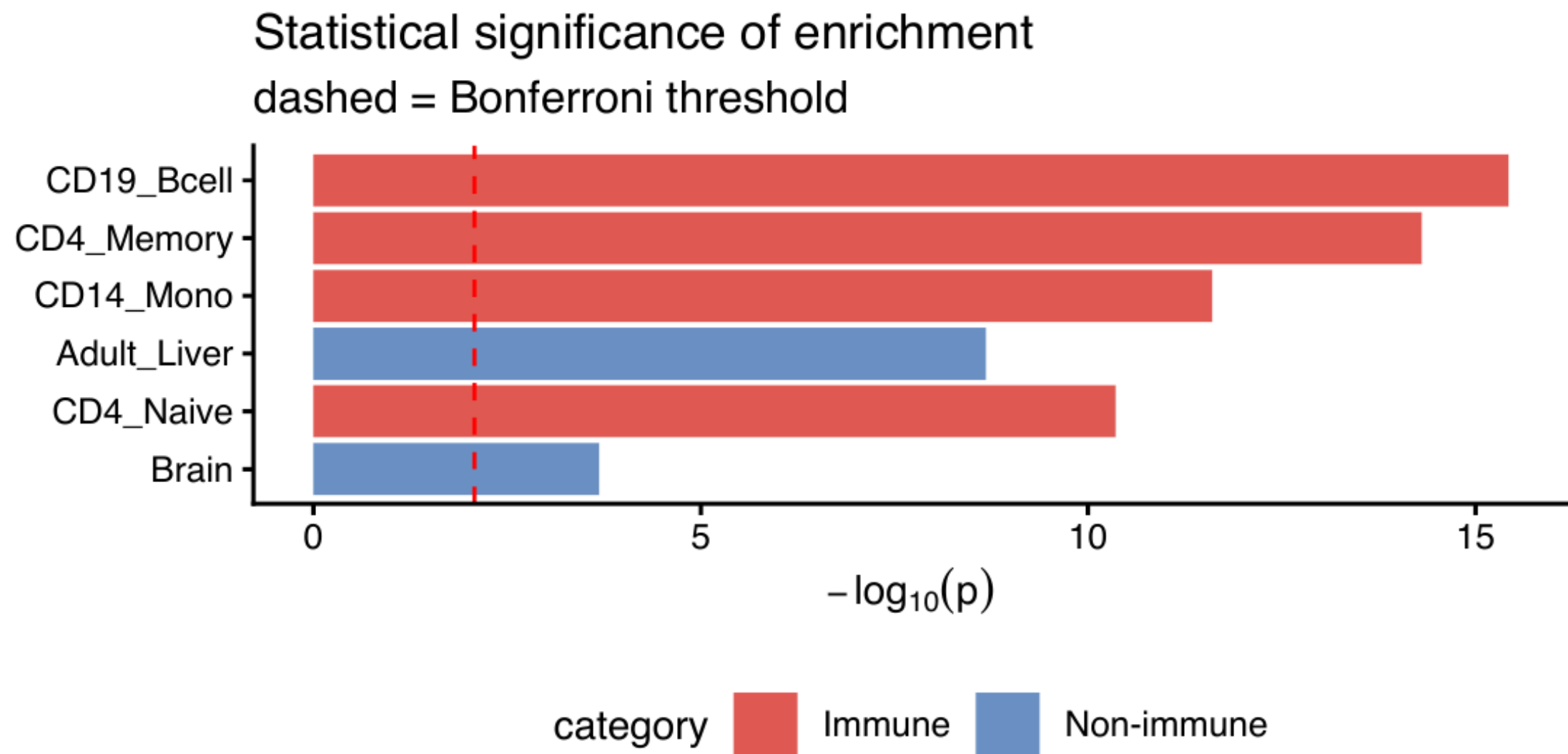
GWAS Enrichment: Odds Ratio

RA loci enriched in immune cell enhancers

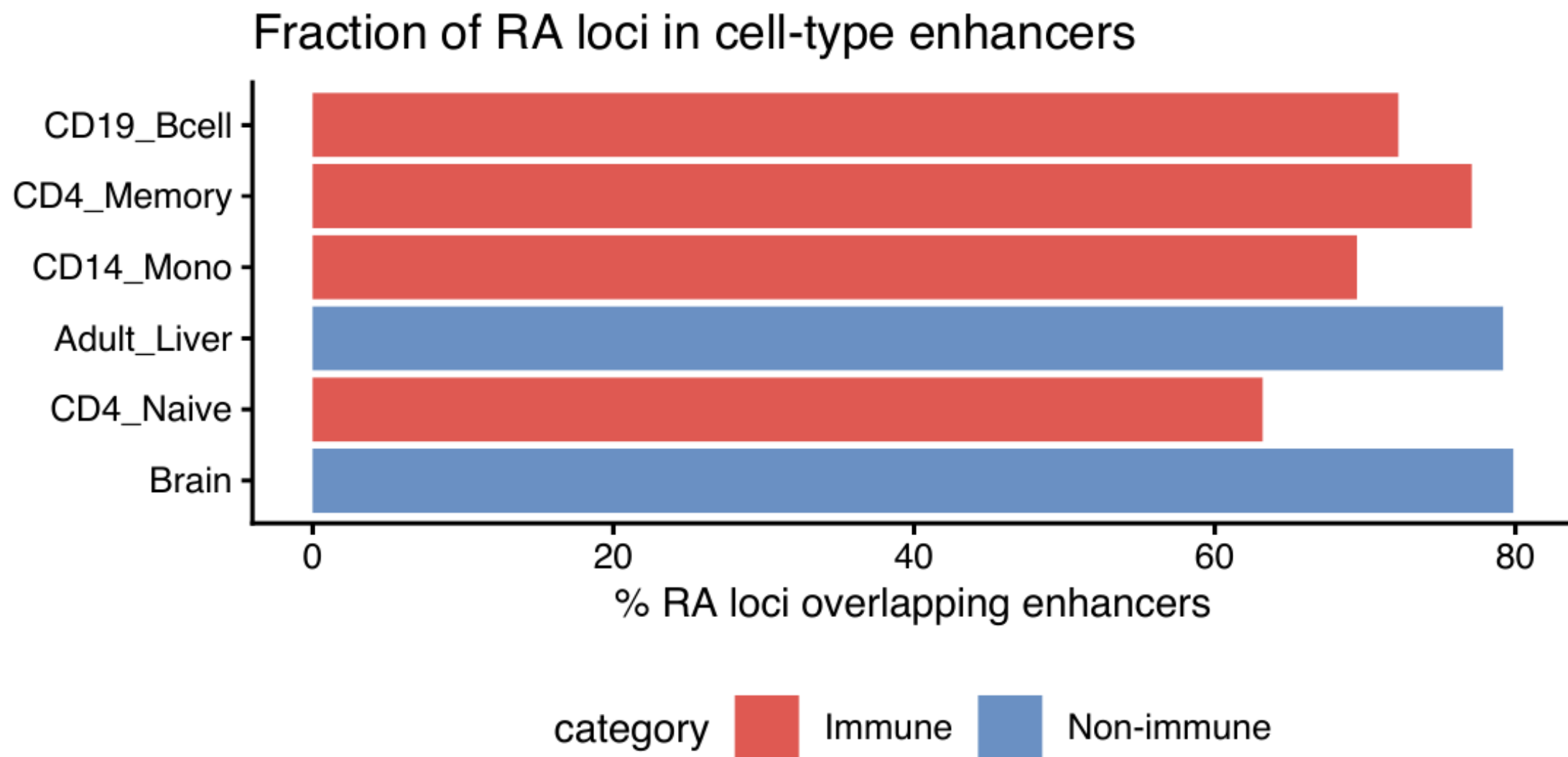
* FDR < 0.05 | Roadmap H3K27ac peaks



GWAS Enrichment: Statistical Significance



GWAS Enrichment: Overlap Fraction



Limitation: Fisher's Test Ignores LD

The problem: nearby SNPs are correlated through **linkage disequilibrium (LD)**

Two significant SNPs 20 kb apart may represent **one causal signal**, not two

⇒ overlapping the same enhancer window gets double-counted

Consequence: Fisher's test **inflates enrichment** in gene-dense, LD-rich regions

Better approaches:

- **Stratified LD score regression (S-LDSC)** — partitions heritability by annotation, models LD (Finucane et al. 2015)
- **GARFIELD** — permutation matching on MAF, distance to TSS, LD
- **GoShifter** — circular permutation within LD blocks

Real-World GWAS–Epigenome Findings (examples)

Rheumatoid arthritis → CD4⁺ T cells

adaptive immunity

IBD → gut immune cells

mucosal inflammation

Type 2 diabetes → pancreatic islets

β-cell dysfunction

Schizophrenia → neurons

brain circuit defects

Height → chondrocytes

cartilage growth plates

(Kundaje et al. 2015)

Why GWAS–Epigenome Integration Matters

Identify disease-relevant cell types

- Guides which cells to study experimentally
- 90% of hits are non-coding — context is everything

Mechanistic insight

- Variant disrupts an enhancer → changes TF binding → alters gene expression

Therapeutic direction

- Target the right cell type, not just the right gene

Links to scRNA-seq

- Fine-map to specific cell states within a tissue

Roadmap of STAT/BIOF/GSAT540 2026

data generation followed by methodology

- ③ Formulating biological questions
- ④ RNA-seq data
- ⑤ Experimental design
- ⑥ Single-cell genomics
- ⑦ Matrix factorization
- ⑩ GWAS
- ⑪ **Regulatory genomics** (Today)
- ⑫ Regression (for reg. genomics)
- ⑬ Biological networks
- ⑭ Clustering

Reference

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